王圆箓：斯坦因藏敦煌文献的首位“保管者”

Wang Yuanlu, the first “curator” of the Stein collection’s Dunhuang corpus

Mélodie Doumy · 2025

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ARTICLE

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论文

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Wang Yuanlu, the first 'curator' of the Stein collection's Dunhuang corpus

中文译文 | L01-P001-003

王圆箓：斯坦因藏敦煌文献的首位'保管者'

L01-P001-004 | 英文原文

Mélodie Doumy

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梅洛迪·杜米

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Asian and African Collections, The British Library, London, UK
Email: melodie.doumy@bl.uk

中文译文 | L01-P001-005

英国伦敦英国图书馆亚洲与非洲藏品部，电子邮箱：melodie.doumy@bl.uk

L01-P001-006 | 英文原文

Abstract

中文译文 | L01-P001-006

摘要

L01-P001-007 | 英文原文

Wang Yuanlu 王圓籙—the individual who accidentally stumbled upon the 'library cave' or Cave 17 at the Mogao Caves near Dunhuang in June 1900—is behind one of the world's most significant discoveries. Yet, in the years that followed, he was also responsible for the scattering of the cave's contents and selling large chunks to Marc Aurel Stein in 1907 and to Paul Pelliot in 1908. How could the self-appointed guardian of this major Buddhist complex part with one of what is often described as its crowning jewels? This article delves into Wang Yuanlu's motivations and highlights his agency, demonstrating that he was instrumental in shaping the now so-called Stein collection. One of the key sources for this investigation are the published writings of Marc Aurel Stein, which provide the most detailed descriptions of Wang and his activities during the period of the dispersal of the contents of Cave 17. These are supplemented by information drawn from the relevant parts of Stein's diaries, Paul Pelliot's writings, and primary sources and recent scholarship in Chinese that shed a different light on Wang's doings. The article starts by studying Wang's relationship with the Mogao Caves and their wider ecosystem. It then looks at the subsequent dispersal of the newly found hoard through his transactions with Stein in 1907 and 1914, which are contrasted with his dealings with Pelliot.

中文译文 | L01-P001-007

王圆箓（王圓籙）于1900年6月偶然发现了敦煌附近莫高窟的'藏经洞'，即第17窟，由此促成了世界上最重要的发现之一。然而，在随后的几年里，洞藏文物也经由他而流散；他于1907年向马克·奥雷尔·斯坦因、于1908年向保罗·伯希和出售了其中的大量文物。这位自行担任这处重要佛教石窟群守护者的人，为何会将常被视为其最珍贵宝藏之一的洞藏文物交出？本文探究王圆箓的动机，强调他的能动性，并表明他在如今所谓'斯坦因收藏'的形成中发挥了关键作用。本研究的一项主要资料是斯坦因已经出版的著述：这些著述对第17窟洞藏流散时期的王圆箓及其活动提供了最详细的描述。此外，本文还采用斯坦因日记的相关内容、伯希和的著述，以及中文原始资料和近期研究；后者为理解王圆箓的行为提供了不同视角。文章首先考察王圆箓与莫高窟及其更广泛环境之间的关系，随后讨论他于1907年和1914年同斯坦因的交易所造成的新发现洞藏的流散，并将这些交易与他同伯希和的交涉相比较。

L01-P001-008 | 英文原文

Keywords: Cave 17; Dunhuang; provenance; Marc Aurel Stein; Wang Yuanlu

中文译文 | L01-P001-008

关键词：第17窟；敦煌；来源与流传记录；马可·奥雷尔·斯坦因；王圆箓

L01-P001-009 | 英文原文

Introduction

中文译文 | L01-P001-009

引言

L01-P001-010 | 英文原文

In June 1900, an individual named Wang Yuanlu 王圓籙 (1850?–1931) noticed a crack in the wall of the corridor leading to a large cave, Cave 16, at the Mogao Caves site, near Dunhuang, as he was conducting some restoration work. Upon checking what was behind the exposed plaster, he discovered a door behind which a small chamber had been excavated in the rock. Now commonly referred to as Cave 17 or the 'library cave', this room is thought to have been sealed off at the beginning of the eleventh century. It turned out to be a real 'time capsule of Silk Road history',[1] containing tens of thousands of manuscripts, as well as printed documents, paintings on paper and silk, textiles, and other Buddhist artefacts.

中文译文 | L01-P001-010 | 原文注号：1

1900年6月，一位名叫王圆箓（王圓籙，1850？—1931）的人在敦煌附近的莫高窟进行修缮工作时，发现通往一座大窟——第16窟——的甬道墙壁上有一道裂缝。他查看剥露的灰泥后方，发现一扇门，门后是一个从岩壁中开凿出来的小室。这个小室如今通常被称为第17窟或'藏经洞'，一般认为它在11世纪初被封闭。这里原来是一个真正的'丝绸之路历史的时间胶囊'〔1〕，内藏数以万计的写本，以及印本文献、纸绢绘画、纺织品和其他佛教文物。

L01-P001-011 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Wang rapidly alerted local officials to this discovery, but no immediate actions were taken. In 1904, orders were sent to keep the collection in place, and he remained de facto custodian of the cave. In 1910, an official from the Ministry of Education was dispatched to Dunhuang to transport all the manuscripts left in Cave 17 to Beijing for safekeeping. By then, the British-Hungarian archaeologist Aurel Stein (1862–1943) and the French Sinologist Paul Pelliot (1878–1945) had already respectively visited the Mogao Caves in 1907

中文译文 | L01-P001-011

王圆箓很快将这一发现报告给地方官员，但官府并未立即采取行动。1904年，官府下令将这批收藏留在原处，他仍是藏经洞事实上的保管人。1910年，学部派出一名官员前往敦煌，将第17窟内剩余的全部写本运往北京妥善保管。此前，英国籍匈牙利考古学家奥雷尔·斯坦因（1862—1943）与法国汉学家保罗·伯希和（1878—1945）已经分别到访莫高窟，时间为1907年

L01-P001-012 | 英文原文

[1] V. Hansen, *The Silk Road: A New History* (Oxford and New York, 2012), pp. 167–197.

中文译文 | L01-P001-012

1 V. Hansen，《丝绸之路：新历史》（牛津与纽约，2012年），第167–197页。

L01-P001-013 | 英文原文

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中文译文 | L01-P001-013

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原PDF第2页（原刊第822页）

L01-P002-002 | 英文原文

and 1908, and Wang had agreed to sell them both exceptionally large chunks of the repository's contents. Later on, he parted with more items against payment. For this reason, Wang Yuanlu has been cast down in Chinese history as a villain, whose name, although associated with the discovery of Cave 17, is even more so linked to the dispersal of its contents. He has often been portrayed as being illiterate and unaware of the significance of the trove held in the cave, which resulted in his being duped by Western explorers. Others have simply considered him to be the prime example of a thief who profited from the sale of Dunhuang relics.[2] In recent years, several Chinese scholars have started to show that Wang was driven by his piety and desire to protect the Mogao Caves. Yet he remains overall an obscure figure.

中文译文 | L01-P002-002 | 原文注号：2

1908年，王圆箓同意将藏经洞中数量极为庞大的文物出售给他们。此后，他又在获得报酬的情况下转让了更多物品。正因如此，王圆箓在中国历史上被塑造成一个反面人物——虽然他的名字与第17窟的发现密切相关，但更常与藏经洞文物的流散联系在一起。人们常常将他描绘成文盲，且不了解洞中文物的重大价值，因而遭到了西方探险家的欺骗。还有人干脆认为他是最典型的从敦煌文物出售中牟利的盗贼。近年来，一些中国学者开始指出，王圆箓的行为其实是出于对他的信仰以及保护莫高窟的愿望。然而总体而言，他依然是一个鲜为人知的人物。

L01-P002-003 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Both Marc Aurel Stein's personal narratives, *Ruins of Desert Cathay* and *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks*, and the expedition reports that he wrote, *Serindia* and *Innermost Asia*, provide complementary accounts of his visits to the Mogao Caves and his negotiations with Wang Yuanlu over the contents of Cave 17. These books play a key part in shaping Stein's self-representation, as he glorifies his own actions and, in doing so, minimises Wang's role. However, when reading between the lines and bringing in other contemporary sources, it becomes possible to see that Wang Yuanlu had a much more important part in the care, arrangement, and dispersal of the cave's contents. While Stein's published accounts had a 'performative' dimension, they also contain information about Wang's custodianship of the caves, his relationship with the wider local community, his motivations for selling Cave 17's contents, and the way he selected materials for the explorer's 'examination'. Therefore, this article critically examines these writings, contrasting them (when relevant) with material from his travel diaries, as well as Pelliot's account and other contemporaneous sources in Chinese. It proposes a fuller picture of Wang Yuanlu—the 'priestly librarian'[3] who could be considered as the first 'curator' of the cave's contents—and highlights his agency in shaping the so-called Stein collection.

中文译文 | L01-P002-003 | 原文注号：3

奥雷尔·斯坦因所著的《沙漠中的华夏遗迹》与《中亚古道探秘》这两部个人叙事著作，以及他撰写的探险报告《锡兰与最内陆的亚洲》，都从不同角度记述了他前往莫高窟的经过，以及他与王圆箓就第17窟藏经内容所进行的商谈。这些著作在塑造斯坦因自我形象的过程中起到了关键作用——他在书中夸耀自己的行为，进而弱化了王圆箓的作用。然而，若能仔细揣摩文字背后的含义，并结合其他同时期的资料，就会发现王圆箓在那些藏经的保管、整理以及流散过程中其实扮演了更为重要的角色。尽管斯坦因公开的记述带有"表演性"的特征，但其中仍包含有关王圆箓负责看守莫高窟的情况、他与当地社区的关系、他出售第17窟藏经的动机，以及他为探险家"考察"而挑选物品的方式等信息。因此，本文对这些著作进行了批判性分析，在适当之处将其与斯坦因的旅行日记、伯希和的记述以及其他中文同时期资料相互对照，从而呈现出王圆箓的全貌——这位可被视为该窟藏经首任"保管者"的"僧侣式图书管理员"，并凸显出他在塑造所谓"斯坦因藏经"这一概念过程中的主动作用。

L01-P002-004 | 英文原文

Abbot Wang: guardian of the Mogao Caves
Wang Yuanlu and the discovery of Cave 17

中文译文 | L01-P002-004

王圆箓：莫高窟的守护者——王圆箓与第17窟的发现

L01-P002-005 | 英文原文

Little is known about Wang Yuanlu 王圓祿 (Figure 1).[4] Much of the information we have about him comes from the accounts of Stein, Pelliot, and other foreign explorers.[5] Originally from Macheng 麻城 County in Hubei 湖北, he was born in *circa* 1849–1850. Later in life, having fled the drought and famine raging in his native province, he ended up at Jiuquan 酒泉 (then Suzhou 肅州) and served in the military.[6] During his service, Wang Yuanlu converted to Daoism under the guidance of a master named Shengdao 盛道.[7] After being discharged

中文译文 | L01-P002-005 | 原文注号：4、5、6、7

关于王圆箓（图1）的记载极为有限。4 我们目前所掌握的关于他的大部分信息都来自斯坦因、伯希和以及其他外国探险家的记述。5 他原籍湖北麻城县，大约出生于1849至1850年之间。后来，为躲避家乡的旱灾与饥荒，他流落到酒泉（当时称肃州），并在当地从军。6 在服役期间，王圆箓在一位名叫盛道的师父指导下皈依了道教。7 退役后

L01-P002-006 | 英文原文

[2] Chen Wanli 陳萬里, *Xixing riji* 西行日記 [*A Diary of Westward Travels*], (ed.) Yang Xiaobin (Lanzhou, 2000), p. 8.

[3] M. A. Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay: Personal Narrative of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China* (London, 1912), vol. ii, p. 190.

中文译文 | L01-P002-006

2 陈万里，《西行日记》[A Diary of Westward Travels]，杨晓斌编（兰州，2000年），第8页。3 M. A. 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国古迹：中亚与中国西部探险记》（伦敦，1912年），第二卷，第190页。

L01-P002-007 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[4] Several Chinese primary sources dating from the time at which Wang Yuanlu was active at Dunhuang indicate that his name (though phonetically the same) was originally with the characters '園祿'. It is only on his epitaph that it was changed to '圓籙'. In addition, Fang Guangchang has suggested that his secular name was Wang Fulin 王福琳. Fang Guangchang 方廣錩, '*Wang Daoshi mingcheng kao*' 王道士名称考 [On the name and titles of Taoist Priest Wang], *Dunhuang yanjiu* 敦煌研究 4 (2016), pp. 111–118.

中文译文 | L01-P002-007

4 几份源自王圆箓在敦煌活动时期的中文原始文献表明，他的名字（虽然发音相同）原本应为"園祿"二字，直到其墓志上才改为"圓籙"。此外，方廣錩还提出，他的俗名是王福琳。方廣錩，《王道士名称考》，《敦煌研究》4（2016），第111–118页。

L01-P002-008 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[5] Rong Xinjiang, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, (trans.) I. Galambos (Leiden and Boston, 2013), p. 107.

[6] Stein thought that Wang Yuanlu 'was a poor friendless mendicant' from Shaanxi 陝西. See M. A. Stein, *Serindia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China, etc.* (Oxford, 1921), vol. 2, p. 804. Wang Jiqing examined in detail the various sources available and demonstrated that, although Wang Yuanlu's place of origin is most often given as Hubei, including on his epitaph, some official Chinese documents from the late Qing Dynasty mention that he came from Hanzhong 漢中 in Shaanxi. According to Wang Jiqing, it is perfectly conceivable that Wang Yuanlu was born in Hubei but spent a lot of his adult life in Shaanxi. Wang Jiqing 王冀青, *Guo bao liu san: Zang jing dong de gu shi* 國寶流散: 藏經洞的故事 (Lanzhou, 2007), pp. 3–6.

中文译文 | L01-P002-008

5 《新疆论敦煌》（Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang），I. Galambos译（莱顿与波士顿，2013年），第107页。6 斯坦因认为王圆箓是来自陕西的"一个穷困且没有朋友的乞讨者"。参见M. A. Stein所著《西域：中亚与中国最西部考察详细报告》（Serindia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China, etc.）（牛津，1921年），第2卷，第804页。王冀青详细研究了各种现有资料，指出虽然王圆箓的籍贯多被记载为湖北，包括其墓志铭中也是如此，但晚清时期的一些中国官方文献却提到他来自陕西的汉中。据王冀青所言，王圆箓很可能出生于湖北，却在陕西度过了大部分成年时光。王冀青，《国宝流散：藏经洞的故事》（Guo bao liu san: Zang jing dong de gu shi）（兰州，2007年），第3–6页。

L01-P002-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[7] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, pp. 79–80.

中文译文 | L01-P002-009

7 《荣氏敦煌讲演录》，第79–80页。

原PDF第3页（原刊第823页）

L01-P003-002 | 英文原文

Figure 1. Portrait of Wang Yuanlu taken by Marc Aurel Stein in June 1907. Source: © From The British Library Collection: Photo 392/26(327).

中文译文 | L01-P003-002

图1. 1907年6月由奥雷尔·斯坦因为王圆箓拍摄的肖像照。图片来源：© 出自英国图书馆藏：照片392/26(327)。

L01-P003-003 | 英文原文

from the army, Wang became a Daoist priest. This earned him the nickname of Wang Daoshi 王道士 ('the Daoshi' for Stein).[8] At the extreme end of the nineteenth century, possibly between 1897 and 1899, Wang Yuanlu settled at the Mogao Caves complex 莫高窟 or Caves of the Thousand Buddhas 千佛洞, where he stayed until his death in 1931.

中文译文 | L01-P003-003 | 原文注号：8

退伍后，王圆箓成了一名道士，也因此获得了"王道士"这一绰号——在斯坦因的记载中便称其为"the Daoshi"。19世纪末，大概在1897年至1899年之间，王圆箓在莫高窟或千佛洞定居下来，并一直居住到1931年去世。

L01-P003-004 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

The Mogao Caves are located within a close distance south-east of the oasis town of Dunhuang 敦煌, which was established as a frontier garrison outpost in the second century BCE and came to be a strategic spot at the cross of the Northern and the Southern Silk Roads. The first cave is said to have been carved in 366 CE by a Buddhist pilgrim monk and, over the next millennium, almost 1,000 caves and niches were gradually excavated in

中文译文 | L01-P003-004

莫高位于敦煌东南不远处，而敦煌则是一座始建于公元前二世纪的边防要塞，后来逐渐发展成为连接南北丝绸之路的战略要地。据传第一座洞窟是由一位佛教朝圣僧人在公元366年开凿的，此后的一千多年间，那里陆续挖掘出了近1000座洞窟和壁龛。

L01-P003-005 | 英文原文

[8] The term 'daoshi 道士' has often been translated as 'Abbot' in English, although it would be more accurate to call him a 'priest' or a 'Daoist master'.

中文译文 | L01-P003-005

"道士"这一称谓在英文中常被译为"Abbot"，但实际上称其为"priest"或"Daoist master"更为准确。

原PDF第4页（原刊第824页）

L01-P004-002 | 英文原文

the sandstone cliff face, half of them richly decorated with painted murals and clay sculptures. In the fourteenth century, the land Silk Roads began to decline and the site gradually fell into disuse. When the Frenchman Charles-Eudes Bonin (1865–1929) visited the Mogao Caves in 1899, at around the same time as Wang Yuanlu himself arrived at the site, he commented on the fact that the caves on the lower level were in danger of being completely silted up if no one took adequate measures.[9] Little did he know that Wang had come to the same realisation.

中文译文 | L01-P004-002 | 原文注号：9

那片砂岩峭壁上，有一半绘有精美的壁画与陶塑。14世纪时，陆上丝绸之路开始衰落，该地也逐渐被废弃。1899年，法国人夏尔-欧德·博南（1865–1929）造访莫高窟，时间与王圆箓抵达此处大致相同，他评论说，若不采取适当措施，下层的洞窟很有可能会被淤泥完全填满。9他并不知道，王圆箓也已意识到同样的问题。

L01-P004-003 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Soon after settling down at the Mogao Caves, Wang Yuanlu started to collect donations from devout locals. With the money, he set about repairing the three-storey complex linked to the eminent ninth-century Monk Wu Hongbian.[10] By the time Stein arrived at the Mogao Caves, Wang had restored a large Buddhist cave on the ground floor (Cave 16) 'to what he conceived to have been its original glory'.[11] Wang Yuanlu hired several workers to clear off drift sand and debris from its entrance. As they were slowly proceeding with their task, they accidentally stumbled upon a small hidden cave in June 1900.[12] Excavated in the north wall of the corridor and later closed off, the room was only a few cubic metres large. It was filled, from floor to ceiling, with manuscripts, paintings, textiles, and other artefacts. These items dated from the late fourth century to the beginning of the eleventh century—the time around which the cave commonly referred to as Cave 17, or the 'library cave', was probably sealed off.

中文译文 | L01-P004-003 | 原文注号：10、11、12

在莫高窟安顿下来后不久，王圆箓就开始向虔诚的当地人募集捐款。他用这些钱着手修缮与九世纪高僧吴洪辩相关的三层建筑群。〔10〕斯坦因到访莫高窟时，王圆箓已将底层一座大型佛窟（第16窟）修复到"他所设想的原有辉煌"。〔11〕王圆箓雇了几名工人清理窟口的流沙与杂物。他们缓慢进行清理时，于1900年6月偶然发现了一间隐蔽的小窟。〔12〕该室开凿于甬道北壁，后来被封闭，空间仅数立方米，却从地面一直到顶部堆满写本、绘画、纺织品和其他文物。其年代从四世纪末延续至十一世纪初；这间通常称为第17窟或"藏经洞"的洞室，很可能就在十一世纪初前后被封闭。

L01-P004-004 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Perhaps hoping to get some form of financial compensation or recognition for his pious endeavours, Wang Yuanlu immediately went to report the discovery to the local county magistrate, Yan Ze 嚴澤 (dates unknown). He took two manuscripts with him as proof, but no actions were taken. When the new county magistrate Wang Zonghan 汪宗翰 (b. 1845) came to Dunhuang in April 1902, he was informed of the existence of Cave 17 and given several of its items. In turn, Wang Zonghan wrote about this to the epigrapher Ye Changshi 葉昌熾 (1849–1917), who was Gansu provincial education commissioner from 1902 to 1906.[13] Furthermore, it appears that Wang Yuanlu also showed a case of manuscripts to the Qing official Ting Dong 廷棟 (1866–1918), but the latter did not regard these as important.[14] Based on Stein's expedition report, 'news of the discovery having reached distant Lanzhou, specimens of the manuscripts were asked for from provincial headquarters'.[15]

中文译文 | L01-P004-004 | 原文注号：13、14、15

或许期望因自己的虔诚之举获得某种经济补偿或认可，王圆箓立即将这一发现上报给了当地县令严泽（生卒年不详），并带去了两部写本作为证据，但却并未因此采取任何行动。1902年4月，新任县令汪宗翰（生于1845年）来到敦煌后，才得知第17窟的存在，并获赠了该窟的几件藏品。汪宗翰随后将此事写信告知了1902年至1906年间担任甘肃省教育专员的金石学家叶昌炽（1849–1917）。此外，王圆箓似乎还向清廷官员廷栋（1866–1918）展示过一些写本，但后者并未认为它们具有重要价值。根据斯坦因的考察报告，“这一发现的消息传到了遥远的兰州，省府便要求提供这些写本的样本”。

L01-P004-005 | 英文原文

[9] C.-E. Bonin, ‘Les grottes des Mille Bouddhas’, *Comptes rendus des séances de l’Académie des Inscriptions et Belles-Lettres* 45.2 (1901), p. 212. For a detailed article about Bonin’s visit to Dunhuang and relations with explorers Pelliot and Hedin, see M. Doumy, ‘Charles-Eudes Bonin: the first French person to visit Dunhuang’, *Silk Roads Archaeology and Heritage* 1.1 (2023), pp. 1–20, https://doi.org/10.5334/srah.3. For a full biography of Bonin in French, see S. Malsagne, *Au Coeur du Grand Jeu: La France en Orient. Charles-Eudes Bonin (1865–1929), explorateur diplomate* (Paris, 2015).

中文译文 | L01-P004-005

9 C.-E. Bonin所著《Les grottes des Mille Bouddhas》载于《Comptes rendus des séances de l’Académie des Inscriptions et Belles-Lettres》45.2卷（1901年），第212页。关于Bonin访问敦煌以及他与伯希和、赫定等探险家之间关系的详细文章，可参阅M. Doumy所著《Charles-Eudes Bonin: the first French person to visit Dunhuang》，载于《Silk Roads Archaeology and Heritage》1.1卷（2023年），第1–20页，网址：https://doi.org/10.5334/srah.3。而关于Bonin的法文完整传记，则可见S. Malsagne所著《Au Coeur du Grand Jeu: La France en Orient. Charles-Eudes Bonin (1865–1929), explorateur diplomate》（巴黎，2015年）。

L01-P004-006 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[10] This information is found in the stele ‘Record of Merit for the Restoration of the Thousand Buddha Caves’ three-storey building (Ch. ‘*Chong xiu Qianfodong san ceng lou gong de bei ji* 重修千佛洞三层楼功德碑记’) dated to 1906, as well as in Wang Yuanlu’s epitaph. See Fan Guangchun 樊光春, ‘*Dunhuang Daoshi Wang Yuanlu pingzhuan*’ 敦煌道士王圆箓评传 [Critical biography of Dunhuang’s Daoist priest Wang Yuanlu], *Zhongguo daojiao* 中國道教 5 (2008), pp. 43–44.

中文译文 | L01-P004-006

10 这一信息见于1906年刻立的《重修千佛洞三层楼功德碑记》石碑，以及王圆箓的墓志铭中。相关内容可见樊光春所著《敦煌道士王圆箓评传》，载于《中国道教》2008年第5期，第43–44页。

L01-P004-007 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[11] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 168.

[12] The date of the discovery of Cave 17 varies depending on sources: it can be given as 20, 22, or 25 June 1907.

[13] Huang Zheng 黄征, *Jie chen yi zhu: Dunhuang yi shu* 劫尘遗珠: 敦煌遗书 [*The Lost Pearl: Dunhuang Manuscripts*] (Lanzhou, 1999), pp. 10–13. Rong Xinjiang and Justin Jacobs both suggested that Wang Yuanlu may not have told Wang Zonghan and local authorities the whole truth about the actual scope of the cave’s contents. They refer to the fact that Ye Changchi 葉昌熾 (1849–1917), Gansu provincial education commissioner from 1902 to 1906, thought that the cave only had several hundreds of manuscripts. It could be that he heard this from Wang Zonghan, who was deliberately misled by Wang Yuanlu. See Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, pp. 90–91, 101; J. Jacobs, *The Compensations of Plunder: How China Lost Its Treasures* (Chicago and London, 2020), pp. 96–97.

中文译文 | L01-P004-007

11 斯坦因，Ruins of Desert Cathay，第168页。12 不同资料所载第17窟发现日期不一，有1907年6月20日、22日或25日等说法。〔译注：此处脚注原文年份作1907，与文章正文所述1900不一致，译文照录，引用时请核对原页。〕13 黄征，《劫尘遗珠：敦煌遗书》（兰州，1999），第10—13页。荣新江与Justin Jacobs都提出，王圆箓可能没有向Wang Zonghan及地方当局如实说明洞藏的实际规模。他们依据的是：1902年至1906年任甘肃学政的叶昌炽（1849—1917），以为洞内只有数百件写本。叶昌炽可能是从Wang Zonghan那里听到这一消息，而后者受到了王圆箓的有意误导。参见荣新江，Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang，第90—91、101页；J. Jacobs，The Compensations of Plunder: How China Lost Its Treasures（芝加哥与伦敦，2020），第96—97页。

L01-P004-008 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[14] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, p. 85.
[15] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 802.

中文译文 | L01-P004-008

14 荣毅仁：《敦煌十八讲》，第85页。15 斯坦因：《西域记》，第802页。

原PDF第5页（原刊第825页）

L01-P005-002 | 英文原文

However, 'hours of diplomatic converse' with Wang Yuanlu purportedly revealed to the explorer that 'they had failed to attract any interest there' and that:

中文译文 | L01-P005-002

据说，通过与王圆箓的"数小时外交式交谈"，这位探险家得知"他们未能在那里引起任何人的兴趣"，而且：

L01-P005-003 | 英文原文

[...] to Wang's undisguised chagrin no further notice had been taken of his treasured old manuscripts or, indeed, of his pious labours which had led to their discovery. Officialdom had rested satisfied with a rough statement that the whole of the manuscripts would make up seven cartloads, and, evidently grudging the cost of transport or the trouble of close examination, had left the whole undisturbed in charge of the Tao-shih [Daoshi] as self-constituted guardian of the temple.[16]

中文译文 | L01-P005-003 | 原文注号：16

令王圆箓极为懊恼的是，人们并未进一步重视他那些珍贵的古老写本，乃至他为发现这些写本而付出的辛勤努力。官府仅仅满足于一个粗略的估计，认为所有写本加起来共有七车之重，显然是因为不愿承担运输费用或耗费精力进行仔细检查，才将这一切原封不动地交由自封为寺庙守护者的道士照看。16

L01-P005-004 | 英文原文

In any event, in May 1904, the provincial government ordered Wang Zonghan in Dunhuang to take measures for the preservation of Cave 17's contents.[17] Some scholars have argued that he was also asked to take an inventory of the manuscripts and paintings.[18] As for Wang Yuanlu, to whom the overall responsibility of safeguarding the deposit was delegated, there is evidence that he took the necessary precautions to prevent anyone from entering the cave without his consent. In his travel diary, Stein recounts that he first heard of the manuscripts found at the Mogao Caves from Zahid Beg, a trader from Urumchi, who told him that these 'had been locked by order'.[19] Indeed, Wang had attached a wooden door to the opening of the cave and kept the key. On 16 March 1907, when Stein and his Chinese secretary Jiang Xiaowan 蔣孝琬 or Jiang Shiye 蔣師爺[20] (d. 1922) first came to the Mogao Caves and tried to access the small cave, it was carefully locked in the absence of Wang Yuanlu, who had gone begging for alms around Dunhuang with two followers.[21] Upon returning two months later, on 21 May 1907, the British-Hungarian explorer found out that the narrow opening had been 'completely walled up with brickwork', allegedly to protect it from the intrusion of eager pilgrims[22] but maybe also as a 'special precaution taken against [his] inquisitive eyes'.[23] When the French Sinologist Paul Pelliot went to the Mogao Caves in 1908, the door to Cave 17 was also locked and he had to wait for Wang Yuanlu to meet him with the key.[24]

中文译文 | L01-P005-004 | 原文注号：17、18、19、20、21、22、23、24

无论如何，1904年5月，省政府命令身在敦煌的汪宗翰采取措施保护第17窟洞藏。〔17〕有学者认为，官府还要求他为写本与绘画编制清单。〔18〕王圆箓被委以保护整批洞藏的总责；有证据表明，他采取了必要防范措施，禁止任何人未经其同意进入洞窟。斯坦因在旅行日记中说，自己最初从乌鲁木齐商人Zahid Beg那里听说莫高窟发现写本，后者告诉他，这些写本"已奉命锁起"。〔19〕王圆箓确实在洞口安装了一扇木门，并保管钥匙。1907年3月16日，斯坦因及其中文秘书蒋孝琬，亦称蒋师爷〔20〕（卒于1922年），首次到访莫高窟并试图进入小窟；当时王圆箓正带两名随从在敦煌周边募化，洞窟在他外出期间被严密锁闭。〔21〕两个月后的1907年5月21日，这位英国籍匈牙利探险家再访时发现，狭窄的洞口已经"完全以砖砌封闭"；据说这是为了防止热切的香客进入〔22〕，但或许也是"特意防备〔他〕好奇目光"的措施。〔23〕法国汉学家伯希和于1908年来到莫高窟时，第17窟的门同样锁着，他也必须等王圆箓拿钥匙来见他。〔24〕

L01-P005-005 | 英文原文

[16] *Ibid*, pp. 803–804; see also Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 167; and Wang Jiqing, 'Aurel Stein's dealings with Wang Yuanlu and Chinese officials in Dunhuang in 1907', in *Sir Aurel Stein, Colleagues and Collections*, (ed.) H. Wang (London, 2012), p. 3. For an expanded version of this article, see Wang Jiqing 王冀青, '*1907 nian Sitanyin yu Wang yuanlu ji Dunhuang guanyuan zhijian de jiaozhu 1907*' 年斯坦因与王圆禄及敦煌官员之间的交往 [Stein's dealings with Wang Yuanlu and Dunhuang officials in 1907], *Dunhuang xue jikan* 3 (2007), pp. 60–76.

中文译文 | L01-P005-005

16 同上，第803–804页；另可参阅斯坦因所著《沙漠中的中国古迹》第167页，以及王冀青所撰《1907年奥雷尔·斯坦因与王圆箓及敦煌官员之间的交往》，载于H. Wang主编的《奥雷尔·斯坦因：同事与藏品》（伦敦，2012年），第3页。该文章的扩展版本可见王冀青所写的《1907年斯坦因与王圆箓及敦煌官员之间的交往》，发表于《敦煌学刊》第3卷（2007年），第60–76页。

L01-P005-006 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[17] Huang Zheng, *Jie chen yi zhu*, pp. 10–13; see also Wang Jiqing, 'Aurel Stein's dealings', p. 3.

[18] Ma Shichang 马世长 used the colophon written by Wang Zonghan on a painting from Cave 17 as proof. The dedication, which has been translated into English with the help of Hsieh Han-Lin, reads as follows: 甘肅敦煌縣千佛洞宋初石室所藏畫大士像。光緒卅年四月朔, 奉檄檢點經卷畫像, 迎歸署中供養。信士敦煌知縣王宗翰謹記。(Tang Dynasty painting of Avalokiteśvara stored in an early Song Dynasty cave at the Thousand Buddha Caves in Dunhuang county, Gansu. On the first day of the 4th moon of the 30th year of Guangxu, I took the official order to inventory the sutra scrolls and paintings and to bring them back to the government for offering). Recorded by the devotee Wang Zonghan, magistrate of Dunhuang. See Ma Shichang, '*Guanyu Dunhuang Cangjingdong de ji ge wenti*' 关于敦煌藏经洞的几个问题 [Several questions regarding Dunhuang Cave 17], *Wenwu* 12 (1978), pp. 22, 33, n. 3.

中文译文 | L01-P005-006

17 黄正《揭陈一珠》，第10–13页；另可参见王冀青《奥雷尔·斯坦因的交往》，第3页。18 马世长以王宗翰为第17窟一幅画作所题的题记作为证据。在谢汉林的帮助下译成英文的该题记内容如下：甘肅敦煌縣千佛洞宋初石室所藏畫大士像。光緒卅年四月朔, 奉檄檢點經卷畫像, 迎歸署中供養。 信士敦煌知縣王宗翰謹記。（即"甘肃敦煌县千佛洞宋初石室所藏的阿弥陀佛像。光绪三十年四月初一，我奉命清点经卷画作并将其带回政府供奉。信徒、敦煌知县王宗翰谨记。"）相关记载可见马世长《关于敦煌藏经洞的几个问题》，载《文史》12卷（1978年），第22、33页及注3。

L01-P005-007 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[19] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 15 March 1907, MSS Stein 245: f. 167.

中文译文 | L01-P005-007

19 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏的斯坦因1906年12月至1908年8月期间田野日记的打字稿，1907年3月15日的记录，编号为MSS Stein 245，页码f. 167。

L01-P005-008 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[20] The term 'shiye 師爺' refers to Jiang's role as a private assistant or private adviser, attending to secretarial duties for Stein.

中文译文 | L01-P005-008

20 "师爷"（shiye）一词，指蒋孝琬作为私人助手或私人顾问，为斯坦因处理文书事务的角色。

L01-P005-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[21] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 29.

[22] *Ibid*, pp. 165–166.

[23] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 803.

[24] P. Pelliot, 'Une bibliothèque médiévale retrouvée au Kan-sou', *Bulletin de l'École Française d'Extrême Orient* 8 (1908), p. 505; this was also mentioned in his travel diary on 27 February 1908; see P. Pelliot, *Carnets de Route, 1906-1908*, (eds.) J. Ghesquière and F. Macouin (Paris, 2008), p. 277.

中文译文 | L01-P005-009

21 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第29页。22 同上，第165–166页。23 斯坦因，《西域记》，第803页。24 伯希和，"在甘肃发现的一座中世纪图书馆"，《法国远东学院公报》第8卷（1908年），第505页；这一内容也见于他1908年2月27日的旅行日记，参见伯希和，《1906–1908年行记》，J. Ghesquière与F. Macouin编（巴黎，2008年），第277页。

原PDF第6页（原刊第826页）

L01-P006-002 | 英文原文

We have therefore seen that Wang, who was already acting as the self-appointed caretaker of the Mogao Caves, came to oversee the protection Cave 17 and its contents in a semi-official capacity in the years following his extraordinary chance discovery. Having attempted to alert several officials, he was instructed to provisionally look after the small cave and its contents, and locked it for safety. We will now demonstrate that he was assuming this role not as a lone Daoist monk, but rather as a well-integrated member of the local religious community, including resident Buddhist monks.

中文译文 | L01-P006-002

由此可见，原本就已担任莫高窟自行指定看管人的王圆箓，在偶然发现藏经洞的数年后，便以半官方的身份负责监管第17窟及其内的藏品。在试图向多位官员通报情况之后，他接到指示暂时看管这座小窟窿及其内的物品，并将其锁上以确保安全。接下来我们将证明，他承担这一职责并非作为一名孤立的道教僧侣，而是作为当地宗教团体中融入度很高的成员，其中便包括驻守于此的佛教僧侣们。

L01-P006-003 | 英文原文

Wang Yuanlu and the local Buddhist community

中文译文 | L01-P006-003

王圆箓与当地的佛教团体

L01-P006-004 | 英文原文

In 1894, the Russian officer and explorer Vsevolod Ivanovich Roborovsky (1856–1910) visited Dunhuang and noted that the Thousand Buddha Caves still attracted up to 10,000 worshippers every year.[25] Over a decade later, the annual celebrations that Stein witnessed on his way back from the Dunhuang Limes demonstrated that the caves, 'notwithstanding all apparent decay, were still real cult places "in being"'. A few Buddhist dwellers also resided at the site. When Wang Yuanlu first put down roots at the Mogao Caves, three temples were located in front of the caves: the upper and middle temples were already occupied by Tibetan monks, so he moved to the lower temple in the southern section of the site.[26]

中文译文 | L01-P006-004 | 原文注号：25、26

1894年，俄国军官兼探险家Vsevolod Ivanovich Roborovsky（1856—1910）到访敦煌，记下千佛洞每年仍吸引多达10,000名信众。〔25〕十余年后，斯坦因从敦煌边塞返回时目睹的年度庆典表明，石窟"尽管看上去处处衰败，仍是真正'在运作'的礼拜场所"。当地还住着少数佛教修行者。王圆箓最初在莫高窟定居时，窟前有三座寺庙：上寺和中寺已住着藏传佛教僧人，因此他搬入遗址南部的下寺。〔26〕

L01-P006-005 | 英文原文

Wang Jiqing has suggested that the lower temple was used for Daoist activities in the early 1820s, but that it later went unoccupied for a long time.[27] In 1907, Stein observed that Wang lived with two 'humble acolytes', likely the same two companions who went with him on begging tours, and that he appeared to 'spen[d] next to nothing on his person or private interests', channelling all the donations collected over the years 'upon [these] labours of piety'.[28] The perception that Wang was dedicated and selflessness was also confirmed in the 1980s by a member of the Dunhuang Academy, Li Zhengyu 李正宇, who had derived the same information from local stories.[29]

中文译文 | L01-P006-005 | 原文注号：27、28、29

王季清认为，19世纪20年代初那座下层佛殿曾被用于道教活动，之后却长期无人居住。27 1907年，斯坦因观察到王圆箓与两名"朴实的侍从"一同生活，很可能是当年与他一同四处化缘的那两位同伴；而且他似乎"几乎不为自己或私人利益花费任何钱财"，将多年来募集到的所有捐款都用于"这些虔诚的宗教事业"。28 20世纪80年代，敦煌研究院的研究员李正宇也从当地传说中获得了相同的信息，进一步印证了人们认为王圆箓为人专注且无私的看法。29

L01-P006-006 | 英文原文

Wang Yuanlu was continuing or joining efforts to rehabilitate the site that had started before his arrival.[30] As explained by the Russian army officer Vsevolod Ivanovich Roborovsky, limited repairs were already underway when he visited the Mogao Caves in 1894:

中文译文 | L01-P006-006 | 原文注号：30

王圆箓在继续此前就已启动的对该遗址的修复工作，或是加入了这些修复行动。据俄罗斯军官弗谢沃洛德·伊万诺维奇·罗博罗夫斯基的描述，他在1894年造访莫高窟时，就已经有有限的修复工作在进行之中：

L01-P006-007 | 英文原文

The *heshang* 和尚 [monks] living there (4 people) complain that the government is taking no measures to repair the caves, whereas private donations for the purpose

中文译文 | L01-P006-007

居住在那里的4名和尚抱怨说，政府并未采取任何措施来修缮洞窟，而私人却为此捐资。

L01-P006-008 | 英文原文

[25] I. Popova, 'S.F. Oldenburg's Second Russian Turkestan Expedition (1914–1915)', in *Russian Expeditions to Central Asia at the Turn of the 20th Century* (St. Petersburg, 2008), p. 163, http://www.orientalstudies.ru/rus/images/pdf/a_popova_2008d.pdf.

中文译文 | L01-P006-008

25 I. Popova所著《S.F. Oldenburg的第二次俄罗斯突厥斯坦探险（1914–1915）》，载于《20世纪之交的俄罗斯中亚探险》（圣彼得堡，2008年），第163页，网址：http://www.orientalstudies.ru/rus/images/pdf/a_popova_2008d.pdf。

L01-P006-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[26] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 27 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 315; see also Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, p. 82; Jacobs, *Compensations of Plunder*, p. 95.

中文译文 | L01-P006-009

26 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏的斯坦因田野日记手抄转录本，1907年5月27日的记录，编号为MSS Stein 204，页面为f. 315；另可参见荣新江所著《敦煌十八讲》第82页，以及雅各布斯所著《掠夺的补偿》第95页。

L01-P006-010 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[27] According to Wang Jiqing, Gusztáv von Kreitner (1847–1893), who visited the site in May 1879 with the Count Béla Széchenyi (1837–1893) and Lajos Lóczy (1849–1920), referred to two lamas, established already for 15 years at the Mogao Caves in his travel account, but he did not allude to the presence of any Daoist monks. Neither did the Russian explorer Nikolai Mikhailovich Przhevalsky (1839–1888), who came to Dunhuang a few months later. See Wang, *Guo bao liu san*, p. 8.

中文译文 | L01-P006-010

27 根据王继青的记载，1879年5月与贝拉·塞切尼伯爵（1837–1893）及拉约什·洛奇（1849–1920）一同前往该地的古斯塔夫·冯·克赖特纳（1847–1893）在游记中提到了已在莫高窟驻留15年的两名喇嘛，但并未提及有任何道士存在。数月后抵达敦煌的俄罗斯探险家尼古拉·米哈伊洛维奇·普热瓦尔斯基（1839–1888）同样没有涉及相关记载。参见王《国宝流散》，第8页。

L01-P006-011 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[28] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 168.

[29] Jin Ronghua 金榮華, *Wang Daoshi—Dunhuang wenwu wailiu guanjian renwu tanwu* 王道士—敦煌文物外流關鍵人物探微 [*The Daoist Priest Wang—Exploring the Key Figures in the Dispersal of Dunhuang Items*] (Taipei, 1993), p. 109.

中文译文 | L01-P006-011

28 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国古迹》，第168页。29 金荣华，《王道士—敦煌文物外流关键人物探微》（台北，1993年），第109页。

L01-P006-012 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[30] As early as 1772, a lama named Li Xinneng 李心能 and his disciple Yuan Xiu 源修 undertook to restore the Leiyin Temple 雷音寺 with the alms they had collected; see Wang, *Guo bao liu san*, p. 7.

中文译文 | L01-P006-012

30 早在1772年，一位名叫李心能的喇嘛及其弟子源修便利用所募集的善款着手修复雷音寺；参见王圆箓《果报流散》，第7页。

原PDF第7页（原刊第827页）

L01-P007-002 | 英文原文

are scarce. So far only 5 or 6 caves have been put right; entrances to them have been mended, wooden annexes built and *fanzas* for *heshang* repaired.[31]

中文译文 | L01-P007-002 | 原文注号：31

相关记载极为稀少。迄今为止，仅有5到6个洞窟得到了修缮：其入口已修补，还建起了木制附属建筑，并修复了僧人的居所。31

L01-P007-003 | 英文原文

In some of his correspondence, Stein referred to Wang Yuanlu as 'the priest chiefly concerned' with Cave 17,[32] which makes sense given the specific role he was entrusted with. His published narrative conveys the impression that Wang carried this responsibility with the awareness of resident Buddhist monks, who oversaw the care of the caves with him: 'The shrine, though full of Buddhist frescoes and sculptures, was in charge of a Taoist priest, the small fraternity of Ho-shangs [he shang 和尚] or Buddhist monks, to which our guide belonged, peacefully sharing with him the guardianship of the site.'[33] From this description, we gain a picture of Wang Yuanlu not only living alongside local Buddhist monks, but also collaborating with them towards the same ends.

中文译文 | L01-P007-003 | 原文注号：32、33

在部分书信中，斯坦因将王圆箓称作与第17窟"最为相关的僧人"32，考虑到他所承担的特定职责，这一称谓确实合情合理。斯坦因所发表的叙述给人的印象是，王圆箓在履行这一职责时始终意识到当地佛教僧侣的存在——这些僧侣与他一同负责管理这些洞窟："尽管该寺院里满是佛教壁画与雕塑，但实际上却由一位道教僧人掌管，还有那群由向导所属的霍尚们，即佛教僧侣，他们与这位道教僧人和平共处，共同承担着保护此地的责任。"33从这段描述中可以看出，王圆箓不仅与当地的佛教僧侣共同生活，还与他们通力合作，共同实现目标。

L01-P007-004 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

There is evidence that Wang granted them access to some of the items from Cave 17. As mentioned earlier, Stein had to wait before he could access the 'walled-up library' and take full measure of its treasures because Wang was not there when he first made his way to the Mogao Caves. In *Serindia*, Stein wrote that a young monk helped him and Jiang Xiaowan to locate the newly discovered hoard and agreed to show them one of the Chinese scrolls from Cave 17. The 'beautifully preserved' manuscript, 'with its fine texture and carefully smoothed surface', showed 'excellent penmanship' and had been lent to his spiritual master, a Tibetan lama, in order to give 'additional lustre' to his small private chapel.[34] Stein noted in his diaries that the specimen was brought by Jiang from the chapel of an absent monk and that a young monk acted as a guide—an account that appears to align with his published narrative.[35] A photograph taken in 1908 by Charles Nouette, the photographer of the expedition led by Paul Pelliot, also depicts a Buddhist monk engaged in ritual practice (Figure 2). He is standing before an altar on which he has set up a book, an incense burner, several statues, and a few other ritual objects. We can see paintings hanging in the background, two of which are now in the collections of the Musée Guimet in France.[36]

中文译文 | L01-P007-004 | 原文注号：34、35、36

有证据表明，王圆箓允许这些僧侣接触第17窟中的一些物品。如前文所述，斯坦因在最初抵达莫高窟时王圆箓并不在场，因此他不得不等待，才能进入那座"被封死的藏经室"并尽览其中的珍宝。在《西域见闻录》中，斯坦因写道，有一名年轻僧侣协助他和蒋孝琬找到了这一新发现的宝藏，并同意让他们查看第17窟中的一件中国卷子。那份"保存完好"、"质地细腻且表面经过精心打磨"的写本，具有"极为出色的笔迹"，曾被借给他的上师——一位藏族喇嘛，用来为其小型私人礼拜堂增添"光彩"。34 斯坦因在日记中提到，这份藏品是蒋孝琬从一名不在场的僧侣的礼拜堂中带出来的，而且还有一名年轻僧侣担任向导，这一记载似乎与他后来发表的叙述相符。35 由保罗·伯希和领导的考察队中的摄影师查尔斯·努埃特在1908年拍摄的一张照片中也展现了一名正在进行宗教仪式的佛教僧侣（见图2）。他站在祭坛前，祭坛上摆放着书籍、香炉、几尊雕像以及其他一些祭祀用品。背景中还可以看到悬挂着的画作，其中两幅如今收藏在法国的吉美博物馆中。36

L01-P007-005 | 英文原文

If these paintings indeed came from Cave 17, then this suggests again that local Buddhist monks used some of the cave's contents for religious purposes, presumably with Wang's consent.[37]

中文译文 | L01-P007-005 | 原文注号：37

如果这些壁画确实出自第17窟，那就再次表明当地的佛教僧侣在王圆箓的同意下，将该窟的部分藏品用于宗教用途。37

L01-P007-006 | 英文原文

That such a significant Buddhist complex—even one that had fallen into dereliction and relative disuse—ended up being overseen by a Daoist monk may seem surprising. One should remember that there probably was no real clear-cut divide between Daoism and Buddhism at the time. For instance, Stein remarked that the peoples of Dunhuang were 'attached with particular zeal to such forms of worship as represent Buddhism in the queer

中文译文 | L01-P007-006

如此重要的佛教建筑群——即便早已荒废、几乎不再被使用——最终却由一名道教僧侣负责管理，这似乎有些令人惊讶。需要记住的是，当时道教与佛教之间很可能并不存在真正明确的界限。例如，斯坦因就曾指出，敦煌的民众"以极大的热忱从事那些体现佛教特征的崇拜活动"

L01-P007-007 | 英文原文

[31] The text was translated and quoted by Irina Popova from Труды экспедиции ИРГО по Центральной Азии. Ч. 1. Отчет начальника экспедиции В.И. Роборовского [*Works of the IRGS Expedition to Central Asia. Part 1. Report of the Expedition Head V.I. Roborovsky*] (St Petersburg, 1900), p. 218; see Popova, 'S.F. Oldenburg's Second Russian Turkestan Expedition', p. 163.

中文译文 | L01-P007-007

31 该文本由伊琳娜·波波娃根据《IRGS中亚探险队著作。第1卷：探险队队长V.I.罗博罗夫斯基的报告》（圣彼得堡，1900年）第218页进行翻译并引述；另可参见波波娃所著《S.F.奥尔登堡的第二次俄罗斯突厥斯坦探险》，第163页。

L01-P007-008 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[32] Confidential report by Stein concerning the cache of ancient manuscripts at Dunhuang, British Museum Central Archives, CE 32/23/16/2.

中文译文 | L01-P007-008

32 斯坦因关于敦煌一批古代写本的机密报告，大英博物馆中央档案馆，CE 32/23/16/2。

L01-P007-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[33] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 29.

[34] Stein, *Serindia*, pp. 801–802.

[35] Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 16 March 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 169.

中文译文 | L01-P007-009

33 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第29页。

34 斯坦因，《西域记》，第801–802页。

35 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏斯坦因1906年12月至1908年8月期间的田野日记打字稿，1907年3月16日的记录，MSS Stein 204：f. 169。

L01-P007-010 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[36] The silk paintings are EO 3579, which represents the Amoghapaśa mandala, and EO 1146, which is probably the remaining top section of a mandala. I am very grateful to Roderick Whitfield, who helped with this identification, personal communication, 14 December 2023.

中文译文 | L01-P007-010

36 这些丝织画分别为EO 3579，为阿摩伽萨曼荼罗；以及EO 1146，很可能是该曼荼罗顶部剩余的部分。我非常感谢罗德里克·惠特菲尔德在鉴定工作中给予的帮助，个人通信，2023年12月14日。

L01-P007-011 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[37] This implies that it would probably have been difficult for Wang Yuanlu to sell these specific items to Pelliot without some level of awareness among the resident monks.

中文译文 | L01-P007-011

37 这意味着，若当地僧侣们没有一定程度的察觉，王圆箓很可能难以将这些特定物品卖给伯希和。

原PDF第8页（原刊第828页）

L01-P008-002 | 英文原文

Figure 2. Photo of a monk taken between 25 February and 27 May 1908, AP8586. Source: © MNAAG, Paris, Dist. RMN-Grand Palais/image musée Guimet.

中文译文 | L01-P008-002

图2. 1908年2月25日至5月27日期间拍摄的一名僧侣的照片，编号AP8586。图片来源：© MNAAG，巴黎，由RMN-Grand Palais/image musée Guimet负责发行。

L01-P008-003 | 英文原文

medley of Chinese popular religion'.[38] Whether Wang Yuanlu was truly Daoist has been debated. For instance, László Bárdi highlighted that Wang was cited in an alternative fashion as a Daoist or a Buddhist, and that some sources indicate he changed status over time from a Daoist to a Buddhist monk.[39] It is not uncommon for Daoist practitioners to also venerate Buddhist deities, such as Guanyin.

中文译文 | L01-P008-003 | 原文注号：38、39

"中国民间宗教的混合体"。38 王圆箓是否真正属于道教徒至今仍存在争议。例如，拉兹洛·巴尔迪指出，有文献将王圆箓描述为道教徒或佛教徒，还有一些资料表明他的身份随时间从道教徒转变为佛教僧侣。39 道教信徒同时尊奉观音等佛教神明的情况并不少见。

L01-P008-004 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

In fact, Wang Yuanlu was most probably initiated to the Longmen branch of Quanzhen Daoism, which was present at Dunhuang then and remains one of the largest Daoist sects in

中文译文 | L01-P008-004

事实上，王圆箓很可能是被引入了全真道教龙门派，该派当时存在于敦煌，至今仍是规模最大的道教宗派之一。

L01-P008-005 | 英文原文

[38] M. A. Stein, *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks: Brief Narrative of Three Expeditions in Innermost Asia and North-Western China* (London, 1933), vol. 1, p. 199.

中文译文 | L01-P008-005

38 M. A. 斯坦因，《关于中亚古代遗迹：三次深入亚洲内陆与中国西北地区的探险简述》（伦敦，1933年），第1卷，第199页。

L01-P008-006 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[39] L. Bárdi, 'Chinese assessment of Sir Aurel M. Stein's work', in *Aurel Stein Bibliography*, (ed.) I. Erdélyi (Bloomington, IN, 1999), p. 45, n. 1.

中文译文 | L01-P008-006

39 L. Bárdi所著《对中国人而言的奥雷尔·M·斯坦因的学术贡献评价》，载于I. Erdélyi主编的《奥雷尔·斯坦因书目》（印第安纳州布卢明顿，1999年），第45页，注1。

原PDF第9页（原刊第829页）

L01-P009-002 | 英文原文

China today.[40] Scholars have stressed that this particular branch of Daoism includes many elements that are indistinguishable from those of Buddhism.[41] According to Rong Xinjiang, the aim of Wang's restorations was to convert Buddhist halls into Daoist shrines.[42] While Stein's accounts referred to Wang's works as 'tokens of lingering Buddhist worship, genuine though distorted',[43] his travel diary did mention an 'invasion of Taoist imagery' in the shrines.[44] Wang's epitaph, inscribed on the tomb stone erected by two of his disciples in 1931, states that he was put in charge of the county's Daoist Association by the magistrate Lu Qian 陆前 in recognition of his merits. Importantly, the epitaph stresses Wang's genuine dedication to restoring the Mogao Caves, including the Buddhist statues, as well as his endeavour to convince people to contribute money towards these efforts.[45] As attested by a letter on red paper signed in his name, it seems that Wang Yuanlu even sent a plea for a large donation to the local administration following the transfer of Cave 17's remaining contents to Beijing.[46]

中文译文 | L01-P009-002 | 原文注号：40、41、42、43、44、45、46

《今日中国》40。有学者指出，这一派的道教包含许多与佛教毫无区别的要素。41据荣新江的研究，王圆箓进行修复工作的目的，是将佛教殿堂改造成道教祠堂。42虽然斯坦因将其所见的王圆箓的遗迹描述为"虽已扭曲但仍属于真实的佛教崇拜遗存"，43但他的游记中确实提到了这些祠堂里"充斥着道教意象"。〔44〕1931年，王圆箓的两位弟子为他立碑刻写墓志，其中称他是因功绩突出而由陆前县令任命为该县道教协会负责人。重要的是，墓志强调了王圆箓对修复莫高窟——包括其中的佛教造像——的真诚奉献，以及他为争取人们捐资支持这些工作所付出的努力。45有一封以他名义签署的红色信件为证，在第17窟的剩余文物被运往北京之后，王圆箓似乎还向当地政府请求提供大额捐赠。46

L01-P009-003 | 英文原文

It is therefore clear that being a Daoist did not preclude Wang from revering the Mogao Caves as a Buddhist site and devoting his existence to their upkeep. According to the stele 'Record of the Thousand Buddha Caves' Thousand Images Pagoda' by Ting Dong, Wang Yuanlu collected several damaged Buddha statues in 1910 and placed them in a specially built pagoda.[47] The pagoda was demolished in the 1940s and the artefacts it contained are now in the collections of the Dunhuang Academy.[48] There is further evidence that Wang Yuanlu's worship extended to the contents of Cave 17, particularly textual materials. We know of two instances in which he directly used the manuscripts from the cave for devotional and merit-making purposes. A document in the Dunhuang county archives dated to 1910 recorded that, in 1908, he 'loaded some Buddhist scrolls into two barrel-like containers, tightly sealed these and placed them on wooden poles inside a Buddhist hall, calling them sūtra-turning wheels'.[49] In 1944, the Dunhuang Academy also found 72 manuscripts inside a statue located in a Daoist temple built by Wang Yuanlu in the early 1900s.[50] Given

中文译文 | L01-P009-003 | 原文注号：47、48、49、50

由此可见，作为道教徒并不妨碍王圆箓将莫高窟视为佛教圣地，并毕生致力于其保护工作。根据丁东所著的《千佛洞记·千像塔》一文记载，王圆箓在1910年收集了几尊受损的佛像，并将它们安置在一座专门建造的塔中。47该塔在20世纪40年代被拆除，其中的文物如今藏于敦煌研究院。48还有更多证据表明，王圆箓的崇拜对象还包括第17窟内的各类物品，尤其是文献资料。目前可知有两次他直接利用该窟中的写本来用于修行积德之事：敦煌县档案馆中一份日期为1910年的文件记载，1908年时他曾"将一些佛教卷子装入两个类似桶状的容器中，严密封好后再把它们放在佛堂内的木杆上，称之为转经筒"。〔49〕1944年，敦煌研究院还在王圆箓在20世纪初建造的一座道观里的雕像内发现了72份写本。50鉴于此

L01-P009-004 | 英文原文

[40] Fan Guangchun 樊光春, '*Dunhuang Daoshi Wang Yuanlu pingzhuan*', p. 44.

[41] J. Abercombie, 'Syncretism in the Study of Quanzhen Taoism: From Essence to Argument' (unpublished PhD thesis, Whitman College, 2012), arminda.whitman.edu/theses/12 (accessed 18 July 2024).

中文译文 | L01-P009-004

40 樊光春，《敦煌道士王圆箓评传》，第44页。41 J. Abercombie，《全真道教研究中的融合现象：从本质到论据》（未发表的博士论文，惠特曼学院，2012年），arminda.whitman.edu/theses/12（访问日期为2024年7月18日）。

L01-P009-005 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[42] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, p. 83.

[43] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 169.

[44] Bodleian Libraries Oxford, entry for 29 May 2023, MSS Stein 204: f. 320.

[45] The tombstone is located inside a stupa containing the remains of Wang Yuanlu, near the Mogao Caves. Zhao Mingyu 趙明玉, '*Tai qing gong da fang zhang dao hui si Wang shi Fazhen muzhi*' 太清宮大方丈道會司王師法真墓誌, in Wei Juxian 衛聚賢, *Dunhuang shishi* 敦煌石室, Appendix 9, *Shuowen yuekan* 說文月刊 3/10 (1946), pp. 35–36.

中文译文 | L01-P009-005

42 龙，《敦煌十八讲》，第83页。43 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国古迹》，第169页。44 牛津博德利图书馆，2023年5月29日的档案记录，MSS Stein 204：f. 320。45 这块墓碑位于莫高窟附近、存放有王圆箓遗骸的佛塔内。赵明玉，《太清宫大方丈道会司王师法真墓誌》，载于卫聚贤《敦煌石室》附录9，《说文月刊》3/10期（1946年），第35–36页。

L01-P009-006 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[46] The letter is held at the Dunhuang Academy, under object number D0311. Referred to in Chinese as '催養經款草丹' or '王道士薦疏', it is signed by Wang Yuanlu and dated to the first to third years of the Xuantong 宣统reign (1910–1911). Some scholars have also suggested that the letter was addressed to the Empress Cixi 慈禧 or to an eminent Buddhist monk. I am grateful to Dunhuang Academy colleagues for this information and for showing me the document.

中文译文 | L01-P009-006

46 这封信件现藏于敦煌研究院，编号为D0311。在中文中它被称为"催养经款草丹"或"王道士荐疏"，由王圆箓亲笔署名，日期为宣统元年至三年（1910–1911年）。也有学者认为这封信是写给慈禧太后或某位高僧的。感谢敦煌研究院的同事们提供此信息并让我得以查看该文献。

L01-P009-007 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[47] This information is recorded in the stele 'Record of the Thousand Buddha Caves' Thousand Images Pagoda' (Ch. '*Dunhuang Qianfodong Xiangta ji* 敦煌千佛洞千相塔记'), dated to the second year of Xuantong's reign; see Fan Guangchun, '*Dunhuang Daoshi Wang Yuanlu pingzhuan*', p. 43. The stele, 112 centimetres high by 56 centimetres wide and 12 centimetres thick, is now in the exhibition centre of the Dunhuang Academy (collection number Z1114).

中文译文 | L01-P009-007

47 这一信息记载于宣统二年刻立的石碑《敦煌千佛洞千相塔记》中；参见范光春所著《敦煌道士王圆箓评传》第43页。该石碑高112厘米，宽56厘米，厚12厘米，现藏于敦煌研究院展览中心（藏品编号Z1114）。

L01-P009-008 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[48] Zhao Shengliang 赵声良, '*1943 nian Luo Jimei pai she Dunhuang shi ku zhao pian de yi yi*' 1943年罗寄梅拍摄敦煌石窟照片的意义 [The significance of Luo Jimei's 1943 photographs of the Dunhuang Caves], in Pengpai Xinwen 澎湃新闻, 23 October 2019, https://www.thepaper.cn/newsDetail_forward_4633619 (accessed 3 April 2024).

中文译文 | L01-P009-008

48 赵声良，《1943年罗寄梅拍摄敦煌石窟照片的意义》，载《澎湃新闻》，2019年10月23日，https://www.thepaper.cn/newsDetail_forward_4633619（访问日期：2024年4月3日）。

L01-P009-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[49] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, pp. 116–117.

[50] J.-P. Drège, 'Notes codicologiques sur les manuscrits de Dunhuang et de Turfan', *Bulletin de l'Ecole française d'Extrême Orient* 74 (1985), p. 489.

中文译文 | L01-P009-009

49 荣新江：《敦煌十八讲》，第116–117页。50 J.-P. Drège："关于敦煌与吐鲁番手稿的文献学笔记"，载《法国远东学院学报》第74卷（1985年），第489页。

原PDF第10页（原刊第830页）

L01-P010-002 | 英文原文

the public and communal nature of these activities, it is highly likely that members of the resident Buddhist community knew of them.

中文译文 | L01-P010-002

鉴于这些活动的公开性与群体性，当地的佛教信众很有可能知晓此事。

L01-P010-003 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

We can now see that Wang Yuanlu, who made it his mission in life to raise funds towards the upkeep and restoration of the Mogao Caves, joined ongoing initiatives that had begun long before his arrival and was deeply connected to the site's Buddhist monks. Upon finding Cave 17, he became responsible for safeguarding its contents, albeit as a representative of the local religious community at large. Both Wang and the resident monks established at the caves were using some of the cave's manuscripts and paintings for their ritual activities. Such information calls for a deeper foray into Wang's relationship with the contents of the small repository.

中文译文 | L01-P010-003

如今我们可以看出，将筹集资金用于莫高窟的维护与修缮视为毕生使命的王圆箓，其实早已参与到在他到来之前就已开展的各项活动中，并且与该地的佛教僧侣们有着密切的联系。在发现第17窟之后，他便负责保护其中的写本，只不过是以当地整个宗教团体的代表身份行事。王圆箓以及那些长期驻守在窟中的僧侣们，都在将窟内的一些写本和绘画用于他们的宗教仪式活动。这些信息让我们有必要进一步探究王圆箓与这个小型藏经库中所藏物品之间的关系。

L01-P010-004 | 英文原文

Wang Yuanlu and the contents of Cave 17

中文译文 | L01-P010-004

王圆箓与第17窟的藏经

L01-P010-005 | 英文原文

Contrary to what has been said, Wang Yuanlu was not illiterate. He possessed at least some rudimentary literacy and numeracy skills, as demonstrated by the fact he kept a list of the various donations he received.[51] The letter on red paper mentioned earlier in this article could have been written by Wang, even if it is unconfirmed. Furthermore, a Dunhuang manuscript in Ryukoku University's Omiya Collection bears two inscriptions that have been tentatively attributed to him by the scholar Fang Guangchang, which could be evidence of his ability to write Chinese.[52] Stein's assistant Jiang Xiaowan reported that Wang was 'ignorant of all that constitutes traditional Chinese scholarship'.[53] Ironically, the two of them were ill-placed to make this observation: Stein deplored 'the great hindrance created by [his] total want of Sinological training' when faced with the mass of Chinese rolls from Cave 17,[54] while Jiang struggled to make sense of their Buddhist content.[55]

中文译文 | L01-P010-005 | 原文注号：51、52、53、54、55

与以往的说法相反，王圆箓并非文盲。他有起码的基础读写和计算能力，他为自己收到的各类捐赠物品列出清单这一事实便足以证明这一点。51 本文早前提及的那封写在红纸上的信很可能就是王圆箓所写，尽管这一说法尚未得到证实。此外，龙谷大学大宫藏馆中有一件敦煌写本，上面有两处题字，学者方光昌暂定为其所写，这或许能证明他具备书写汉语的能力。52 斯坦因的助手蒋孝琬则称王圆箓“对所有属于中国传统学术范畴的知识都一窍不通”。53 具有讽刺意味的是，说出这种话的两人本身就并不适合对此评头论足：斯坦因在面对第17窟的大量汉语卷轴时，曾痛斥“自己完全缺乏汉学训练所带来的巨大障碍”；54 而蒋孝琬则难以理解这些卷轴中的佛教内容。55

L01-P010-006 | 英文原文

With the help of his local network, Wang Yuanlu might have had an edge over them in identifying some of the texts from the small cave. During his visit in 1908, the French Sinologist Paul Pelliot observed perfectly ordered Tibetan manuscripts enclosed in wooden covers. Relying on information from some Tibetan monks, Wang identified them as a form of Kanjur, which Pelliot interpreted as an early version of the Tibetan Buddhist canon: 'It seemed probable *a priori* that the perfectly ordered kia-pan, the only works in order in the whole library, represented a Kandjur; and this is precisely the information that the Wang tao gave me himself, based on the testimony of the lamas who have had access to the cave.'[56]

中文译文 | L01-P010-006 | 原文注号：56

借助自身的当地人人脉，王圆箓在识别那个小洞窟中的部分写本时或许比他们更具优势。1908年访问期间，法国汉学家保罗·伯希和观察到那些被木盒封装、排列整齐的藏文写本。王圆箓则根据一些藏族僧人的信息，将这些写本认定为一种“甘珠尔”；而伯希和将其解读为藏传佛教经典的早期版本：“从初步判断来看，整个藏经洞中唯一排列有序的这些写本很可能是甘珠尔；而这恰恰也是王道士根据那些曾进入过洞窟的僧人的说法亲自告诉我的信息。”56

L01-P010-007 | 英文原文

While this turned out not to be strictly true, as the volumes contained copies of *Perfection of Wisdom* sutras, the lamas were perhaps identifying the volumes as 'Kanjur' because of their appearance and because they contained important canonical texts. Such large volumes could have served a similar ritual function to Kanjur collections in local monasteries. In any case, this indicates that Wang was able to gather valuable knowledge through local sources.

中文译文 | L01-P010-007

虽然事实并非完全如此，因为这些卷册中其实藏有《般若波罗蜜多经》的副本，喇嘛们或许只是根据其外观以及其中包含的重要经典，便将这些卷册视为“Kanjur”。如此厚重的卷册在本地寺院中可能具有与Kanjur藏籍类似的仪式功能。无论如何，这都表明王圆箓能够通过当地渠道获取宝贵的信息。

L01-P010-008 | 英文原文

[51] Wang Yuanlu showed his accounts and his temple subscription to Jiang Xiaowan; see Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 168. When Stein went back to the Mogao Caves in 1914, Wang still kept a 'fine red book of donations'; see M. A. Stein, *Innermost Asia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia, Kan-su and Eastern Iran* (Oxford, 1928), p. 357.

中文译文 | L01-P010-008

51 王圆箓将自己的账目及寺庙捐款记录出示给了蒋孝琬；参见斯坦因所著《沙漠中的华夏遗迹》，第168页。1914年斯坦因再次前往莫高窟时，王圆箓仍保存着一本“精美的红色捐赠簿”；参见M. A. 斯坦因所著《最遥远的亚洲：中亚、甘肃及伊朗东部的考察详细报告》（牛津，1928年），第357页。

L01-P010-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[52] Fang Guangchang 方廣錩, '*Wang Daoshi mingcheng kao*', pp. 116–118.

[53] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 804.

[54] *Ibid*, pp. 821, 809: 'The limitations of my philological knowledge would not permit a rapid selection of what might be of special interest amidst these masses of Chinese texts.'

[55] *Ibid*, p. 802.

中文译文 | L01-P010-009

52 方廣錩，《王道士名稱考》，第116–118頁。53 斯坦因，《西域记》，第804頁。54 同上，第821、809頁："由于我的语言学知识有限，无法从这些大量的中文典籍中迅速筛选出那些可能具有特殊价值的资料。"55 同上，第802頁。

L01-P010-010 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[56] P. Pelliot, 'Une grotte médiévale retrouvée au Kan-sou', *Bulletin de l'École française d'Extrême- Orient* 8 (1908), p. 507: 'Il semblait probable *a priori* que les kia-pan parfaitement en ordre, les seuls ouvrages en ordre de toute la bibliothèque, représentaient un Kandjur; et c'est justement le renseignement que m'a donné de lui-même le Wang Tao, sur la foi des lamas qui ont eu accès dans la grotte.'

中文译文 | L01-P010-010

56 伯希和，《在甘肃发现的一处中世纪洞窟》，《法国远东学院公报》第8卷（1908年），第507页："初步看来，那些排列得极为整齐的经函——这是整个藏书库中唯一有序的书籍——很可能是一部甘珠尔；而王圆箓正是根据那些曾进入过洞窟的喇嘛的讲述，向我提供了关于它的信息。"

原PDF第11页（原刊第831页）

L01-P011-002 | 英文原文

There is further reason to believe that Wang Yuanlu's limited knowledge was sufficient for him to realise the importance of the manuscripts, paintings, and other relics that the cave contained. On numerous occasions, including some mentioned earlier, Wang gave away discreet batches from the newly found hoard to officials and dignitaries in Gansu, causing the early dispersal of Cave 17's contents from 1900 onwards.[57] In doing so, Wang was perfectly able to select the better preserved, most complete, and aesthetically pleasing specimens. He hand-picked several beautiful paintings and removed Buddhist and Daoist scriptures that not only were finely written, but also happened to possess a high scholarly value.[58] Pelliot's writings also reveal that there were copper statuettes in the cave, which Wang Yuanlu also used as gifts.[59] As stressed by Susan Whitfield, to find such exceptional specimens, Wang would have gone through a considerable number of items.[60]

中文译文 | L01-P011-002 | 原文注号：57、58、59、60

还有进一步的理由表明，王圆箓虽见识有限，却足以意识到该窟中所藏的写本、绘画及其他文物的重要性。包括前文已提及的几次在内，他多次将新发现的这些珍宝中的一部分悄悄送给甘肃当地的官员与权贵，从而导致从1900年起第17窟的藏品开始流散。57 在此过程中，他总能挑选出保存状况最佳、最为完整且最具观赏价值的物件——他会精心挑选几幅精美的绘画，同时取走那些不仅书写精良而且具有极高学术价值的佛教与道教经文。58 伯希和的著作中也提到过该窟中还有铜制小雕像，王圆箓同样将它们作为礼物送人。59 正如苏珊·惠特菲尔德所强调的，要选出如此出众的物件，王圆箓必定翻阅过数量相当可观的物品。60

L01-P011-003 | 英文原文

At some point between 1900 and 1904, Wang completely emptied Cave 17 before he received the order to put the whole 'collection' back in it.[61] During this process, he must have had the opportunity to form an overall idea of everything that had been deposited in the small room prior to its sealing-off. Because the scattering of the cave's contents started very soon after its discovery, this makes Wang Yuanlu the only person who was ever close to knowing their full extent and original arrangement. Stein wrote that Wang was looking for 'valuables'.[62] This somehow conveyed the image of Wang Yuanlu as an individual driven by greed. It would be more accurate to say that he was searching for valuable items, which could be understood in terms of their significance as well as their monetary value. Wasn't the British-Hungarian explorer himself drawn to the Caves of the Thousand Buddhas by the promise of Cave 17's hidden 'treasures'?[63] Wang could have decanted the cave to get a better understanding of what was in there, perhaps even to reorder its contents into an arrangement that he deemed more adequate.

中文译文 | L01-P011-003 | 原文注号：61、62、63

在1900年至1904年间的某个时候，王圆箓在接到将全部"藏品"重新放回第17窟的命令之前，已先将该窟内的物品全部清空。在这一过程中，他必定有机会了解这个封闭前的小空间里曾存放过的一切。由于该洞窟的物品在被发现后很快就开始散落，这使得王圆箓成为唯一几乎掌握其全部内容与原有布局的人。斯坦因写道，王圆箓当时正在寻找"贵重物品"。这种说法无形中将王圆箓塑造成一个被贪婪驱使的人，但实际上更准确的说法应是他在搜寻具有价值的事物，而这些价值既包括其重要性，也包括其经济价值。难道这位英匈探险家本人被吸引到千佛洞，不也正是出于对第17窟中隐藏"宝藏"的期待吗？王圆箓很可能是为了更清楚地了解窟内的物品，甚至可能为了按照自己认为更合理的顺序重新排列这些物品，才将窟内物品全部倒出的。

L01-P011-004 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Wang Yuanlu certainly did play a vital role in the organisation of Cave 17's contents when he rehoused them. Stein described what were two very distinct kinds of bundles in the cave: the 'regular' bundles, composed of uniform packets containing canonical Buddhist texts in Chinese and Tibetan that may have once belonged to monastic libraries; and the 'miscellaneous' or 'mixed' bundles, filled with fragmentary Chinese and Tibetan rolls, non-Chinese texts, paintings, textiles, and other ex-votos.[64] Wang had sorted and structured these bundles according to their type and physical characteristics. At the bottom, he had put several 'miscellaneous' bundles to 'what he thought appropriate use in turning the floor at the foot of the north wall and on either side of the clay platform into a foundation level with the latter'.[65] In his diary, Stein recorded that some of these bundles, which contained pictures and waste paper, may even have been placed there to keep off the damp.[66] He had then built on this base a 'wall-like array' of 'regular' manuscript bundles, above which lay

中文译文 | L01-P011-004 | 原文注号：64、65、66

王圆箓在重新整理第17窟内的藏物时，确实发挥了至关重要的作用。斯坦因描述了该窟中存在的两种截然不同的卷束：一类是"常规"卷束，由装订整齐的包袋构成，内含可能曾属于寺院藏书的汉文和藏文佛教经典；另一类则是"杂项"或"混合"卷束，其中装有零碎的汉文和藏文卷、非汉文文本、绘画、纺织品以及其他供奉物。王圆箓根据这些卷束的类型与物理特征对它们进行了分类整理。他在北墙底部及泥质平台两侧的地面之上，按照自己的设想对这些"杂项"卷束进行了处理，将其改造成与平台平齐的基底。斯坦因在日记中记载，其中一些装有图片和废纸的卷束，或许是被放置在那里用以防潮的。随后，他在这一基础上构建了一排类似墙状的"常规"写本卷束，其上方还摆放着其他物品。

L01-P011-005 | 英文原文

[57] Hundreds of items—both manuscripts and paintings—had been given to officials and other individuals before Aurel Stein arrived at Dunhuang in 1907; see Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, pp. 84–102.

中文译文 | L01-P011-005

57 在奥雷尔·斯坦因于1907年抵达敦煌之前，已有数百件物品——包括写本与绘画——被赠予了官员及其他个人；参见荣新江所著《敦煌十八讲》第84–102页。

L01-P011-006 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[58] *Ibid*, pp. 84, 100–101.

[59] These items proved particularly popular and were rapidly almost exhausted, but Pelliot managed to secure a few during his visit; see Pelliot, 'Une grotte médiévale', pp. 506, 528.

中文译文 | L01-P011-006

58 同上，第84页、100–101页。59 这些物品极为受欢迎，几乎很快就被卖空，但伯希和在访问期间设法弄到了几件；参见伯希和所著《一座中世纪洞窟》，第506页、528页。

L01-P011-007 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[60] P. Terzi and S. Whitfield, 'Reconstructing a medieval library? The contents of the manuscript bundles in the Dunhuang Library Cave', *Silk Roads Archaeology and Heritage* 1.1 (2023), pp. 56–76.

中文译文 | L01-P011-007

60 P. Terzi与S. Whitfield所著《重建一座中世纪图书馆？敦煌藏经洞内的写本卷束内容》，载《丝绸之路考古与遗产》1.1期（2023年），第56–76页。

L01-P011-008 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[61] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 182; Stein, *Serindia*, pp. 808–809.

[62] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 182; Stein, *Serindia*, pp. 808–809.

[63] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 801.

[64] *Ibid*, p. 814.

[65] *Ibid*, p. 823.

[66] Bodleian Libraries Oxford, entry for 28 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: ff. 317–318: 'During the Tao-shih [Daoshi]'s absence, I succeeded in digging down to floor in the NE corner. Here between the wall & base three bundles full of silk pict[ure]s, waste paper, etc., had been thrown down to keep off the damp! [...] No moisture in rock, but clay built base appar[ently] absorbs some from outside air.'

中文译文 | L01-P011-008

61 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第182页；斯坦因，《西域记》，第808–809页。62 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第182页；斯坦因，《西域记》，第808–809页。63 斯坦因，《西域记》，第801页。64 同上，第814页。65 同上，第823页。66 牛津大学博德利图书馆1907年5月28日的记录，MSS Stein 204，第317–318页："在那位道士离开期间，我成功地在东北角的地面处进行了挖掘。在墙壁与基底之间，有三卷束装满丝绸画作、废纸等物品的卷束，那些东西被扔在那里是为了防止潮湿！……岩石中并无水分，但显然由黏土构成的基底吸收了部分外界空气中的水分。"

原PDF第12页（原刊第832页）

L01-P012-002 | 英文原文

numerous irregularly shaped bundles with heterogeneous contents.[67] If anything, the way Wang rehoused the materials in the cave seemed careful and intentional, not haphazard.[68]

中文译文 | L01-P012-002 | 原文注号：67、68

许多形状不规则、内容各异的卷束。67 事实上，王圆箓将这些资料重新存放于洞穴中的方式显得十分谨慎且刻意，并非随意为之。68

L01-P012-003 | 英文原文

Whether to raise awareness of the pious efforts that were being carried out and solicit donations or to genuinely alert people to this extraordinary discovery, Wang Yuanlu hand-picked hundreds of fine manuscripts, paintings, and other artefacts, and gifted them to officials, triggering their slow dispersal as early as 1900. He may not have realised the full historical, cultural, and scholarly value of the objects contained in the hoard, but this is not to say that he did not consider them to be important. Wang knew better than anyone what was inside Cave 17 and carefully reorganised the bundles in a way that reflected, as we will see below, his very own appraisal of the newly found repository's collection.

中文译文 | L01-P012-003

无论是旨在让人们知晓当时正在进行的那些虔诚的整理工作并募集捐赠，还是真正想要让众人了解这一惊人的发现，王圆箓都精心挑选了数百件精美的写本、绘画及其他文物，将其赠予官员们，由此使得这些物品早在1900年便开始了缓慢的流散。他或许并未意识到这批藏匿物品所具有的全部历史、文化与学术价值，但这并不意味着他不认为它们很重要。王圆箓比任何人都更清楚第17窟内的藏品情况，他以一种精心安排卷束的方式对它们进行了重新整理，正如我们下文将看到的那样，这种方式反映出了他对这一新发现的藏经之宝的独特评价。

L01-P012-004 | 英文原文

Wang Yuanlu: disperser of Cave 17's contents

Aurel Stein's first visit to Dunhuang

中文译文 | L01-P012-004

王圆箓：第17窟藏品的散佚者 奥雷尔·斯坦因对敦煌的首次探访

L01-P012-005 | 英文原文

Aurel Stein first visited Dunhuang and the Mogao Caves Buddhist complex during his second Central Asian expedition (1906–1908). The selection and acquisition of paintings, manuscripts, and other sacred relics from the cave turned out to be a gradual negotiation process, dependent in large part on the goodwill of Wang Yuanlu. In the words of the British-Hungarian explorer: 'We never knew how long we might rely on the Tao-shih [Daoshi]'s indulgence.'[69] His writings reveal that Wang played a crucial role from the onset, determining to a large extent what Stein was eventually able to purchase. The whole transaction can be broken down in two distinct phases: the first phase unfolded between 22 May and 6 June 1907, while the second phase took place in around October of the same year.[70]

中文译文 | L01-P012-005 | 原文注号：69、70

奥雷尔·斯坦因在第二次中亚探险之旅（1906–1908年）期间首次造访了敦煌与莫高窟佛教遗址群。从这些洞窟中挑选并获取绘画、写本以及其他神圣遗物，其实是一个逐步协商的过程，且在很大程度上取决于王圆箓的配合意愿。这位英匈混血的探险家如此说道："我们始终不知道还能在多大程度上依靠那位道士的宽容。"69 他的著作表明，王圆箓从一开始就发挥了至关重要的作用，在很大程度上决定了斯坦因最终能够购得哪些物品。整个交易过程可划分为两个不同的阶段：第一阶段发生在1907年5月22日至6月6日之间，而第二阶段则是在同年10月左右展开的。70

L01-P012-006 | 英文原文

We will now explore Stein's dealings with Wang Yuanlu on each of these occasions.

中文译文 | L01-P012-006

我们现在将探讨斯坦因在这些不同场合中与王圆箓的交往情况。

L01-P012-007 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

When Stein and his secretary Jiang Xiaowan first came to the Caves of the Thousand Buddhas in March 1907, Wang Yuanlu was absent. However, they were shadowed by a young monk who revealed the location of Cave 17 and allowed them to examine one of the manuscripts lent to his master. Given how embedded Wang was in the small Buddhist monastic community at the site, he was most likely informed of the explorer's visit. As Stein waited in town for the local festival and the annual pilgrimage to the caves to be over, Jiang contacted Wang Yuanlu and asked him to wait for them at the Mogao Caves.[71] Therefore, when Stein returned on 21 May of the same year, Wang immediately came to 'welcome [him] at what for most of the year he might well claim as sacred ground entrusted to his own exclusive care'.[72]

中文译文 | L01-P012-007 | 原文注号：71、72

1907年3月，当斯坦因和他的秘书蒋孝琬首次来到千佛洞时，王圆箓并不在场。不过，始终有一名年轻僧侣跟随着他们，不仅告知了第17窟的位置，还允许他们查看交由他师父保管的一些写本。鉴于王圆箓与当地那个小型佛教僧团联系极为紧密，他很可能是早就得知了这位探险家的到访。在斯坦因于镇上等待当地节日以及年度朝洞活动结束期间，蒋孝琬便联系了王圆箓，让他到莫高窟等候他们。71因此，当斯坦因在同年5月21日返回时，王圆箓立刻赶来"迎接他——对于他而言，这片地方几乎一年中的大半时间都属于他独自负责照看的圣地"。72

L01-P012-008 | 英文原文

Stein's description of Wang was particularly unflattering, conveying the image of a shifty-looking, deceitful, and untrustworthy individual: 'He looked a very queer person, extremely shy and nervous, with an occasional expression of cunning which was far from encouraging. It was clear from the first that he would be a difficult person to handle.'[73]

中文译文 | L01-P012-008 | 原文注号：73

斯坦因对王圆箓的描述尤其负面，将他描绘成一个外表可疑、充满欺骗性且不可信赖的人："他看起来是个非常古怪的家伙，极为羞怯紧张，偶尔流露出的狡黠神情更令人望而却步。从一开始就很明显，他会是个难以打交道的人。"73

L01-P012-009 | 英文原文

This is somewhat hypocritical, as the explorer himself proudly reported, in his published accounts, how he was using subterfuge. The next morning, in an attempt to disguise the main objective of his stay, he 'avoided any long interview' with Wang and pretended to be

中文译文 | L01-P012-009

这实在有些虚伪，因为这位探险家本人在其发表的记述中还自豪地宣称自己运用了各种诡计。次日清晨，为掩饰此行的真正目的，他"避免与王进行任何长谈"，并假装……

L01-P012-010 | 英文原文

[67] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 814.

[68] When Stein started looking at some of the 'miscellaneous' packets placed at the bottom of the 'regular' bundles, Wang was visibly annoyed that he disturbed his arrangement and proceeded to fill the space with bundles that the explorer had already sifted through. See Bodleian Libraries Oxford, MSS 204: f. 318.

中文译文 | L01-P012-010

67 斯坦因，《西域记》，第814页。68 当斯坦因开始查看那些放在"常规"卷束底部的"杂项"包袱时，王圆箓明显对他扰乱自己的整理秩序感到恼怒，于是便开始用斯坦因已经翻阅过的卷束来填满那个空隙。参见牛津博德利图书馆藏手稿MSS 204，第318页。

L01-P012-011 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[69] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 188.

[70] For a thorough review of Stein's acquisitions of Dunhuang materials, see Terzi and Whitfield, 'Reconstructing a medieval library?', pp. 56–76.

中文译文 | L01-P012-011

69 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国古迹》，第188页。70 若想全面了解斯坦因所收集的敦煌文献，可参阅特尔齐与惠特菲尔德所著的《重建一座中世纪图书馆？》，第56–76页。

L01-P012-012 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[71] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 802.

[72] *Ibid*, p. 803.

[73] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 165.

中文译文 | L01-P012-012

71 斯坦因，《西域记》，第802页。

72 同上，第803页。

73 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第165页。

原PDF第13页（原刊第833页）

L01-P013-002 | 英文原文

absorbed by 'the survey of the main grottoes, and the photographing of the more notable frescoes'.[74] Yet, Stein was keen to 'ascertain the true character and approximate date of the collection' contained within the hoard.[75] He dispatched Jiang Xiaowan to 'sound [D]aoshi about MSS, wishing to prepare [the] ground slowly. Priest ready to show collection, & before evening S.[hiye] saw it, a large recess crammed full with MSS. to roof!'[76]

中文译文 | L01-P013-002 | 原文注号：74、75、76

他正忙于"勘察主要洞窟，并拍摄较为重要的壁画"。〔74〕然而，斯坦因急于"查明这批洞藏的真实性质与大致年代"。〔75〕他派蒋孝琬去"探询道士关于写本的情况，希望逐步作好铺垫。道士愿意展示收藏；傍晚之前，师爷便已看到了：一个大凹室里，写本直堆到屋顶！"〔76〕

L01-P013-003 | 英文原文

Stein had hoped to see the manuscripts 'in their original place of deposit',[77] but this initial conversation was not the open sesame they had expected. Wang Yuanlu consented, 'with various meticulous reservations', only to let Stein see 'such specimens of the collection as he might conveniently lay his hands on'.[78] The mere suggestion that the explorer may wish to acquire a few manuscripts caused Wang 'manifestly genuine perturbation'.[79]

中文译文 | L01-P013-003 | 原文注号：77、78、79

斯坦因原本希望能在"这些写本最初的存放地"见到它们，77但这次初步的交谈并未如他们所愿打开局面。王圆箓"带着种种细致的保留"才同意让斯坦因查看"那些他能够轻易拿到的藏品样本"。78仅仅想到这位探险家可能想要获取几份写本，就足以让王圆箓"明显地感到十分不安"。79

L01-P013-004 | 英文原文

Concerned that the promise of money might not overcome the religious scruples and fear of popular resentment that Stein believed motivated Wang Yuanlu's reluctance, he decided to pay him a formal visit.[80] He asked to see the restored Cave 16, known to be Wang's 'chief care',[81] as well as 'the pride and the mainstay of his [Dunhuang] existence'.[82] In a famous episode from his published accounts (not recorded in his diaries),[83] Stein sought to win Wang's trust by invoking the seventh-century Buddhist monk Xuanzang 玄奘:

中文译文 | L01-P013-004 | 原文注号：80、81、82、83

斯坦因担心，金钱的许诺未必足以克服他所认为的、使王圆箓迟疑的宗教顾虑和对民众反感的恐惧，因此决定正式拜访王圆箓。〔80〕他要求参观修复后的第16窟；那是王圆箓'首要关切'的地方〔81〕，也是他'〔在敦煌〕生活的骄傲和支柱'。〔82〕在他已刊记述中一个著名的场景里——他的日记中并没有这一记载〔83〕——斯坦因试图借提及七世纪佛教僧人玄奘来赢得王圆箓的信任：

L01-P013-005 | 英文原文

More than once before, my well-known attachment to the memory of Hsuan-tsang [Xuanzang], the greatest of those pilgrims, had been helpful in securing me a sympathetic hearing both among the learned and the simple. Wang Tao-shih [Daoshi], too, had probably heard about it. [...] I thought it appropriate to tell Wang Tao-shih [Daoshi], as well as my poor Chinese would permit, of my devotion to the saintly traveller; how I had followed his footsteps from India for over ten thousand Li across inhospitable mountains and deserts; how in the course of the pilgrimage I had traced to its present ruins, however inaccessible, many a sanctuary he had previously visited and described; and so on.[84]

中文译文 | L01-P013-005 | 原文注号：84

此前不止一次，我因对那位最伟大的朝圣者玄奘的深切怀念，而得以在学者与普通民众中都获得善意的倾听。王道士很可能也听说过这件事。……我觉得有必要在我的中文水平允许的范围内，向王道士讲述我对这位圣洁旅人的崇敬之情；讲述我是如何追随他的足迹，穿越荒凉的群山与沙漠，行程超过一万里里，从印度赶来；又如何在朝圣途中，找到了他曾到过并描述过的许多遗迹，即便那些地方如今已难以抵达，等等。84

L01-P013-006 | 英文原文

Late that night, Jiang came to Stein's tent bearing a 'small bundle of manuscript rolls' that Wang had secretly given him.[85] It must have belonged to the 'regular' bundles, for it contained several Chinese sutras, 'all neatly rolled up and enclosed in cotton wrappers'.[86] A note at the beginning of several scrolls in Chinese stated that they had been first brought from India and translated by Xuanzang, whom Stein called his 'Chinese patron saint'. Both Stein and Jiang Xiaowan assumed this auspicious sign could only be a coincidence since 'Wang Tao-shih [Daoshi] in his ignorance could have had no inkling, when he picked up those specimens, of their connexion with [Xuanzang]'s sacred memory'.[87] Was it just a lucky accident?

中文译文 | L01-P013-006 | 原文注号：85、86、87

当晚晚些时候，蒋孝琬带着一"小卷束写本卷子"来到了斯坦因的帐篷，那是王圆箓偷偷交给他的。85那应该属于那些"常规"的卷束，因为其中包含了几部汉文佛经，"全都整齐地卷起并用棉布包裹着"。86几卷汉文卷子的开头有注释，说明这些卷子最初是从印度带来的，由玄奘翻译，斯坦因称玄奘为他的"中国守护神"。斯坦因和蒋孝琬都认为这一吉祥的迹象只能是巧合，因为"王道士由于无知，当他拿起那些样本时，根本不可能意识到它们与玄奘的圣洁记忆之间存在关联"。87这真的只是幸运的偶然吗？

L01-P013-007 | 英文原文

[74] *Ibid*, p. 165.
[75] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 166.
[76] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 22 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 305.

中文译文 | L01-P013-007

74 同上，第165页。75 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第166页。76 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏的斯坦因1906年12月至1908年8月期间野外日记的打字稿，1907年5月22日的条目，MSS Stein 204：f. 305。

L01-P013-008 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[77] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 803.
[78] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 166.
[79] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 803.
[80] *Ibid*, pp. 804, 808.
[81] *Ibid*, p. 804.
[82] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 167.
[83] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 22 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: ff. 305–306.

中文译文 | L01-P013-008

77 斯坦因，《西天记》，第803页。78 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第166页。79 斯坦因，《西天记》，第803页。80 同上，第804页、第808页。81 同上，第804页。82 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第167页。83 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏的斯坦因1906年12月至1908年8月期间野外日记的打字稿，1907年5月22日的条目，MSS Stein 204：ff. 305–306。

L01-P013-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[84] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 169.
[85] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 807.
[86] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 23 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 307.

中文译文 | L01-P013-009

84 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第169页。85 斯坦因，《西里印度》，第807页。86 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏斯坦因田野日记的打字稿，1907年5月23日的记录，MSS Stein 204：f. 307。

L01-P013-010 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[87] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 807.

中文译文 | L01-P013-010

87 斯坦因，《西里印度》，第807页。

原PDF第14页（原刊第834页）

L01-P014-002 | 英文原文

It is unlikely: these fine manuscripts probably came from the 'regular' bundles filled with canonical texts, so Wang must have extracted them specifically. If the conversation about Xuanzang did take place that very afternoon, then it is worth considering whether Wang was using these scrolls as 'bait' to start the negotiations with Stein.

中文译文 | L01-P014-002

这种可能性很低：这些精美的写本很可能来自那些装满经典文献的"常规"卷束，因此王圆箓必定是特意将它们取出来的。如果那次关于玄奘的谈话确实发生在当天下午，那么就有必要考虑一下，王圆箓是否在利用这些卷子作为"诱饵"，以便与斯坦因展开谈判。

L01-P014-003 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

The following day, 23 May 1907, Wang Yuanlu finally opened the door to Cave 17, which Stein depicted as a 'black hole' where 'no examination of the manuscripts would be possible'.[88] It was agreed that Wang would continue to take out a bundle or two at a time and allow them to 'look rapidly through their contents in a less cramped and dark part of the temple precincts'.[89] A small room in the antechapel of Cave 16, sheltered from view, was turned into an improvised 'reading room' for Stein and Jiang, who had to work quickly for fear that Wang might change his mind.[90] Responsible for retrieving items, Wang Yuanlu began with the 'miscellaneous' bundles he had stacked atop the 'regular' bundles.[91] Stein thus looked through a 'large bundle of silk and cotton banners and prayer flags', two Chinese bundles, 'a large convolute of mixed papers', and 'one packet of large C[entral] A[sian] sheets'.[92]

中文译文 | L01-P014-003 | 原文注号：88、89、90、91、92

次日，即1907年5月23日，王圆箓终于打开第17窟的门。斯坦因将那里形容为'黑洞'，认为在里面'根本无法检查写本'。〔88〕双方商定，王圆箓仍每次取出一两束，让他们在寺院范围内不那么拥挤昏暗的地方'快速查看其中内容'。〔89〕第16窟前室一间不易被人看到的小屋，被临时用作斯坦因与蒋孝琬的'阅览室'；他们必须赶快工作，以免王圆箓改变主意。〔90〕负责取物的王圆箓，先拿出堆放在常规卷束上方的杂项卷束。〔91〕因此，斯坦因查看了'一大束绢、棉布旗幡及经幡'、两束汉文材料、'一大捆混杂的纸张'，以及'一包大幅中亚文纸张'。〔92〕

L01-P014-004 | 英文原文

The explorer remarked that 'it was mere chance, too, what bundles the Tao-shih [Daoshi] would hand [them] out'.[93] In fact, Wang was carefully planning what to deliver, focusing on the items he valued the least. The position of the 'miscellaneous' bundles made them easy to reach, but, more importantly, their selection was deliberate. While Wang Yuanlu appeared indifferent to Stein sifting through these bundles, he was by contrast eager to shield the regular ones from him: 'The secret hope of diverting by their sacrifice my attention from the precious rolls of Chinese canonical texts or "Ching" [jing 經] made him now more assiduously grope for and hand out bundles of what he evidently classed under the head of miscellaneous rubbish.'[94]

中文译文 | L01-P014-004 | 原文注号：93、94

这位探险家指出，"道士会把哪些卷束交给他们，这也纯属偶然"。实际上，王圆箓是在精心规划要交付哪些物品，他选择的是那些他自己认为价值最低的物件。那些"杂项"卷束的位置便于取用，但更重要的是，它们的挑选是经过刻意安排的。虽然王圆箓对斯坦因翻看这些卷束似乎毫不在意，但他却极力想保护那些"常规"的卷束不让他看到："他暗自希望通过牺牲这些物品，将我的注意力从那些珍贵的中国经典文献卷轴，也就是'经'上转移开，正因如此，他才更加卖力地搜寻并递出那些被他明确归类为杂项垃圾的卷束。"

L01-P014-005 | 英文原文

Thanks to Jiang's persuasion, Wang consented to letting them remove the items that they were putting aside, provided that they exercised the utmost discretion and acted in secret:[95]

中文译文 | L01-P014-005 | 原文注号：95

在蒋孝琬的劝说下，王圆箓同意让他们拿走那些被他们搁置起来的物品，条件是他们必须极为谨慎行事，并秘密进行。

L01-P014-006 | 英文原文

The Tao-shih [Daoshi] had summoned up the courage to fall in with my wishes, on the solemn condition that nobody besides us three was to get the slightest inkling of what was being transacted, and that as long as I kept Chinese soil the origin of these 'finds' was not to be revealed to any living being.[96]

中文译文 | L01-P014-006 | 原文注号：96

道士终于鼓起勇气答应了我的愿望，但郑重提出条件：除了我们三人，任何人都不得对正在进行的交易有丝毫察觉；只要我还身在中国境内，就绝不能向任何人透露这些“发现”的来源。〔96〕

L01-P014-007 | 英文原文

Wang Yuanlu did not want to be seen outside his quarters at night, so Jiang Xiaowan acted as courier, carrying documents back to Stein's tent while everyone else slept.[97] This demonstrates that Wang remained in control and dictated the terms of the transaction.

中文译文 | L01-P014-007 | 原文注号：97

王圆箓不想在夜间出现在自己的住处外面，因此由蒋孝琬充当信使，在其他人都在睡觉时将文件送回斯坦因的帐篷。这表明王圆箓依然掌控着局面，并能决定交易的条款。

L01-P014-008 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Stein spent five days working through 'miscellaneous' bundles, gathering items he considered of special interest: 'everything that possessed artistic or archaeological value, and

中文译文 | L01-P014-008

斯坦因花了五天时间翻阅那些“杂项”卷束，挑选出他认为具有特殊价值的物品：“所有具有艺术或考古价值的东西，以及

L01-P014-009 | 英文原文

[88] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 172; Stein, *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks*, p. 204.
[89] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 808.
[90] *Ibid*, p. 809.
[91] *Ibid*, p. 814.
[92] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 23 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: ff. 307–308.

中文译文 | L01-P014-009

88 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第172页；斯坦因，《关于中亚古代的踪迹》，第204页。89 斯坦因，《西域记》，第808页。90 同上，第809页。91 同上，第814页。92 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏斯坦因田野日记的打字稿，1907年5月23日的记录，MSS Stein 204，第307–308页。

L01-P014-010 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[93] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 182.
[94] *Ibid*, pp. 178–179.
[95] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 813.
[96] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 181.
[97] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 813; Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 181.

中文译文 | L01-P014-010

93 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第182页。94 同上，第178–179页。95 斯坦因，《西域记》，第813页。96 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第181页。97 斯坦因，《西域记》，第813页；斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第181页。

原PDF第15页（原刊第835页）

L01-P015-002 | 英文原文

whatever manuscripts in Indian or Central Asian languages could be traced'.[98] He was surprised and delighted that Wang 'raised no objection when [he] put aside rapidly "for closer inspection" the best of the pictures on silk, linen, and paper I could lay my hands on'.[99] He hand-picked some banners, paintings, and several manuscripts in Brahmi, Sanskrit, and Uyghur, written in a variety of formats. He also extracted any secular texts in Chinese, drawings, and woodblock prints that he came across.[100]

中文译文 | L01-P015-002 | 原文注号：98、99、100

"凡是能够找到的用印度语或中亚语言写成的写本"。98 令他惊讶且欣喜的是，当自己迅速将所能找到的那些绘在丝织品、亚麻布和纸张上的最佳画像"拿开以便仔细查看"时，王圆箓并未提出任何反对。99 他精心挑选了一些旗帜、绘画，以及用梵文、梵语和维吾尔文写成、格式各异的几份写本。此外，他还挑出了所有能找到的中文世俗文本、图画和木刻版画。100

L01-P015-003 | 英文原文

Despite the remarkable 'finds' already made, Stein was still intent on accessing the 'rampart' of regular manuscript bundles 'rising against the walls of the chapel'.[101] Wang Yuanlu was initially reluctant, resisting the 'heavy labour of clearing out the whole chamber' and the 'risk of exposure thus involved', but he eventually started removing the regular bundles with the help of an assistant.[102] As Stein's diaries hint, the prospect of a donation may have swayed him:

中文译文 | L01-P015-003 | 原文注号：101、102

尽管已经有了那些惊人的"发现"，斯坦因仍一心想要打开"紧贴着小礼拜堂墙壁而立"的那些成捆的普通写本"壁垒"。101 王圆箓起初并不情愿，他抗拒"清理整个房间的繁重劳动"以及由此带来的"物品暴露的风险"，但最终还是在一名助手的帮助下开始清理那些普通的卷束。102 正如斯坦因的日记所暗示的，捐赠的可能性或许改变了他的态度：

L01-P015-004 | 英文原文

During morning, Wang opened question as to donation for temple. Took up the theme in order to introduce question of purchase. No definite offer could be made until I had seen the full extent of the collection. So Wang, his helpmate and Sieh [Shiye] slaved all the afternoon in clearing out bundles of MSS. From cella.[103]

中文译文 | L01-P015-004 | 原文注号：103

上午，王圆箓提出给寺庙捐助的事。我顺着这个话题，提出购买的问题。在看清全部收藏的规模之前，我不能作出确定报价。因此，王圆箓、他的助手和师爷，整个下午都在辛苦地从洞室搬出写本卷束。〔103〕

L01-P015-005 | 英文原文

By nightfall on 27 May 1907, the entire collection of regular bundles had been arranged in neat rows in the cella of Cave 16 (Figure 3).[104] Stein and Jiang Xiaowan quickly selected items, without breaking pace to unfold scrolls or check their backs,[105] mindful that Wang Yuanlu was uneasy about their handling of material he clearly highly valued, particularly the Chinese sutras.[106] The operation also yielded an unexpected bonus, for several large miscellaneous bundles, placed by Wang Yuanlu at the very bottom, were now revealed. They contained exquisite silk paintings and textiles that Stein set aside among his 'selections'.[107]

中文译文 | L01-P015-005 | 原文注号：104、105、106、107

到1907年5月27日夜幕降临时，所有普通的卷束藏品都已整齐地排列在16号洞穴的小礼拜堂里（见图3）。104 斯坦因和蒋孝琬迅速挑选物品，他们毫不耽搁地展开卷子或检查其背面，105 因为他们知道王圆箓对于处理那些他显然极为看重的物品——尤其是中文经文——感到十分不安。106 这次行动还带来了一个意外的收获，因为王圆箓放在最底部的几大堆杂项卷束现在显露了出来。那些卷束里装有精美的丝织画作和纺织品，斯坦因将它们归入了自己的"精选物品"之中。107

L01-P015-006 | 英文原文

Having grown increasingly tense, Wang was now keen to conclude his proceedings with the explorer: 'While asking for a substantial subscription to his temple, he yet protested that any cession of sacred texts or "Chings [jing 經]"—and among these he classed all Chinese manuscript rolls, whatever their contents might be—was impossible.'[108] Stein then attempted to acquire the whole hoard, but Wang Yuanlu categorically refused, and his insistence only worsened the situation.[109] In his diaries, Stein wrote that Wang raised difficulties 'about [the] consent of donors',[110] further expanding on this in his published accounts:

中文译文 | L01-P015-006 | 原文注号：108、109、110

越来越紧张的王圆箓现在急于与这位探险家结束谈判：他在要求对方为他的寺庙提供大量捐款的同时，还抗议说绝不可能交出任何神圣的经文或"经"——他将所有中文写本的卷子，无论其内容如何，都归入这一类——。108 斯坦因随后试图收购全部藏品，但王圆箓断然拒绝，他的坚持只会使局势更加恶化。109 在自己的日记中，斯坦因写道，王圆箓就"捐赠人的同意问题"设置了障碍，110 而他在发表的记述中进一步阐述了这一点：

L01-P015-007 | 英文原文

[98] Confidential report by Stein concerning the cache of ancient manuscripts at Dunhuang, British Museum archives, CE 32/23/16/2.

中文译文 | L01-P015-007

98 斯坦因关于敦煌古代写本藏品的机密报告，大英博物馆档案，CE 32/23/16/2。

L01-P015-008 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[99] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 812.

[100] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entries for 23 to 27 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: ff. 307–315.

中文译文 | L01-P015-008

99 斯坦因，《西印度》，第812页。100 牛津大学博德利图书馆，斯坦因野外日记的打字稿，1907年5月23日至27日的记录，MSS Stein 204：ff. 307–315。

L01-P015-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[101] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 822.

[102] *Ibid*, p. 822.

[103] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 27 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 315.

中文译文 | L01-P015-009

101 斯坦因，《西印度》，第822页。102 同上，第822页。103 牛津大学博德利图书馆，斯坦因野外日记的打字稿，1907年5月27日的记录，MSS Stein 204：f. 315。

L01-P015-010 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[104] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 823.

[105] *Ibid*, p. 823.

[106] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 191.

[107] Stein, *Serindia*, pp. 823–824. The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 2 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: ff. 317–318.

中文译文 | L01-P015-010

104 斯坦因，《西印度》，第823页。105 同上，第823页。106 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第191页。107 斯坦因，《西印度》，第823–824页。牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏斯坦因田野日记的打字稿，1907年5月2日的记录，MSS Stein 204：第317–318页。

L01-P015-011 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[108] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 823.

[109] *Ibid*, p. 813.

[110] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 23 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 316.

中文译文 | L01-P015-011

108 斯坦因，《西印度》，第823页。109 同上，第813页。110 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏斯坦因田野日记的打字稿，1907年5月23日的记录，MSS Stein 204：第316页。

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L01-P016-002 | 英文原文

Figure 3. Image showing piled-up manuscript bundles and tables outside of Cave 17, in the corridor leading to Cave 16. Source: M. A. Stein, *Serindia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China, etc.* (Oxford, 1921), vol. ii, fig. 200.

中文译文 | L01-P016-002

图3. 显示第17窟外、通往第16窟的走廊中堆放着的写本卷束与桌子的图像。资料来源：M.A.斯坦因，《西印度：中亚与中国最西部探险详细报告》（牛津，1921年），第二卷，图200。

L01-P016-003 | 英文原文

The Tao-shih [Daoshi] persisted in urging with all signs of sincere anxiety that any deficiency in those piles of sacred texts was bound to be noticed by his patrons, whose publicly recorded subscriptions had helped him to clear and restore the temple; this would lead to the loss of the position which he had built up for himself in the district by the pious labours of eight years and to the destruction of his life's task. Former scruples reasserting themselves, he reproached himself for having given up sacred objects which his patrons had as much right to control as he had, and doggedly asserted the need of consulting them before taking any further step.[111]

中文译文 | L01-P016-003 | 原文注号：111

那位道士始终怀着极为焦虑的神情极力劝说，称那些圣典堆里若有任何缺失，必定会被他那些出资资助他清理与修复寺庙的赞助人发现；这不仅会让他历经八年虔诚努力才在该地区建立起来的地位丧失，还会毁掉他一生的事业。曾经的顾虑再度浮现，他责备自己交出了那些他的赞助人和他一样有权利掌控的圣物，并坚决主张在采取进一步行动之前必须先与他们商议。111

L01-P016-004 | 英文原文

When Stein went to skim through the regular bundles in search of interesting materials the next day, he realised that Wang Yuanlu had shifted almost all of them back into Cave 17 overnight. In his published accounts, he recounted how they had nevertheless reached a compromise, assuring him of 'fifty well-preserved bundles of Chinese text rolls and five of Tibetan ones, besides all [his] previous selections from the miscellaneous bundles'.[112] His personal diaries precise that Wang had left behind between 30 and 40 less well-preserved rolls and was only persuaded to 'extract from [the recess] about half of [the] finally selected bundles', amounting to '5 Tib[etan] rolled bundles; 3 large packets of Tib.[etan] pothis (among them two compl[ete] works & large portions of 7-8 others); 40 Chin.[ese] bundles (among them 2-3 misc.[ellaneous], 1 with frag.[ments])', as well as '6 large bundles of silk and other pictures'.[113] Now that the bundles were safely back in the

中文译文 | L01-P016-004 | 原文注号：112、113

次日，斯坦因前去略看那些常规卷束，寻找值得关注的材料，却发现王圆箓已在夜间把几乎所有卷束搬回第17窟。在其已经出版的记述中，斯坦因说两人最终仍达成了妥协，保证交给他"50束保存完好的汉文卷子和5束藏文卷子，外加此前从杂项卷束中挑出的全部材料"。〔112〕但他的私人日记具体记载，王圆箓留下了30至40卷保存较差的卷子，而且经劝说才同意"从〔洞室〕取出最终选定卷束的大约一半"，共计"5束藏文卷子；3大包藏文梵夹装写本（其中有2部完整作品，以及另外7—8部作品的大量部分）；40束汉文写本（其中2—3束为杂项，1束有残片）"，另有"6大束绢画及其他绘画"。〔113〕如今这些卷束已被安全地搬回

L01-P016-005 | 英文原文

[111] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 824.
[112] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 193.
[113] Bodleian Libraries Oxford, entry for 29 May 1907, MSS 204: f. 319.

中文译文 | L01-P016-005

111 斯坦因，《西印度》，第824页。112 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第193页。113 牛津博德利图书馆，1907年5月29日的记录，MSS 204：f. 319。

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L01-P017-002 | 英文原文

cave, Wang could choose again which ones he deemed acceptable to part with. For instance, he also presented the explorer with 'several broken bundles', and a 'large silk embroidered Buddha curtain, app[arently] lifesize'.[114] This is most probably the splendid embroidery of the Buddha flanked by two disciples now held in the British Museum collections.[115]

中文译文 | L01-P017-002 | 原文注号：114、115

在离开洞窟时，王圆箓可以再次挑选那些他认为可以舍弃的物品。例如，他还向这位探险家展示了"几卷破损的卷束"，以及一块"显然为真人大小的大型丝绸绣制佛帘"。114这很可能是如今藏在大英博物馆藏品中的、由两位弟子环绕的华丽佛像绣品。115

L01-P017-003 | 英文原文

Once the transaction was complete, Wang went to Dunhuang to beg for alms. Considering what he had said about his patrons' right to decide the fate of the manuscripts, he may have used this opportunity to ask them whether they supported his dealings with Stein. Stein's report notes that, upon coming back from town a week later, Wang seemed 'reassured that the secret had not been discovered, and that his spiritual influence, such as it was, had suffered no diminution'.[116] Perhaps encouraged by his sponsors' approval, Wang was sufficiently emboldened to let Stein purchase 20 regular bundles of manuscripts, with additional selections from the 'mixed' bundles.

中文译文 | L01-P017-003 | 原文注号：116

交易完成后，王圆箓便到敦煌城里募化。考虑到他曾表示施主有权决定写本的去留，他可能借此机会询问他们是否支持自己与斯坦因的交易。斯坦因的报告记载，一周后从城里回来时，王圆箓似乎"确信秘密尚未泄露，而且自己的宗教影响力，无论究竟有多大，都丝毫未减"。〔116〕也许受到资助者认可的鼓励，王圆箓胆子更大了，允许斯坦因购买20束常规写本，另外还可从"混合"卷束中挑选一些材料。

L01-P017-004 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

The explorer left the Mogao Caves on 12 June 1907, with seven cases full of manuscripts and five cases of paintings, embroideries, and other items:

中文译文 | L01-P017-004

1907年6月12日，这位探险家离开了莫高窟，带走了装满写本的七个箱子和装满绘画、绣品及其他物品的五个箱子：

L01-P017-005 | 英文原文

I had the satisfaction of seeing that the shy Tao-shih [Daoshi], honest in his own way, now breathed freely again. It seemed almost as if in a dim way he recognized that it was a pious act on his part to let me rescue for Western scholarship as much as circumstances would permit of those ancient Buddhist relics which local ignorance would allow to lie here neglected or to be lost in the end. When I finally took my departure from the 'Halls of the Thousand Buddhas', his quaint, sharp-cut face had resumed its customary expression of shy but self-contented serenity.[117]

中文译文 | L01-P017-005 | 原文注号：117

我欣慰地看到，那位性格羞涩、以自己方式行事而诚实的道士，如今又能自由自在地呼吸了。他似乎隐约意识到，让我在当地人的无知之下免于被忽视或最终遗失的那些古老佛教遗物，在条件允许的情况下为西方学术界拯救出来，是一种虔诚的行为。当我最终离开"千佛洞"时，他那张古朴、轮廓分明的脸又恢复了那种惯常的、羞涩却又自得安详的表情。117

L01-P017-006 | 英文原文

For Wang, the true 'pious act' was selling the cave's contents to fund the renovation work that preoccupied him. As he and other monks actively used the manuscripts and paintings for religious purposes, their 'neglect' was hardly a concern. Having been conflicted throughout his negotiations with Stein, Wang Yuanlu was undoubtedly relieved to see him go.

中文译文 | L01-P017-006

对王圆箓而言，真正的"虔诚行为"其实是出售洞窟内的物品，以此为他亟需开展的修缮工作筹集资金。由于他和其他僧侣都在积极地将那些写本和绘画用于宗教用途，它们被"忽视"根本不在他们的考虑范围内。在整个与斯坦因的谈判过程中一直心存矛盾的王圆箓，见到斯坦因离开无疑感到如释重负。

L01-P017-007 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

The second phase of Stein's acquisitions took place four months later, when he stopped at Anxi to retrieve the cases of antiquities he had left with the magistrate on his way back from Jiuquan. Through a messenger he sent a written proposal for further 'selections' from Cave 17, which was 'met with a cautious response'.[118] In his answer, received on 27 September 1907, Wang Yuanlu specified the price he expected per 100 bundles, already setting the tone of the transaction.[119] To avoid raising suspicions, Stein stayed behind and entrusted negotiations to his Chinese secretary.[120] Jiang Xiaowan departed for the Mogao Caves on 29 September with 600 taels, intending to reach the site by 2 October and to be back by the sixth.[121] On the evening of 4 October 1907, the convoy returned with four camels

中文译文 | L01-P017-007 | 原文注号：118、119、120、121

斯坦因第二阶段的取得活动发生在四个月后：他从酒泉返回途中在安西停留，取回此前交由县令保管的古物箱。他派信使送去书面提议，希望从第17窟进一步"挑选"材料，但"得到的答复十分谨慎"。〔118〕斯坦因于1907年9月27日收到的回复中，王圆箓明确写出自己期望每100束获得的价钱，已经为交易定下基调。〔119〕为免引起怀疑，斯坦因本人留下，将交涉委托给中文秘书。〔120〕蒋孝琬于9月29日携600两银子动身前往莫高窟，计划10月2日前抵达，6日前返回。〔121〕1907年10月4日晚，驼队带着四峰骆驼返回

L01-P017-008 | 英文原文

[114] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein field diaries, entry for 29 May 1907, MSS 204: f. 320.
[115] This item was given the number Ch.00269 by Stein and received the registration number MAS, 0.1129 at the British Museum.

中文译文 | L01-P017-008

114 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏的斯坦因田野日记打印稿，1907年5月29日的记录，编号为MSS 204：f. 320。115 斯坦因为该物品编号为Ch.00269，它在大英博物馆的登记编号则为MAS, 0.1129。

L01-P017-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[116] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 825.
[117] *Ibid*, p. 825.
[118] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 339.
[119] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 27 September 1907, MSS Stein 205: f. 90.

中文译文 | L01-P017-009

116 斯坦因，《西域记》，第825页。117 同上，第825页。118 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第339页。119 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏的斯坦因1906年12月至1908年8月的田野日记打印稿，1907年9月27日的记录，编号为MSS Stein 205：f. 90。

L01-P017-010 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[120] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 339.
[121] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 29 September 1907, MSS Stein 205: f. 91.

中文译文 | L01-P017-010

120 斯坦因，《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第339页。121 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏的斯坦因1906年12月至1908年8月的田野日记打印稿，1907年9月29日的记录，编号为MSS Stein 205：f. 91。

原PDF第18页（原刊第838页）

L01-P018-002 | 英文原文

heavily laden with manuscripts, having marched by night to avoid attention.[122] In his personal narrative, Stein recounted the 'secret mission' as a resounding success: 'How he had managed to secure the timorous Taoist monk, and to induce him for a very reasonable recompense to hand out at night over two hundred additional bundles of Chinese texts, was quite a dramatic story. The whole was managed most discreetly.'[123]

中文译文 | L01-P018-002 | 原文注号：122、123

斯坦因为避免引起注意，连夜行进，带回的物品里装满了写本。122 在他的个人叙述中，斯坦因将这次"秘密行动"描述为一次巨大的成功："他究竟是如何说服那位胆小的道士，并在给出相当合理的报酬后，让其在夜间交出两百多卷束中文文献的，这真是个极具戏剧性的故事。整个过程都处理得极为隐秘。"123

L01-P018-003 | 英文原文

The explorer's field diary offers slightly different insights. When Jiang reached the caves on 1 October 1907, Wang Yuanlu was away and had to be fetched by his 'famulus' on a donkey. Despite Jiang's efforts, Wang refused to reduce his price or agree to further sales. He was particularly unwilling to part with some Tibetan manuscripts, in which a group of lamas had expressed an interest:

中文译文 | L01-P018-003

这位探险家的野外日记则提供了略有不同的视角。1907年10月1日蒋孝琬抵达莫高窟时，王圆箓并不在，不得不由他的一个骑驴的"仆从"去把他请来。尽管蒋孝琬竭力争取，王圆箓仍拒绝降低价格或同意进一步出售。他尤其不愿交出一些藏文写本，因为有一群喇嘛表示了对这些写本感兴趣：

L01-P018-004 | 英文原文

It appears Tib.[etan] Mss. are to be taken over by some 6–9 red-robed Tib.[etan] monks who wish to keep them in a separate shrine. These men made Tao-shih [Daoshi] nervous. 200 bundles were taken out from dark hole without previous selection; but [Jiang Siye] says he rejected 'lan-di' ones. Packing done hurriedly within cave and sacks put on *shotas* within.[124]

中文译文 | L01-P018-004 | 原文注号：124

看来那些藏文写本将被六到九名身穿红袍的藏族僧侣拿走，他们希望将这些写本保存在单独的祠堂里。这些人让道士们感到紧张。200卷束写本在未经事先挑选的情况下就从那个暗洞中被取了出来；但蒋世业称自己拒绝了那些"劣质"的卷束。这些写本在窟内被匆忙打包，然后装进袋子，再把袋子放在马背上。124

L01-P018-005 | 英文原文

This passage demonstrates again that Wang was guiding the selection process and suggests that the local Buddhist community influenced negotiations, as Wang prioritised the monks' interests in this instance. Although Wang Yuanlu ceded a large share of Chinese and Tibetan manuscripts, he controlled the transaction at every stage. Jiang Xiaowan's rejection of several 'lan-di' (spoiled or decayed) bundles also indicates that Wang Yuanlu tried to release manuscripts of lesser value.[125] By contrast, when selecting gifts for officials, Wang had chosen particularly fine manuscripts, with beautiful handwriting and in excellent condition. Upon leaving Dunhuang in mid June 1907, Stein had taken with him over 90 bundles of manuscripts, containing about 1,200 separate texts in rolls or 'Pothis'. This new tranche of materials was even more significant: it comprised 230 of the regular bundles, 'rais[ing] the number of texts to close on 4,000'.[126]

中文译文 | L01-P018-005 | 原文注号：125、126

这段文字再次表明，王圆箓在指导挑选过程，并且暗示当地的佛教团体影响了谈判结果，因为在这一场合王圆箓优先考虑了僧侣们的利益。尽管王圆箓让出了大量中文和藏文写本，但他仍在每个阶段掌控着交易。蒋孝琬拒绝了若干“劣质”（已损坏或腐朽的）卷束，这也说明王圆箓试图处理那些价值较低的手稿。125 相比之下，在为官员挑选礼物时，王圆箓则选择了书写精美、状况极佳的优质写本。1907年6月中旬离开敦煌时，斯坦因带走了90多卷束写本，其中包含约1200份以卷或“Pothis”形式存在的独立文献。这批新获得的资料更为重要：它包含了230个常规卷束，“使得文献总数接近4000份”。126

L01-P018-006 | 英文原文

When Stein met Wang, he quickly understood that the preservation of the Mogao Caves was key to him. He saw in his pious endeavours powerful motivation to sell the contents of Cave 17, while Wang saw in Stein an opportunity to get money for the site's upkeep. Yet, throughout the ensuing transactions, Wang Yuanlu proved nervous and conflicted, especially about parting with the 'regular' bundles of Buddhist sutras. As we have seen, this was due to the high value the local religious community placed on these materials. Wang set the conditions for their 'exchange': he chose most of the bundles for Stein's examination, stipulated that the items be transferred at night in the greatest secrecy, and probably pre-selected the bundles presented to Jiang when he returned on his own.

中文译文 | L01-P018-006

当斯坦因见到王圆箓时，他很快意识到保护莫高窟对他而言至关重要。他在王圆箓虔诚的举动中看到了出售第17窟内物品的强大动力，而王圆箓则在斯坦因身上看到了为窟寺维护筹集资金的机会。然而，在此后的所有交易中，王圆箓都显得紧张且内心矛盾，尤其是在处理那些“常规”的佛教经文卷束时。正如我们所见，这是由于当地宗教团体对这些文献极为重视。王圆箓为这些物品的“交换”设定了条件：他挑选了大部分卷束供斯坦因查看，规定必须在夜间以最隐秘的方式转移物品，而且很可能在他独自返回时，已经预先挑选好了要交给蒋孝琬的卷束。

L01-P018-007 | 英文原文

Wang Yuanlu and Paul Pelliot

中文译文 | L01-P018-007

王圆箓与保罗·伯希和

L01-P018-008 | 英文原文

Less than a year after Stein, on 12 February 1908, Paul Pelliot arrived at Dunhuang, where he stayed until the beginning of June 1908. During his sojourn in Urumqi at the end of 1907, he

中文译文 | L01-P018-008

在斯坦因之后不到一年，也就是1908年2月12日，保罗·伯希和抵达敦煌，并在那里一直待到1908年6月初。1907年底他在乌鲁木齐期间，他

L01-P018-009 | 英文原文

[122] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 5 October 1907, MSS Stein 205: f. 94.

中文译文 | L01-P018-009

122 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏，为斯坦因1906年12月至1908年8月期间田野日记的打字稿，1907年10月5日的记录，编号为MSS Stein 205，页码为f. 94。

L01-P018-010 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[123] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 339.

[124] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 5 October 1907, MSS Stein 205: f. 95.

中文译文 | L01-P018-010

123 斯坦因所著《沙漠中的中国遗迹》，第339页。124 牛津大学博德利图书馆所藏，为斯坦因1906年12月至1908年8月期间田野日记的打字稿，1907年10月5日的记录，编号为MSS Stein 205，页码为f. 95。

L01-P018-011 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[125] The author would like to thank their two anonymous reviewers for suggesting that 'lan-di' might be Stein's transcription for 爛的, meaning 'rotten', 'decayed', or 'ragged'. This term would have denoted manuscript scraps considered of low value.

中文译文 | L01-P018-011

125 作者特此感谢两位匿名审稿人，是他们建议"lan-di"可能是斯坦因对"烂的"的音译，意为"腐朽的"、"衰败的"或"破旧的"；这一术语用来指代那些被认为价值较低的字写本残片。

L01-P018-012 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[126] British Museum Central Archives, CE 32/23/16/2.

中文译文 | L01-P018-012

126 大英博物馆中央档案馆，编号为CE 32/23/16/2。

原PDF第19页（原刊第839页）

L01-P019-002 | 英文原文

had heard of the newly found repository at the Mogao Caves complex and had been shown an eighth-century manuscript from Cave 17.[127] This had made him even more eager to reach the Thousand Buddha Caves, which were already on his itinerary when he left France. Once there, Pelliot also purchased a sizeable portion of the cave's contents from Wang Yuanlu. Stein may have been the first Western explorer to see the newly discovered cache, but I would argue that Pelliot's luck was to have come in second place. It may have resulted in his securing some of the 'rarest' pieces.

中文译文 | L01-P019-002 | 原文注号：127

他曾听说过莫高窟群中新发现的藏经处，还有人向他展示过来自第17窟的八世纪写本。这让他更加渴望前往千佛洞，而该地本来就在他离开法国时的行程之中。抵达后，伯希和也从王圆箓手中购入了大量洞内藏品。尽管斯坦因可能是首位见到这些新发现藏品的西方探险家，但我认为伯希和能居次位实属幸运，这或许使他得以获得一些最为"稀有"的文物。

L01-P019-003 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

By the time Pelliot came to the Mogao Caves, Wang had had several months to see whether there were any repercussions to selling crates' worth of materials from the small cave to Stein. The benefits must have outweighed the negatives, as he was ready to engage in another such transaction with Pelliot. According to the French Sinologist:

中文译文 | L01-P019-003

当伯希和来到莫高窟时，王圆箓已经过了数月时间，观察将大量藏品卖给斯坦因是否会有什么后果。显然收益大于弊端，因为他才愿意再次与伯希和进行类似的交易。据这位法国汉学家所述：

L01-P019-004 | 英文原文

Mr. Stein had worked in the cave for three days, and officially bought a certain number of manuscripts, with the knowledge of the local mandarin; the monk added that our colleague [Stein] had also personally left him a sum, which he said was plump, to get more [manuscripts]. A word to the wise; I knew for certain the procedure to adopt myself.[128]

中文译文 | L01-P019-004 | 原文注号：128

斯坦因先生在那个洞窟里工作了三天，在当地官员的知情下正式购买了一定数量的写本；那名僧人还补充说，我们的同事[斯坦因]还亲自留给他一笔可观的款项，让他去获取更多[写本]。给聪明人提个醒；我自己很清楚该采取何种做法。128

L01-P019-005 | 英文原文

There is no evidence that Wang Yuanlu ever made any sort of agreement with the local official—if anything, this is at odds with the discretion that Stein was asked to use during their interactions. Could this have been a lie that was meant to put Pelliot at ease and convince him to engage in a financial deal with Wang?

中文译文 | L01-P019-005

没有证据表明王圆箓曾与当地官员达成过任何协议——事实上，这与双方交往时要求斯坦因行使的自主权是相悖的。这会不会是一种谎言，意在让伯希和安心，从而说服他与王圆箓进行金钱交易？

L01-P019-006 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

While Wang Yuanlu had resisted giving Stein full access to the small repository, insisting on handing him preselected bundles of materials, he showed no such resistance when the Frenchman came. Interestingly, Wang no longer seemed concerned about people finding out what Pelliot was up to. He had asked Stein and Jiang to work in a screened room during the day and to remove materials 'for further examination' (knowing what this implied) at night, yet Pelliot made no mention of any such stipulations. For three weeks, from 3 March 1908, Pelliot used the small space left by the items Stein had removed, squatting inside the niche to examine as many items as possible. He was amazed to find many of the bundles still intact and sewn up.[129] During the first ten days, he managed to freely check up to 1,000 scrolls a day.[130] A photograph shows him crouching in Cave 17, with piles of materials behind him.

中文译文 | L01-P019-006 | 原文注号：129、130

虽然王圆箓之前拒绝让斯坦因完全进入那个小藏经处，坚持只交给他预先挑选好的卷束藏品，但当那位法国人到来时，他却不再有此类抗拒。有趣的是，他似乎也不再担心有人会发现伯希和在做什么。他曾要求斯坦因和江在白天在有遮挡的房间里工作，晚上则把藏品取出来"作进一步研究"（他心知其含义），然而伯希和并未提及任何此类规定。从1908年3月3日起的三周时间里，伯希和利用斯坦因搬走物品后留下的空隙，蹲在壁龛里尽可能多地检查物品。他惊讶地发现许多卷束依然完好无损且被缝封着。129在最初的十天里，他每天能够自由查看多达1,000卷子。130一张照片显示他正蜷缩在第17窟中，身后堆放着大量藏品。

L01-P019-007 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Several of Pelliot's selection criteria were similar to Stein's. He too prioritised scrolls written in languages such as Uyghur or Brahmi: 'My ignorance simplified the choice of non-Chinese documents. I distinguish many letters and their alphabet, but the meaning escapes me; to leave nothing interesting behind, I acquired everything.'[131] Pelliot sought to acquire most of the remaining Tibetan documents, putting aside 'about five hundred kilos of manuscripts dating back to the first four centuries of Tibetan Buddhism'.[132] He also focused on the Chinese manuscripts with dated colophons, non-Buddhist texts, and other historically significant documents. His mastery of classical Chinese enabled him to better sort through materials in this language, including non-canonical Buddhist texts. Unlike Stein,

中文译文 | L01-P019-007 | 原文注号：131、132

伯希和的若干挑选标准与斯坦因相似。他同样优先选择用维吾尔文或婆罗米文等语言书写的卷子：‘我的学识有限，这便简化了非汉语文献的筛选过程。我能辨认出许多字母及其字母表，但无法理解其含义；为确保不遗漏任何有趣的东西，我便将所有相关物品都收了下来。’131 伯希和试图获取其余的大部分藏文文献，仅留下了‘约五百公斤可追溯至藏传佛教最初四个世纪的写本’。132 他同时还关注带有日期题记的汉文写本、非佛教文本以及其他具有历史意义的文献。由于精通古汉语，他能够更高效地整理这类语言的资料，其中包括那些非正统的佛教典籍。与斯坦因不同，

L01-P019-008 | 英文原文

[127] P. Pelliot, ‘Trois Ans dans la Haute Asie: Conférence de M. Paul Pelliot au Grand Amphithéâtre de la Sorbonne, le 10 décembre 1909’, *Extrait du Bulletin du Comité de l’Asie Française* (Janvier 1910) (Paris, 1910), p. 13. The article has been digitised and is available on Toyo Bunko, http://dsr.nii.ac.jp/toyobunko/VIII-5-B2-12/, https://doi.org/10.20676/00000241.

中文译文 | L01-P019-008

127 P. 伯希和，《在高亚洲的三年：保罗·伯希和1909年12月10日在索邦大学大礼堂的演讲》，摘自《法国亚洲委员会公报》（1910年1月）（巴黎，1910年），第13页。该文章已被数字化，可在东洋文库网站查看，网址为http://dsr.nii.ac.jp/toyobunko/VIII-5-B2-12/，DOI编号为https://doi.org/10.20676/00000241。

L01-P019-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[128] Translated by the author; Pelliot, ‘Une bibliothèque médiévale’, p. 505.
[129] *Ibid*, pp. 506–507.
[130] *Ibid*, p. 505.
[131] *Ibid*, p. 508.
[132] *Ibid*, p. 507.

中文译文 | L01-P019-009

128 作者译；伯希和，《一座中世纪图书馆》，第505页。129 同上，第506–507页。130 同上，第505页。131 同上，第508页。132 同上，第507页。

原PDF第20页（原刊第840页）

L01-P020-002 | 英文原文

who had insisted on the ‘regular’ or ‘library’ bundles, Pelliot had little interest in them. He deliberately discarded the Chinese copies of the *Lotus Sutra* and the *Nirvana Sutra*.[133]

中文译文 | L01-P020-002 | 原文注号：133

由于伯希和坚持要那些“规整的”或属于“图书馆类”的卷束，他对这类东西兴趣寥寥。他故意丢弃了《法华经》与《涅槃经》的中文版本。133

L01-P020-003 | 英文原文

This may explain why he did not face the same resistance from Wang Yuanlu, who valued canonical sutras most highly.

中文译文 | L01-P020-003

这或许可以解释为何他并未遭遇王圆箓那样的抵制，因为王圆箓最为看重的是那些正统的佛经。

L01-P020-004 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Overall, Wang did not object to Pelliot's selections, but he did not let him acquire everything either. Pelliot was keen to have the huge Tibetan *pothi* stacked in perfect order in a corner of the cave that Wang Yuanlu identified as a form of Kanjur or Tibetan Buddhist canon.[134] Wang explained that a Mongol prince from Qaidam, who travelled to the Mogao Caves every year, had got into the habit of consulting them each time. He refused to part with them to avoid upsetting the regular visitor.[135] Despite protracted negotiations, Wang conceded only three volumes.[136] To divert the Sinologist's attention and safeguard these Tibetan copies of the *Perfection of Wisdom Sutra*, Wang Yuanlu offered Pelliot several paintings. He claimed that they were the best and had been set aside long ago.[137] Stein was likely correct in thinking that Wang had handed him what he considered to be 'rubbish'[138] because he had obviously held onto the items more important to him.

中文译文 | L01-P020-004 | 原文注号：134、135、136、137、138

总体而言，王圆箓并不反对伯希和的挑选，但也不会让他拿走所有物品。伯希和渴望将那些大量的藏文经卷以极其整齐的顺序堆放在第17窟的一个角落里，而王圆箓则认为那个地方适合存放甘珠尔或藏传佛教经典。134 王圆箓解释说，有一位来自柴达木的蒙古王子每年都会前往莫高窟，并养成了每次都去查阅那些经卷的习惯。为了避免打扰这位常客，他拒绝交出那些经卷。135 经过长时间的谈判，王圆箓最终只同意交出三卷。136 为了转移这位汉学家的注意力并保护这些藏文版的《般若波罗蜜多经》，王圆箓向伯希和提供了几幅画作。他声称那些都是最出色的作品，早就被搁置起来了。137 斯坦因认为王圆箓把那些在他看来是"垃圾"的东西交给了自己，这一看法很可能是正确的，138 因为王圆箓显然保留了那些对他而言更为重要的物品。

L01-P020-005 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

In August and September 1909, Pelliot travelled to Beijing to buy books for the Bibliothèque nationale de France. He brought a small selection of Dunhuang manuscripts, which several scholars examined and photographed. They formed an association to reproduce and publish the most important texts.[139] This marked a turning point, as Chinese scholars became aware of the value of Cave 17's contents. They petitioned the Qing Ministry of Education, which ordered in 1910 that the remaining manuscripts should be sent to Beijing for safekeeping. Unfortunately, there were several instances of theft and loss during their transfer to the capital.[140]

中文译文 | L01-P020-005 | 原文注号：139、140

1909年8月和9月，伯希和前往北京为法国国家图书馆采购书籍。他带去了一批敦煌写本，一些学者对这些写本进行了查看和拍照。他们还成立了一个协会，旨在复制并出版其中最重要的文本。139 这是一个转折点，因为中国学者开始意识到第17窟藏品的价值。他们向清政府的教育部门请愿，该部门于1910年下令将剩余的写本送往北京妥善保管。不幸的是，在这些写本转运至京城的过程中发生了多起被盗和丢失的事件。140

L01-P020-006 | 英文原文

Wang Yuanlu's attitude was markedly different during Pelliot's visit in 1908. Although it is often said that Pelliot gained better access thanks to his excellent Chinese, other factors were probably at play. By then, Wang had established his own boundaries regarding what could and could not be sold, possibly in accord with his lay patrons and the local monastic community. Furthermore, unlike Stein, who insisted on purchasing materials from the regular bundles, Pelliot was not interested in collecting Buddhist canonical texts, which may have reduced tension in his dealings with Wang.

中文译文 | L01-P020-006

在1908年伯希和到访期间，王圆箓的态度则截然不同。尽管人们常说伯希和凭借出色的汉语能力获得了更好的获取机会，但其他因素可能也起到了作用。那时，王圆箓已经就哪些物品可以出售、哪些不可以出售制定了自己的准则，这些准则很可能与他那些世俗的资助者以及当地的僧团有所契合。此外，与坚持要从规整的卷束中购买物品的斯坦因不同，伯希和并不对收集佛教经典感兴趣，这或许减少了他与王圆箓交往时的矛盾。

L01-P020-007 | 英文原文

Acquisitions by other explorers and Stein's second visit to Dunhuang

中文译文 | L01-P020-007

其他探险家的收购活动以及斯坦因对敦煌的第二次访问

L01-P020-008 | 英文原文

As we have seen, most of Cave 17's remaining manuscripts were transferred to Beijing in 1910. In the letter written on red paper mentioned in the first part of this article, Wang Yuanlu complained that he had not received the amount of money promised for his restoration work. He also mentioned 'donating' thousands of scrolls to Stein and Pelliot, although he was careful to use a turn of phrase emphasising the piety of this act.[141] This shows that

中文译文 | L01-P020-008 | 原文注号：141

正如我们所见，第17窟剩余的大部分写本在1910年被转运到了北京。在本文前文提到的那封写在红纸上的信中，王圆箓抱怨称自己并未收到承诺的用于修复工作的款项。他还提到"捐赠"了数千卷卷子给斯坦因和伯希和，不过他谨慎地使用了某种措辞来强调这一行为的虔诚性。141 这表明

L01-P020-009 | 英文原文

[133] *Ibid.*

[134] M. Lalou, 'Les manuscrits tibétains des grandes prajñapāpāramitā trouvés à Touen-houang', in *Silver Jubilee Volume of the Zinbun-Kagaku-Kenkyusyo* (1954), p. 257.

中文译文 | L01-P020-009

133 同上。134 M. Lalou所著《在敦煌发现的伟大般若波罗蜜多类藏文手稿》，载于《津文学研究会银禧纪念文集》（1954年），第257页。

L01-P020-010 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[135] Pelliot, 'Une bibliothèque médiévale', p. 507.

[136] In his travel diaries, Pelliot said on 12 May 1908 that he had only managed to buy one of these books; see Pelliot, *Carnets de Route*, p. 294. However, the post-scriptum to an article published in the same year indicates that he had secured three volumes; see Pelliot, 'Une bibliothèque médiévale', p. 529, n. 1.

中文译文 | L01-P020-010

135 伯希和所著《一座中世纪图书馆》，第507页。136 伯希和在1908年5月12日的旅行日记中称自己仅买到了其中一册，见其《旅途笔记》第294页；然而同年发表的一篇文章的附言表明他实际上获得了三卷，见伯希和所著《一座中世纪图书馆》，第529页，注1。

L01-P020-011 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[137] Pelliot, *Carnets de Route*, p. 136.
[138] See full quote earlier in the article; Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, pp. 178–179.
[139] Pelliot, 'Trois Ans dans la Haute Asie', p. 15.
[140] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, p. 106.
[141] Shuchen Wang, 'Atoms & Bits of Cultural Heritage: The Use of Dunhuang Collections in Knowledge Making, Nation Building, Museum Diplomacy, Cultural Tourism and Digital Economy' (unpublished PhD thesis, Aalto University, 2019), p. 57, footnote 15, https://urn.fi/URN:ISBN:978-952-60-8685-9 (accessed 30 July 2024).

中文译文 | L01-P020-011

137 伯希和所著《旅途笔记》，第136页。138 完整引文见该文章前文；斯坦因所著《沙漠中的中国古迹》，第178–179页。139 伯希和所著《在高亚洲的三年》，第15页。140 荣所著《敦煌十八讲》，第106页。141 王书臣所著《文化遗产的碎片与原子：敦煌藏经在知识创造、国家建设、博物馆外交、文化旅游及数字经济中的应用》（阿尔托大学未公开发表博士论文，2019年），第57页，脚注15，网址：https://urn.fi/URN:ISBN:978-952-60-8685-9，访问日期为2024年7月30日。

原PDF第21页（原刊第841页）

L01-P021-002 | 英文原文

Wang did not attempt to hide that he had given a large number of items to the two foreigners, even if he did not mention that he did so against payment. What he kept quiet, however, is that he had disobeyed official orders and secreted hundreds of items.

中文译文 | L01-P021-002

王圆箓并未试图隐瞒自己将大量物品送给了那两位外国人这一事实，尽管他没提及自己是未经报酬就这么做的。但他没有说出口的是，他违抗了官方命令，私藏了数百件物品。

L01-P021-003 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

In 1911–1912, Wang Yuanlu sold several hundreds of manuscripts from his stash to members of the third Ōtani expedition (1910–1914).[142] While waiting for Tachibana Zuichō 橘瑞超 (1890–1968), the leader of the expedition, Yoshikawa Koichirō 吉川小一郎 (1885–1978), began examining the Mogao Caves and taking photographs of the murals on 17 October 1911. At the site he bought two carved statues from Wang, who made a special journey to Dunhuang the next day to sell him some 'Tang sutras'. In December, Wang visited again, explaining that the country's turmoil would prevent him from getting funds from Suzhou's Yamen for the restoration of the caves. He was asked to come back with a better set of manuscripts and returned in early January 1912 with scrolls written in a script Yoshikawa identified as Mongolian and preferred not to buy. In his diaries, the Japanese explorer wrote that he suspected Wang Yuanlu of having made a secret arrangement with his landlord.[143] He also compared the attitude of the Daoist priest with Cave 17's Tang sutras to that of a thief 'carrying stolen goods'.[144]

中文译文 | L01-P021-003 | 原文注号：142、143、144

1911年至1912年间，王圆箓将自己藏匿的数百份写本卖给了第三次大谷探险队（1910–1914年）的成员。142在等待该探险队的领队橘瑞超（1890–1968年）到来的同时，吉川小一郎（1885–1978年）于1911年10月17日开始考察莫高窟，并为壁画拍照。他在现场从王圆箓处买下了两尊雕像，而王圆箓次日特意赶往敦煌，为他出售一些"唐经"。12月时，王圆箓再次前来，解释称国内的动荡使他无法从苏州的衙门获得用于修复洞窟的资金。他被告知要带更多更好的写本回来，于是于1912年1月初带着一些卷子返回，那些卷子上的文字是吉川小一郎认定为蒙古文体的，而他并不打算购买。这位日本探险家在日记中写道，他怀疑王圆箓与自己的房东暗中做了交易。143他还将这位道教道士的态度与第17窟的唐经相比，称其就像"携带赃物"的小偷。144

L01-P021-004 | 英文原文

After months of delay, Tachibana Zuichō finally arrived in Dunhuang and went to the Mogao Caves with Yoshikawa. They bought 169 scrolls and asked Wang Yuanlu to bring better manuscripts. Wang came back with 200 additional items, some of which they thought were forgeries, prompting them to sort the scrolls into three categories by quality. On 4 February 1912, Wang brought another batch of 200 Buddhist scrolls in Chinese that Yoshikawa and Tachibana also purchased.[145] They left town a few days later. Yoshikawa returned to Dunhuang on his own in February 1913 and acquired approximately 80 scrolls from Wang.[146] A large proportion of these were Tibetan copies of the *Aparamitayus Sutra*, which would presumably have been in the regular 'library' bundles.[147]

中文译文 | L01-P021-004 | 原文注号：145、146、147

经过数月的拖延，橘瑞超终于抵达敦煌，并与吉川小一郎一同前往莫高窟。他们购买了169卷卷子，并让王圆箓再带更好的写本过来。王圆箓又带来了200件物品，其中一些被他们认为是仿制品，这促使他们按照质量将那些卷子分为三类。1912年2月4日，王圆箓又带来了一批共200卷的中文佛教卷子，吉川小一郎和橘瑞超也将其买下。145几天后他们离开了敦煌。1913年2月，吉川小一郎独自再次前往敦煌，从王圆箓处获得了大约80卷卷子。146其中很大一部分是《无量寿经》的藏文抄本，这些很可能是原本存放在常规"图书馆"卷束中的。147

L01-P021-005 | 英文原文

When Stein stopped at Dunhuang again in 1914, during his third Central Asian expedition (1913–1916), Wang was still in possession of manuscripts from Cave 17. Wang Yuanlu welcomed Stein to town and cordially invited him to the Mogao Caves, hinting that his own store of ancient manuscripts had not yet been exhausted.[148] Wang also told him 'with a bitterness only too justified' that he had received none of the large sum assigned by the Central Government as compensation for the removal of the manuscripts.[149] The money had vanished on the way, 'duly absorbed in transit through various offices',[150] and he regretted 'not having previously had the courage and wisdom to accept the big offer that [Stein] had

中文译文 | L01-P021-005 | 原文注号：148、149、150

1914年，也就是斯坦因进行第三次中亚探险（1913–1916年）期间，当他再次驻足敦煌时，王圆箓仍持有来自第17窟的写本。王圆箓热情地欢迎斯坦因来到敦煌，并诚挚地邀请他前往莫高窟，暗示自己收藏的古代写本还远未用尽。148他还"带着完全有理由的愤懑"告诉斯坦因，他根本没有收到中央政府为补偿这些写本的取出而拨付的那笔巨额款项。149那笔钱在转运过程中就消失了，"在经过各个机构时被合理地扣下了"，150他后悔"此前没有足够的勇气和智慧去接受[斯坦因]给出的那份丰厚提议"。

L01-P021-006 | 英文原文

[142] Wang was not the only person with manuscripts for sale. The diaries of Yoshikawa Koichirō reveal that he was offered a scroll by the head of the Anxi Telegraph Office even before reaching Dunhuang in 1911. He also purchased a smaller number of manuscripts from several locals, including a farm labourer and a Chinese merchant. Imre Galambos, 'The third Ōtani expedition at Dunhuang: acquisition of the Japanese collection of Dunhuang manuscripts', *Journal of Inner Asian Art and Archaeology* 3 (2008): pp. 30–31. Ueyama Daishun, 'How I came to be convinced that the Ōtani collection contains forged manuscripts', in *Dunhuang Manuscripts Forgeries,* (ed.) S. Whitfield (London, 2002), pp. 316–320.

中文译文 | L01-P021-006

142 王圆箓并非唯一一个有写本待售的人。吉川幸一郎的日记显示，早在1911年抵达敦煌之前，安西电报局局长就曾向他提供过一卷子。他还从包括一名农夫和一名中国商人在内的几名当地人手中购入了少量写本。Imre Galambos，《第三次大谷探险队赴敦煌：日本敦煌写本藏品的收购》，《内亚艺术与考古学杂志》第3期（2008年）：第30–31页。Ueyama Daishun，《我为何确信大谷藏品中存在伪造写本》，载于S. Whitfield编著的《敦煌写本伪造案》（伦敦，2002年），第316–320页。

L01-P021-007 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[143] Galambos, 'Third Ōtani expedition at Dunhuang', pp. 30–31.
[144] English translation from Yoshikawa Koichirō's diary. See Daishun, 'How I came to be convinced', p. 317.
[145] *Ibid*, pp. 317–8. See also Galambos, 'Third Ōtani expedition at Dunhuang', p. 31.
[146] *Ibid*, p. 32. The author found the precise number of manuscripts in an interview given by Yoshikawa Koichirō 70 years after the events. See also Hao Chunwen, *Dunhuang Manuscripts: An Introduction to Texts from the Silk Road*, (trans.) S. Teiser (Diamond Bar, CA, 2020), p. 51.

中文译文 | L01-P021-007

143 Galambos，《第三次大谷探险队赴敦煌》，第30–31页。144 为吉川幸一郎日记的英文译文，参见Daishun所著《我为何确信》，第317页。145 同上，第317–318页。另可参见Galambos所著《第三次大谷探险队赴敦煌》，第31页。146 同上，第32页。作者在吉川幸一郎于那些事件发生70年后接受的一次采访中得知了写本的确切数量。另可参见Hao Chunwen所著《敦煌写本：丝绸之路文本导论》（S. Teiser译，加利福尼亚州戴蒙德巴尔，2020年），第51页。

L01-P021-008 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[147] Shang Lin 尚林, Fang Guangchang 方廣錩, and Rong Xinjiang 荣新江, *Zhongguo suocang Dagu shoujipin gaikuang: tebie yi Dunhuang xiejing wei zhongxin* 中國所藏集品概況—特別以敦煌寫經為中心 (Kyoto, 1991).

中文译文 | L01-P021-008

147 尚林、方廣錩与荣新江合著的《中国所藏集品概况—特别以敦煌写经为中心》（京都，1991年）。

L01-P021-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[148] Stein, *Innermost Asia*, p. 356.
[149] *Ibid*, p. 355.
[150] Stein, *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks*, p. 210.

中文译文 | L01-P021-009

148 斯坦因，《最内陆的亚洲》，第356页。149 同上，第355页。150 斯坦因，《关于古代中亚的遗迹》，第210页。

原PDF第22页（原刊第842页）

L01-P022-002 | 英文原文

made through Jiang S[h]iye for the whole collection *en bloc*'.[151] Wang Yuanlu's patrons felt the same and were probably aware of his actions. As Stein wrote:

中文译文 | L01-P022-002 | 原文注号：151

是通过蒋师爷为整个藏经洞藏量整体办理的。'151 王圆箓的资助者们也有相同看法，很可能也知晓他的行为。正如斯坦因所写：

L01-P022-003 | 英文原文

His devout clientèle among the Tun-huang population, seeing how well he had laid out the sums received, first from myself and then from Pei Ta jên, i.e. M. Pelliot, in building new gaudy chapels and a large, comfortable hospice, seemed to agree in sharing his feelings. They, no doubt, fully approved too of the shrewd precaution which the honest Taoist monk had taken against the official spoliation of the temple becoming too complete.[152]

中文译文 | L01-P022-003 | 原文注号：152

他在敦煌当地的虔诚信众们，看到他如何妥善使用从我这里以及后来从佩蒂安先生，也就是伯希和那里获得的资金，用来建造崭新的华丽礼拜堂和一座宽敞舒适的救济院，似乎也认同他的感受。毫无疑问，他们也完全赞同这位诚实的道士为防止寺庙遭到过度官方掠夺而采取的明智预防措施。152

L01-P022-004 | 英文原文

Stein made his way to the site on 2 April 1914. The following day, he received confirmation that Wang had indeed put away a 'nest egg' of Chinese manuscripts.[153] Wang showed him two large boxes crammed with sutra rolls whose handwriting, high-quality paper, Buddhist content, and dating indicated they came from the 'regular' bundles that 'Wang Tao-shih [Daoshi], under the influence of quasi-religious scruples, had in 1907 been least willing to part.'[154] Almost all these scrolls, Stein noted, were large (often complete) and in remarkably good condition.[155] Wang had deliberately retained the finest specimens, displaying the very qualities that had guided his choice of gifts for Gansu officials as early as 1900.

中文译文 | L01-P022-004 | 原文注号：153、154、155

斯坦因于1914年4月2日赶到了现场。次日，他得到确认，王圆箓确实藏有一批中国写本作为"私藏"。153 王圆箓给他看了两个装满经卷卷轴的大箱子，从这些卷轴的笔迹、优质纸张、佛教内容以及年代来看，它们都属于那些"王道士在近乎宗教性的顾忌驱使下，于1907年最不愿舍弃的'常规'卷束"。154 斯坦因指出，这些卷子几乎全是大型卷轴（往往为完整卷轴），且保存状况极为良好。155 王圆箓刻意保留了最精美的样本，这些样本恰恰体现了早在1900年他为甘肃官员挑选礼物时所依据的标准。

L01-P022-005 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

This time, Stein did not 'reasonably hope for any finds of outstanding importance', since Pelliot had likely examined most of the manuscripts and selected all the non-Chinese texts, along with any Chinese texts of obvious interest.[156] Frustratingly for Stein, however, Wang Yuanlu now demanded a much higher 'donation' than in 1907. Not only had Wang learned from his dealings with other explorers, but he also wanted appropriate compensation for scrolls he regarded as especially valuable:

中文译文 | L01-P022-005 | 原文注号：156

这一次，斯坦因并不"合理地期望能发现任何具有重大价值的物品"，因为伯希和很可能已经检查过大部分写本，并选走了所有非中文文本以及所有明显有价值的中文文本。156 然而令斯坦因沮丧的是，王圆箓现在要求的"捐赠"金额比1907年高得多。他不仅从与其他探险家的交往中积累了经验，还希望为自己认为特别珍贵的卷轴获得相应的补偿：

L01-P022-006 | 英文原文

his shrewd sense of business had been awakened by the payments received from subsequent visitors to a keener comprehension of the money value of what he retained. He consequently held out at first for a price per roll which, being about four times as much as that paid on the occasion of [Jiang Shiye 師爺]'s big haul of October, 1907, seemed distinctly too high. No doubt Wang's estimate was greatly influenced by the fact that the rolls he was now prepared to part with were almost all large ones and particularly well preserved.[157]

中文译文 | L01-P022-006 | 原文注号：157

后来有其他探访者带来的款项让他敏锐的经商意识觉醒，使他更清楚地认识到自己所保留物品的金钱价值。因此他一开始要求的每卷价格大约是1907年10月[蒋师爷]那次大批获取写本时支付价格的四倍，显然过高了。毫无疑问，王圆箓的估价在很大程度上受到了他此次准备出售的卷轴几乎全是大型且保存特别完好这一事实的影响。157

L01-P022-007 | 英文原文

In the end, Stein purchased 570 Buddhist manuscripts, filling a total of five cases, 'each as large as a pony could conveniently carry'.[158] What he acquired was once again shaped by Wang Yuanlu, who had mainly Buddhist canonical texts in Chinese, some dating as early as the fifth and sixth centuries. In addition, to seal their deal, he also presented him with a collection of relief stucco plaques that he had supposedly found in another cave.[159]

中文译文 | L01-P022-007 | 原文注号：158、159

最终，斯坦因购买了570份佛教写本，这些写本装满了五个箱子，"每个箱子的大小都刚好适合一匹小马驮运"。158 他获得的物品依然是在王圆箓的筛选下确定的，那些写本主要是中文佛教经典，有些可追溯至五世纪和六世纪。此外，为促成交易，王圆箓还送给他一批据称在另一处洞窟中发现的浮雕灰泥牌匾。159

L01-P022-008 | 英文原文

During Stein's second visit, Wang showed him his accounts and the new structures that had appeared over the past seven years, largely funded by the 1907 payments in exchange

中文译文 | L01-P022-008

在斯坦因的第二次到访期间，王圆箓向他展示了自己的账目，以及过去七年里建成的新建筑，这些建筑大多是由1907年的那笔款项资助建造的。

L01-P022-009 | 英文原文

[151] *Ibid*, p. 211.
[152] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 830.
[153] Stein, *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks*, p. 211.
[154] Stein, *Innermost Asia*, p. 358.
[155] *Ibid*, p. 358.
[156] *Ibid*, p. 358.
[157] *Ibid*, p. 358.
[158] *Ibid*, p. 358.
[159] *Ibid*, p. 359.

中文译文 | L01-P022-009

151 同上，第211页。152 斯坦因，《西域记》，第830页。153 斯坦因，《中亚古道考》，第211页。154 斯坦因，《最远亚洲》，第358页。155 同上，第358页。156 同上，第358页。157 同上，第358页。158 同上，第358页。159 同上，第359页。

原PDF第23页（原刊第843页）

L01-P023-002 | 英文原文

for his 'selections'. Right opposite Cave 16 and Cave 17 now stood a guest house, a series of shrines, and a few facilities that 'attested the little priest's single-minded ambition to restore, according to his lights, the glory and popular attractions of the ancient sacred site'.[160] Several wall paintings and stucco sculptures had also been restored. Elsewhere, substantial work had been done to remove the drift sand blocking the lower-level caves and to render the upper-level caves accessible by 'cutting passages from one cave-shrine to another right through the rock wall separating them'.[161]

中文译文 | L01-P023-002 | 原文注号：160、161

正是由于他的“筛选”工作。在第16窟与第17窟的正对面，当时建有一座客舍、几座神龛以及一些其他设施，这些皆“印证了那位小道士一心一意想要按照自己的理解，恢复这座古老圣地的辉煌与吸引力”的决心。160此外，几幅壁画和灰泥雕塑也得到了修复。在其他地方，人们还做了大量工作，清除堵塞下层洞窟的流沙，并通过“在分隔各洞窟的神龛之间的岩壁中开凿通道”，使得上层洞窟能够通行。161

L01-P023-003 | 英文原文

As Stein left with his new acquisitions, he could not help but wonder ‘whether the contents of the two big boxes of manuscripts which Wang Tao-shih [Daoshi] kept in his store-room really represented the whole of the reserve he had managed to retain’.[162] There is no way to confirm his suspicions. In August 1914, the Russian orientalist and Buddhist scholar Sergey Oldenburg (1863–1934), who was leading his second Russian Turkestan expedition (1914–1915), travelled to Dunhuang. His team systematically studied and reproduced the pictorial and sculptural remains of the Mogao Caves, compiling an account of all caves, making floor plans, taking photographs, and copying murals. They gathered 19,000 Dunhuang manuscripts, mostly fragments, as well as over 350 paintings, acquired primarily from other caves rather than Cave 17.[163]

中文译文 | L01-P023-003 | 原文注号：162、163

当奥雷尔·斯坦因带着他新获得的藏品离开时，他不禁思考：“王道士——即那位道士——储存在其仓库里的那两大箱写本的内容，是否真的代表了他设法保留下来的全部藏书？”162目前无法证实他的猜测。1914年8月，正在领导第二次俄罗斯突厥斯坦探险队（1914–1915年）的俄罗斯东方学家兼佛教学者谢尔盖·奥尔登堡（1863–1934）前往敦煌。他的团队系统地研究并复制了莫高窟内的绘画与雕塑遗存，为所有洞窟编制了记录、绘制了平面图、拍摄了照片，并临摹了壁画。他们收集到了19,000份敦煌写本，其中大部分为残片，此外还有350多幅绘画，这些作品主要来自其他洞窟，而非第17窟。163

L01-P023-004 | 英文原文

By the time Stein returned to Dunhuang in 1914, most of Cave 17’s contents had been removed. Even so, he secured another 600 fine Buddhist scrolls from Wang Yuanlu, who still possessed manuscripts from the small cache. Having learned from his dealings with Pelliot and the members of the Ōtani expedition, Wang was now determined to obtain fair payment to finance his restoration work. These manuscripts are now held at the British Library. Again, Stein was only able to choose from the materials that were made available to him and, in that sense, Wang played a determining role in shaping the collection that the explorer was gathering.

中文译文 | L01-P023-004

到1914年斯坦因再次回到敦煌时，第17窟的大部分物品已被搬走。即便如此，他仍从王圆箓手中获得了另外600卷精美的佛教卷子，因为王圆箓仍保有那批少量藏书中的部分写本。在经历了与伯希和以及大谷探险队成员的交往之后，王圆箓如今决心获得合理的报酬，用以资助自己的修复工作。这些写本现保存在英国图书馆。同样，斯坦因也只能从他人提供给他的材料中挑选，从这个意义上说，王圆箓在塑造这位探险家正在收集的藏书系列方面起到了决定性作用。

L01-P023-005 | 英文原文

Conclusion

中文译文 | L01-P023-005

结论

L01-P023-006 | 英文原文

Wang Yuanlu—the man whose pious restoration work led to one of the most astonishing discoveries of the twentieth century—is a fascinating character. This article provides a more nuanced understanding of Wang by examining his relationship with the Mogao Caves and their wider ecosystem (especially the community of local Buddhist monks and the lay donors who funded his enterprises), by tracing how he conducted his transactions with Stein in 1907 and 1914, and by contrasting these with his dealings with other explorers. We argue here that Wang is not so much an 'obscure' as an 'obscured' figure.

中文译文 | L01-P023-006

王圆箓——正是他虔诚的修复工作促成了20世纪最惊人的发现之一——是个极具魅力的人物。本文通过考察他与莫高窟及其周边环境（尤其是当地的佛教僧侣群体以及为他的事业提供资助的居士捐助者）之间的关系，追溯他在1907年和1914年与斯坦因进行交易的过程，并将其与其他探险家的交往加以对比，从而让人们对王圆箓有更为细致的了解。我们在此认为，王圆箓与其说是个"默默无闻"的人，不如说是个"被忽视"的人物。

L01-P023-007 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Aurel Stein's detailed writings and other sources belie the simplistic image of a 'quaint priest, with [a] curious mixture of pious zeal, naïve ignorance, and astute tenacity of purpose',[164] who was swayed to sell thousands of manuscripts and other artefacts out of his and Stein's shared admiration for Xuanzang or a belief that letting Stein take some of the

中文译文 | L01-P023-007 | 原文注号：164

奥雷尔·斯坦因的详细记载以及其他资料，都打破了那种将他描绘成"一位古朴的道士，兼具虔诚的热忱、天真的无知以及精明的执着决心"164的简单形象——即认为他是出于对自己与斯坦因都对玄奘的共同敬仰，或是出于希望让斯坦因拿走部分物品的考虑，才同意出售数千份写本及其他文物的那种看法。

L01-P023-008 | 英文原文

[160] *Ibid*, p. 357.
[161] *Ibid*, p. 360.
[162] *Ibid*, p. 359.
[163] For an overview, see Hao Chunwen, *Dunhuang Manuscripts*, pp. 54–56. For more details, refer to Popova, 'S.F. Oldenburg's Second Russian Turkestan Expedition (1914–1915)', pp. 158–175. In addition to the items collected in 1914–1915, several Dunhuang manuscripts acquired from an unknown source had been transferred to St Petersburg in 1911. See A. Zorin, 'The collection of Dunhuang Tibetan texts kept at the IOM RAS', Institute of Oriental Manuscripts, RAS, St. Petersburg, 2012, pp. 365–367, http://www.orientalstudies.ru/rus/images/pdf/a_zorin_2012_b.pdf.

中文译文 | L01-P023-008

160 同上，第357页。161 同上，第360页。162 同上，第359页。163 如需概览，可参见郝春文所著《敦煌写本》，第54–56页；如需更多细节，可参阅波波娃所写的《S.F.奥尔登堡的第二次俄罗斯突厥斯坦探险（1914–1915年）》，第158–175页。除1914–1915年间收集的物品外，还有几件来历不明的敦煌写本在1911年已被转移至圣彼得堡。参见A.佐林所著《保存在俄罗斯科学院东方写本研究所的敦煌藏文文献集》，圣彼得堡，俄罗斯科学院东方写本研究所，2012年，第365–367页，网址：http://www.orientalstudies.ru/rus/images/pdf/a_zorin_2012_b.pdf。

L01-P023-009 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

[164] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 169.

中文译文 | L01-P023-009

164 斯坦因所著《沙漠中的中国古迹》，第169页。

L01-P024-002 | 英文原文

manuscripts to Buddhism's homeland would earn him some spiritual merit.[165] Wang exercised far more agency than he is usually credited with, yet he should not be reduced to a thief or even a shrewd businessman who treated Cave 17's contents as mere commodities. As noted by Justin Jacobs, he 'sought to control access to his "goods," carefully manage his "stock," and "sell" them on his own terms'.[166] This insight, however, does not reflect the full range of his motivation.

中文译文 | L01-P024-002 | 原文注号：165、166

将那些写本运回佛教的发源地，能够为他赢得一些功德。165 王圆箓的实际自主权远超过人们通常认为的程度，但他也不应被简化为一个小偷，或是那种将第17窟的藏品视为普通商品的老练商人。正如贾斯汀·雅各布斯所指出的，他"试图控制对自己'货物'的获取，精心管理自己的'库存'，并按照自己的条件将它们'出售'"。166 然而，这一见解并未反映出他全部的动力所在。

L01-P024-003 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Wang Yuanlu, who took it upon himself to act as guardian of the Mogao Caves and joined ongoing restoration efforts, can be considered the first 'curator' or 'keeper' of Cave 17 and its contents. He alerted the authorities to the newly found hoard and, left in charge of preserving the collection, installed a locked door and reorganised the room according to what he deemed a more suitable arrangement. Contrary to Stein's accounts, Wang was far from unaware of the nature of the cave's contents. He collaborated with resident Buddhist monks, drawing on their expertise to identify some materials and lending them items for ritual purposes. He also hand-picked fine specimens as gifts for Gansu officials. Finally, having completely emptied and restacked Cave 17, he would have had a good grasp of its contents.

中文译文 | L01-P024-003

王圆箓主动承担了莫高窟守护者的职责，并参与当时正在进行的修缮工作，因此可以视为第17窟及其洞藏的首位'保管者'或'管理者'。他将新发现的洞藏报告给官府；在被留任负责保护这批收藏后，他安装了一扇带锁的门，并按照自己认为更合适的方式重新整理了洞室。与斯坦因的记述不同，王圆箓远非不了解洞藏的性质。他与驻窟的佛教僧人合作，借助他们的专门知识辨认部分材料，并借出物品供仪式使用。他还亲自挑选精美的样本，赠送给甘肃官员。最后，既然他曾将第17窟彻底清空并重新堆放其中的物品，他理应相当了解洞藏的内容。

L01-P024-004 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Equally important is Wang's role in shaping the now so-called Dunhuang Stein collection. Throughout his transactions with Stein, he was concerned with controlling the conditions of the exchange. When Stein first visited the Mogao Caves in 1907, he was not allowed free access to the repository and largely had to rely on Wang's choice of bundles to make selections. Stein and Jiang had to act in quasi-secrecy to avoid arousing suspicion. Wang Yuanlu was particularly protective of the Buddhist canonical texts that formed the bulk of the 'regular bundles', which he had safely sandwiched between top and bottom layers of 'miscellaneous' bundles. To distract Stein, he supplied one miscellaneous bundle after another, filled with materials he considered 'rubbish' or almost worthless—that is, paintings, drawings, printed documents, and texts in Central Asian languages. This is how the embroidery of the Buddha at the Vultures Peak or the 868 printed copy of the Diamond Sutra ended up in the United Kingdom.[167] Stein nevertheless secured a substantial number of 'regular' bundles in 1907 and 1914, explaining why the British Library's Stein collection contains multiple copies of the same scripture, including the *Lotus Sutra* and the *Diamond Sutra* in Chinese.

中文译文 | L01-P024-004 | 原文注号：167

同样重要的是王圆箓在如今所谓'敦煌斯坦因收藏'形成过程中的作用。在与斯坦因交易的整个过程中，他一直试图掌控交换的条件。斯坦因于1907年首次到访莫高窟时，并未获准自由进入藏经洞，挑选材料时在很大程度上只能依赖王圆箓拿出的卷束。斯坦因和蒋孝琬不得不近乎秘密地行动，以免引起怀疑。王圆箓尤其看重构成大多数'常规卷束'的佛教经典，将它们稳妥地夹在上下两层'杂项'卷束之间。为了转移斯坦因的注意，他接连拿出杂项卷束，其中装着他认为是'废物'或几乎不值钱的材料，即绘画、画稿、印本文献和以中亚语言书写的文本。灵鹫山说法图刺绣和868年印制的《金刚经》便是这样流入英国的。〔167〕不过，斯坦因仍在1907年和1914年取得了相当多的'常规'卷束；这也解释了英国图书馆的斯坦因收藏为何包含同一经典的多个抄本，其中包括汉文《法华经》和《金刚经》。

L01-P024-005 | 英文原文（原段接续 / 分段）

Ultimately, Wang Yuanlu made a judgement call between the relative importance of the Mogao Caves site as a whole versus that of Cave 17's contents. For him, enabling repair works to what had been a thriving Buddhist pilgrimage centre was a pious duty to which he devoted his life, channelling money from his begging tours and the sale of manuscripts into clearing sand, repairing statues and paintings, and restoring shrines. His decision was made not only from the perspective of living practice as opposed to that of scholarship but also collectively. Although Wang avoided drawing attention to his dealings with Stein, it is likely that local Buddhist monks were aware. Wang himself told Stein he was keen to consult the donors funding his initiatives. This may explain why his later transactions with Pelliot and others were conducted more openly. What seems clear is that his reputation was not diminished when he died in 1931; his disciples obtained permission from local authorities to erect a stupa in his honour, opposite the caves.[168]

中文译文 | L01-P024-005 | 原文注号：168

归根结底，王圆箓在莫高窟整体与第17窟洞藏的相对重要性之间作出了判断。对他而言，促成修复这处曾经兴盛的佛教朝圣中心，是他毕生投入的一项虔敬职责。他将外出募化和出售写本所得的钱用于清沙、修补塑像与壁画，以及修缮佛堂。他作出这一决定，既是从活态宗教实践而非学术研究的角度出发，也是集体商议的结果。尽管王圆箓避免让自己与斯坦因的交易引人注意，但当地佛教僧人很可能知情。王圆箓本人曾告诉斯坦因，他希望征询资助其修缮活动的施主的意见。这或许能够解释，他后来与伯希和及其他人的交易为何更为公开。看来明确的是，他于1931年去世时声望并未受损；他的弟子得到地方当局许可，在石窟对面为他修建了一座纪念塔。〔168〕

L01-P024-006 | 英文原文

[165] *Ibid*, p. 170.
[166] Jacobs, *Compensations of Plunder*, p. 97.
[167] They are now respectively held at the British Museum and British Library.
[168] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, p. 107.

中文译文 | L01-P024-006

165 同上，第170页。166 雅各布斯，《掠夺的补偿》，第97页。167 这些写本目前分别保存在大英博物馆和英国图书馆。168 荣新江，《敦煌十八讲》，第107页。

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ARTICLE

Wang Yuanlu, the first 'curator' of the Stein collection's Dunhuang corpus

Mélodie Doumy

Asian and African Collections, The British Library, London, UK
Email: melodie.doumy@bl.uk

Abstract

Wang Yuanlu 王圓籙—the individual who accidentally stumbled upon the 'library cave' or Cave 17 at the Mogao Caves near Dunhuang in June 1900—is behind one of the world's most significant discoveries. Yet, in the years that followed, he was also responsible for the scattering of the cave's contents and selling large chunks to Marc Aurel Stein in 1907 and to Paul Pelliot in 1908. How could the self-appointed guardian of this major Buddhist complex part with one of what is often described as its crowning jewels? This article delves into Wang Yuanlu's motivations and highlights his agency, demonstrating that he was instrumental in shaping the now so-called Stein collection. One of the key sources for this investigation are the published writings of Marc Aurel Stein, which provide the most detailed descriptions of Wang and his activities during the period of the dispersal of the contents of Cave 17. These are supplemented by information drawn from the relevant parts of Stein's diaries, Paul Pelliot's writings, and primary sources and recent scholarship in Chinese that shed a different light on Wang's doings. The article starts by studying Wang's relationship with the Mogao Caves and their wider ecosystem. It then looks at the subsequent dispersal of the newly found hoard through his transactions with Stein in 1907 and 1914, which are contrasted with his dealings with Pelliot.

Keywords: Cave 17; Dunhuang; provenance; Marc Aurel Stein; Wang Yuanlu

Introduction

In June 1900, an individual named Wang Yuanlu 王圓籙 (1850?–1931) noticed a crack in the wall of the corridor leading to a large cave, Cave 16, at the Mogao Caves site, near Dunhuang, as he was conducting some restoration work. Upon checking what was behind the exposed plaster, he discovered a door behind which a small chamber had been excavated in the rock. Now commonly referred to as Cave 17 or the 'library cave', this room is thought to have been sealed off at the beginning of the eleventh century. It turned out to be a real 'time capsule of Silk Road history',[1] containing tens of thousands of manuscripts, as well as printed documents, paintings on paper and silk, textiles, and other Buddhist artefacts.

Wang rapidly alerted local officials to this discovery, but no immediate actions were taken. In 1904, orders were sent to keep the collection in place, and he remained de facto custodian of the cave. In 1910, an official from the Ministry of Education was dispatched to Dunhuang to transport all the manuscripts left in Cave 17 to Beijing for safekeeping. By then, the British-Hungarian archaeologist Aurel Stein (1862–1943) and the French Sinologist Paul Pelliot (1878–1945) had already respectively visited the Mogao Caves in 1907

[1] V. Hansen, *The Silk Road: A New History* (Oxford and New York, 2012), pp. 167–197.

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and 1908, and Wang had agreed to sell them both exceptionally large chunks of the repository's contents. Later on, he parted with more items against payment. For this reason, Wang Yuanlu has been cast down in Chinese history as a villain, whose name, although associated with the discovery of Cave 17, is even more so linked to the dispersal of its contents. He has often been portrayed as being illiterate and unaware of the significance of the trove held in the cave, which resulted in his being duped by Western explorers. Others have simply considered him to be the prime example of a thief who profited from the sale of Dunhuang relics.[2] In recent years, several Chinese scholars have started to show that Wang was driven by his piety and desire to protect the Mogao Caves. Yet he remains overall an obscure figure.

Both Marc Aurel Stein's personal narratives, *Ruins of Desert Cathay* and *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks*, and the expedition reports that he wrote, *Serindia* and *Innermost Asia*, provide complementary accounts of his visits to the Mogao Caves and his negotiations with Wang Yuanlu over the contents of Cave 17. These books play a key part in shaping Stein's self-representation, as he glorifies his own actions and, in doing so, minimises Wang's role. However, when reading between the lines and bringing in other contemporary sources, it becomes possible to see that Wang Yuanlu had a much more important part in the care, arrangement, and dispersal of the cave's contents. While Stein's published accounts had a 'performative' dimension, they also contain information about Wang's custodianship of the caves, his relationship with the wider local community, his motivations for selling Cave 17's contents, and the way he selected materials for the explorer's 'examination'. Therefore, this article critically examines these writings, contrasting them (when relevant) with material from his travel diaries, as well as Pelliot's account and other contemporaneous sources in Chinese. It proposes a fuller picture of Wang Yuanlu—the 'priestly librarian'[3] who could be considered as the first 'curator' of the cave's contents—and highlights his agency in shaping the so-called Stein collection.

Abbot Wang: guardian of the Mogao Caves

Wang Yuanlu and the discovery of Cave 17

Little is known about Wang Yuanlu 王圓祿 (Figure 1).[4] Much of the information we have about him comes from the accounts of Stein, Pelliot, and other foreign explorers.[5] Originally from Macheng 麻城 County in Hubei 湖北, he was born in *circa* 1849–1850. Later in life, having fled the drought and famine raging in his native province, he ended up at Jiuquan 酒泉 (then Suzhou 肅州) and served in the military.[6] During his service, Wang Yuanlu converted to Daoism under the guidance of a master named Shengdao 盛道.[7] After being discharged

[2] Chen Wanli 陳萬里, *Xixing riji* 西行日記 [*A Diary of Westward Travels*], (ed.) Yang Xiaobin (Lanzhou, 2000), p. 8.

[3] M. A. Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay: Personal Narrative of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China* (London, 1912), vol. ii, p. 190.

[4] Several Chinese primary sources dating from the time at which Wang Yuanlu was active at Dunhuang indicate that his name (though phonetically the same) was originally with the characters '園祿'. It is only on his epitaph that it was changed to '圓籙'. In addition, Fang Guangchang has suggested that his secular name was Wang Fulin 王福琳. Fang Guangchang 方廣錩, '*Wang Daoshi mingcheng kao*' 王道士名称考 [On the name and titles of Taoist Priest Wang], *Dunhuang yanjiu* 敦煌研究 4 (2016), pp. 111–118.

[5] Rong Xinjiang, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, (trans.) I. Galambos (Leiden and Boston, 2013), p. 107.

[6] Stein thought that Wang Yuanlu 'was a poor friendless mendicant' from Shaanxi 陝西. See M. A. Stein, *Serindia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China, etc.* (Oxford, 1921), vol. 2, p. 804. Wang Jiqing examined in detail the various sources available and demonstrated that, although Wang Yuanlu's place of origin is most often given as Hubei, including on his epitaph, some official Chinese documents from the late Qing Dynasty mention that he came from Hanzhong 漢中 in Shaanxi. According to Wang Jiqing, it is perfectly conceivable that Wang Yuanlu was born in Hubei but spent a lot of his adult life in Shaanxi. Wang Jiqing 王冀青, *Guo bao liu san: Zang jing dong de gu shi* 國寶流散: 藏經洞的故事 (Lanzhou, 2007), pp. 3–6.

[7] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, pp. 79–80.

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Figure 1. Portrait of Wang Yuanlu taken by Marc Aurel Stein in June 1907. Source: © From The British Library Collection: Photo 392/26(327).

from the army, Wang became a Daoist priest. This earned him the nickname of Wang Daoshi 王道士 ('the Daoshi' for Stein).[8] At the extreme end of the nineteenth century, possibly between 1897 and 1899, Wang Yuanlu settled at the Mogao Caves complex 莫高窟 or Caves of the Thousand Buddhas 千佛洞, where he stayed until his death in 1931.

The Mogao Caves are located within a close distance south-east of the oasis town of Dunhuang 敦煌, which was established as a frontier garrison outpost in the second century BCE and came to be a strategic spot at the cross of the Northern and the Southern Silk Roads. The first cave is said to have been carved in 366 CE by a Buddhist pilgrim monk and, over the next millennium, almost 1,000 caves and niches were gradually excavated in

[8] The term 'daoshi 道士' has often been translated as 'Abbot' in English, although it would be more accurate to call him a 'priest' or a 'Daoist master'.

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the sandstone cliff face, half of them richly decorated with painted murals and clay sculptures. In the fourteenth century, the land Silk Roads began to decline and the site gradually fell into disuse. When the Frenchman Charles-Eudes Bonin (1865–1929) visited the Mogao Caves in 1899, at around the same time as Wang Yuanlu himself arrived at the site, he commented on the fact that the caves on the lower level were in danger of being completely silted up if no one took adequate measures.[9] Little did he know that Wang had come to the same realisation.

Soon after settling down at the Mogao Caves, Wang Yuanlu started to collect donations from devout locals. With the money, he set about repairing the three-storey complex linked to the eminent ninth-century Monk Wu Hongbian.[10] By the time Stein arrived at the Mogao Caves, Wang had restored a large Buddhist cave on the ground floor (Cave 16) 'to what he conceived to have been its original glory'.[11] Wang Yuanlu hired several workers to clear off drift sand and debris from its entrance. As they were slowly proceeding with their task, they accidentally stumbled upon a small hidden cave in June 1900.[12] Excavated in the north wall of the corridor and later closed off, the room was only a few cubic metres large. It was filled, from floor to ceiling, with manuscripts, paintings, textiles, and other artefacts. These items dated from the late fourth century to the beginning of the eleventh century—the time around which the cave commonly referred to as Cave 17, or the 'library cave', was probably sealed off.

Perhaps hoping to get some form of financial compensation or recognition for his pious endeavours, Wang Yuanlu immediately went to report the discovery to the local county magistrate, Yan Ze 嚴澤 (dates unknown). He took two manuscripts with him as proof, but no actions were taken. When the new county magistrate Wang Zonghan 汪宗翰 (b. 1845) came to Dunhuang in April 1902, he was informed of the existence of Cave 17 and given several of its items. In turn, Wang Zonghan wrote about this to the epigrapher Ye Changshi 葉昌熾 (1849–1917), who was Gansu provincial education commissioner from 1902 to 1906.[13] Furthermore, it appears that Wang Yuanlu also showed a case of manuscripts to the Qing official Ting Dong 廷棟 (1866–1918), but the latter did not regard these as important.[14] Based on Stein's expedition report, 'news of the discovery having reached distant Lanzhou, specimens of the manuscripts were asked for from provincial headquarters'.[15]

[9] C.-E. Bonin, 'Les grottes des Mille Bouddhas', *Comptes rendus des séances de l'Académie des Inscriptions et Belles-Lettres* 45.2 (1901), p. 212. For a detailed article about Bonin's visit to Dunhuang and relations with explorers Pelliot and Hedin, see M. Doumy, 'Charles-Eudes Bonin: the first French person to visit Dunhuang', *Silk Roads Archaeology and Heritage* 1.1 (2023), pp. 1–20, https://doi.org/10.5334/srah.3. For a full biography of Bonin in French, see S. Malsagne, *Au Coeur du Grand Jeu: La France en Orient. Charles-Eudes Bonin (1865–1929), explorateur diplomate* (Paris, 2015).

[10] This information is found in the stele 'Record of Merit for the Restoration of the Thousand Buddha Caves' three-storey building (Ch. '*Chong xiu Qianfodong san ceng lou gong de bei ji* 重修千佛洞三层楼功德碑记') dated to 1906, as well as in Wang Yuanlu's epitaph. See Fan Guangchun 樊光春, '*Dunhuang Daoshi Wang Yuanlu pingzhuan*' 敦煌道士王圓箓评传 [Critical biography of Dunhuang's Daoist priest Wang Yuanlu], *Zhongguo daojiao* 中國道教 5 (2008), pp. 43–44.

[11] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 168.

[12] The date of the discovery of Cave 17 varies depending on sources: it can be given as 20, 22, or 25 June 1907.

[13] Huang Zheng 黄征, *Jie chen yi zhu: Dunhuang yi shu* 劫尘遗珠: 敦煌遗书 [*The Lost Pearl: Dunhuang Manuscripts*] (Lanzhou, 1999), pp. 10–13. Rong Xinjiang and Justin Jacobs both suggested that Wang Yuanlu may not have told Wang Zonghan and local authorities the whole truth about the actual scope of the cave's contents. They refer to the fact that Ye Changchi 葉昌熾 (1849–1917), Gansu provincial education commissioner from 1902 to 1906, thought that the cave only had several hundreds of manuscripts. It could be that he heard this from Wang Zonghan, who was deliberately misled by Wang Yuanlu. See Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, pp. 90–91, 101; J. Jacobs, *The Compensations of Plunder: How China Lost Its Treasures* (Chicago and London, 2020), pp. 96–97.

[14] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, p. 85.

[15] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 802.

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However, 'hours of diplomatic converse' with Wang Yuanlu purportedly revealed to the explorer that 'they had failed to attract any interest there' and that:

> [...] to Wang's undisguised chagrin no further notice had been taken of his treasured old manuscripts or, indeed, of his pious labours which had led to their discovery. Officialdom had rested satisfied with a rough statement that the whole of the manuscripts would make up seven cartloads, and, evidently grudging the cost of transport or the trouble of close examination, had left the whole undisturbed in charge of the Tao-shih [Daoshi] as self-constituted guardian of the temple.[16]

In any event, in May 1904, the provincial government ordered Wang Zonghan in Dunhuang to take measures for the preservation of Cave 17's contents.[17] Some scholars have argued that he was also asked to take an inventory of the manuscripts and paintings.[18] As for Wang Yuanlu, to whom the overall responsibility of safeguarding the deposit was delegated, there is evidence that he took the necessary precautions to prevent anyone from entering the cave without his consent. In his travel diary, Stein recounts that he first heard of the manuscripts found at the Mogao Caves from Zahid Beg, a trader from Urumchi, who told him that these 'had been locked by order'.[19] Indeed, Wang had attached a wooden door to the opening of the cave and kept the key. On 16 March 1907, when Stein and his Chinese secretary Jiang Xiaowan 蔣孝琬 or Jiang Shiye 蔣師爺[20] (d. 1922) first came to the Mogao Caves and tried to access the small cave, it was carefully locked in the absence of Wang Yuanlu, who had gone begging for alms around Dunhuang with two followers.[21] Upon returning two months later, on 21 May 1907, the British-Hungarian explorer found out that the narrow opening had been 'completely walled up with brickwork', allegedly to protect it from the intrusion of eager pilgrims[22] but maybe also as a 'special precaution taken against [his] inquisitive eyes'.[23] When the French Sinologist Paul Pelliot went to the Mogao Caves in 1908, the door to Cave 17 was also locked and he had to wait for Wang Yuanlu to meet him with the key.[24]

[16] *Ibid*, pp. 803–804; see also Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 167; and Wang Jiqing, 'Aurel Stein's dealings with Wang Yuanlu and Chinese officials in Dunhuang in 1907', in *Sir Aurel Stein, Colleagues and Collections*, (ed.) H. Wang (London, 2012), p. 3. For an expanded version of this article, see Wang Jiqing 王冀青, '*1907 nian Sitanyin yu Wang yuanlu ji Dunhuang guanyuan zhijian de jiaozhu 1907*' 年斯坦因与王圆禄及敦煌官员之间的交往 [Stein's dealings with Wang Yuanlu and Dunhuang officials in 1907], *Dunhuang xue jikan* 3 (2007), pp. 60–76.

[17] Huang Zheng, *Jie chen yi zhu*, pp. 10–13; see also Wang Jiqing, 'Aurel Stein's dealings', p. 3.

[18] Ma Shichang 马世长 used the colophon written by Wang Zonghan on a painting from Cave 17 as proof. The dedication, which has been translated into English with the help of Hsieh Han-Lin, reads as follows: 甘肅敦煌縣千佛洞宋初石室所藏畫大士像。光緒卅年四月朔, 奉檄檢點經卷畫像, 迎歸署中供養。信士敦煌知縣王宗翰謹記。(Tang Dynasty painting of Avalokiteśvara stored in an early Song Dynasty cave at the Thousand Buddha Caves in Dunhuang county, Gansu. On the first day of the 4th moon of the 30th year of Guangxu, I took the official order to inventory the sutra scrolls and paintings and to bring them back to the government for offering). Recorded by the devotee Wang Zonghan, magistrate of Dunhuang. See Ma Shichang, '*Guanyu Dunhuang Cangjingdong de ji ge wenti*' 关于敦煌藏经洞的几个问题 [Several questions regarding Dunhuang Cave 17], *Wenwu* 12 (1978), pp. 22, 33, n. 3.

[19] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 15 March 1907, MSS Stein 245: f. 167.

[20] The term 'shiye 師爺' refers to Jiang's role as a private assistant or private adviser, attending to secretarial duties for Stein.

[21] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 29.

[22] *Ibid*, pp. 165–166.

[23] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 803.

[24] P. Pelliot, 'Une bibliothèque médiévale retrouvée au Kan-sou', *Bulletin de l'École Française d'Extrême Orient* 8 (1908), p. 505; this was also mentioned in his travel diary on 27 February 1908; see P. Pelliot, *Carnets de Route, 1906-1908*, (eds.) J. Ghesquière and F. Macouin (Paris, 2008), p. 277.

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We have therefore seen that Wang, who was already acting as the self-appointed caretaker of the Mogao Caves, came to oversee the protection Cave 17 and its contents in a semi-official capacity in the years following his extraordinary chance discovery. Having attempted to alert several officials, he was instructed to provisionally look after the small cave and its contents, and locked it for safety. We will now demonstrate that he was assuming this role not as a lone Daoist monk, but rather as a well-integrated member of the local religious community, including resident Buddhist monks.

Wang Yuanlu and the local Buddhist community

In 1894, the Russian officer and explorer Vsevolod Ivanovich Roborovsky (1856–1910) visited Dunhuang and noted that the Thousand Buddha Caves still attracted up to 10,000 worshippers every year.[25] Over a decade later, the annual celebrations that Stein witnessed on his way back from the Dunhuang Limes demonstrated that the caves, 'notwithstanding all apparent decay, were still real cult places "in being"'. A few Buddhist dwellers also resided at the site. When Wang Yuanlu first put down roots at the Mogao Caves, three temples were located in front of the caves: the upper and middle temples were already occupied by Tibetan monks, so he moved to the lower temple in the southern section of the site.[26] Wang Jiqing has suggested that the lower temple was used for Daoist activities in the early 1820s, but that it later went unoccupied for a long time.[27] In 1907, Stein observed that Wang lived with two 'humble acolytes', likely the same two companions who went with him on begging tours, and that he appeared to 'spen[d] next to nothing on his person or private interests', channelling all the donations collected over the years 'upon [these] labours of piety'.[28] The perception that Wang was dedicated and selflessness was also confirmed in the 1980s by a member of the Dunhuang Academy, Li Zhengyu 李正宇, who had derived the same information from local stories.[29]

Wang Yuanlu was continuing or joining efforts to rehabilitate the site that had started before his arrival.[30] As explained by the Russian army officer Vsevolod Ivanovich Roborovsky, limited repairs were already underway when he visited the Mogao Caves in 1894:

> The *heshang* 和尚 [monks] living there (4 people) complain that the government is taking no measures to repair the caves, whereas private donations for the purpose

[25] I. Popova, 'S.F. Oldenburg's Second Russian Turkestan Expedition (1914–1915)', in *Russian Expeditions to Central Asia at the Turn of the 20th Century* (St. Petersburg, 2008), p. 163, http://www.orientalstudies.ru/rus/images/pdf/a_popova_2008d.pdf.

[26] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 27 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 315; see also Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, p. 82; Jacobs, *Compensations of Plunder*, p. 95.

[27] According to Wang Jiqing, Gusztáv von Kreitner (1847–1893), who visited the site in May 1879 with the Count Béla Széchenyi (1837–1893) and Lajos Lóczy (1849–1920), referred to two lamas, established already for 15 years at the Mogao Caves in his travel account, but he did not allude to the presence of any Daoist monks. Neither did the Russian explorer Nikolai Mikhailovich Przhevalsky (1839–1888), who came to Dunhuang a few months later. See Wang, *Guo bao liu san*, p. 8.

[28] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 168.

[29] Jin Ronghua 金榮華, *Wang Daoshi—Dunhuang wenwu wailiu guanjian renwu tanwu* 王道士—敦煌文物外流關鍵人物探微 [*The Daoist Priest Wang—Exploring the Key Figures in the Dispersal of Dunhuang Items*] (Taipei, 1993), p. 109.

[30] As early as 1772, a lama named Li Xinneng 李心能 and his disciple Yuan Xiu 源修 undertook to restore the Leiyin Temple 雷音寺 with the alms they had collected; see Wang, *Guo bao liu san*, p. 7.

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> are scarce. So far only 5 or 6 caves have been put right; entrances to them have been mended, wooden annexes built and *fanzas* for *heshang* repaired.[31]

In some of his correspondence, Stein referred to Wang Yuanlu as 'the priest chiefly concerned' with Cave 17,[32] which makes sense given the specific role he was entrusted with. His published narrative conveys the impression that Wang carried this responsibility with the awareness of resident Buddhist monks, who oversaw the care of the caves with him: 'The shrine, though full of Buddhist frescoes and sculptures, was in charge of a Taoist priest, the small fraternity of Ho-shangs [he shang 和尚] or Buddhist monks, to which our guide belonged, peacefully sharing with him the guardianship of the site.'[33] From this description, we gain a picture of Wang Yuanlu not only living alongside local Buddhist monks, but also collaborating with them towards the same ends.

There is evidence that Wang granted them access to some of the items from Cave 17. As mentioned earlier, Stein had to wait before he could access the 'walled-up library' and take full measure of its treasures because Wang was not there when he first made his way to the Mogao Caves. In *Serindia*, Stein wrote that a young monk helped him and Jiang Xiaowan to locate the newly discovered hoard and agreed to show them one of the Chinese scrolls from Cave 17. The 'beautifully preserved' manuscript, 'with its fine texture and carefully smoothed surface', showed 'excellent penmanship' and had been lent to his spiritual master, a Tibetan lama, in order to give 'additional lustre' to his small private chapel.[34] Stein noted in his diaries that the specimen was brought by Jiang from the chapel of an absent monk and that a young monk acted as a guide—an account that appears to align with his published narrative.[35] A photograph taken in 1908 by Charles Nouette, the photographer of the expedition led by Paul Pelliot, also depicts a Buddhist monk engaged in ritual practice (Figure 2). He is standing before an altar on which he has set up a book, an incense burner, several statues, and a few other ritual objects. We can see paintings hanging in the background, two of which are now in the collections of the Musée Guimet in France.[36] If these paintings indeed came from Cave 17, then this suggests again that local Buddhist monks used some of the cave's contents for religious purposes, presumably with Wang's consent.[37]

That such a significant Buddhist complex—even one that had fallen into dereliction and relative disuse—ended up being overseen by a Daoist monk may seem surprising. One should remember that there probably was no real clear-cut divide between Daoism and Buddhism at the time. For instance, Stein remarked that the peoples of Dunhuang were 'attached with particular zeal to such forms of worship as represent Buddhism in the queer

[31] The text was translated and quoted by Irina Popova from Труды экспедиции ИРГО по Центральной Азии. Ч. 1. Отчет начальника экспедиции В.И. Роборовского [*Works of the IRGS Expedition to Central Asia. Part 1. Report of the Expedition Head V.I. Roborovsky*] (St Petersburg, 1900), p. 218; see Popova, 'S.F. Oldenburg's Second Russian Turkestan Expedition', p. 163.

[32] Confidential report by Stein concerning the cache of ancient manuscripts at Dunhuang, British Museum Central Archives, CE 32/23/16/2.

[33] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 29.

[34] Stein, *Serindia*, pp. 801–802.

[35] Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 16 March 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 169.

[36] The silk paintings are EO 3579, which represents the Amoghapaśa mandala, and EO 1146, which is probably the remaining top section of a mandala. I am very grateful to Roderick Whitfield, who helped with this identification, personal communication, 14 December 2023.

[37] This implies that it would probably have been difficult for Wang Yuanlu to sell these specific items to Pelliot without some level of awareness among the resident monks.

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Figure 2. Photo of a monk taken between 25 February and 27 May 1908, AP8586. Source: © MNAAG, Paris, Dist. RMN-Grand Palais/image musée Guimet.

medley of Chinese popular religion'.[38] Whether Wang Yuanlu was truly Daoist has been debated. For instance, László Bárdi highlighted that Wang was cited in an alternative fashion as a Daoist or a Buddhist, and that some sources indicate he changed status over time from a Daoist to a Buddhist monk.[39] It is not uncommon for Daoist practitioners to also venerate Buddhist deities, such as Guanyin.

In fact, Wang Yuanlu was most probably initiated to the Longmen branch of Quanzhen Daoism, which was present at Dunhuang then and remains one of the largest Daoist sects in

[38] M. A. Stein, *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks: Brief Narrative of Three Expeditions in Innermost Asia and North-Western China* (London, 1933), vol. 1, p. 199.

[39] L. Bárdi, 'Chinese assessment of Sir Aurel M. Stein's work', in *Aurel Stein Bibliography*, (ed.) I. Erdélyi (Bloomington, IN, 1999), p. 45, n. 1.

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China today.[40] Scholars have stressed that this particular branch of Daoism includes many elements that are indistinguishable from those of Buddhism.[41] According to Rong Xinjiang, the aim of Wang's restorations was to convert Buddhist halls into Daoist shrines.[42] While Stein's accounts referred to Wang's works as 'tokens of lingering Buddhist worship, genuine though distorted',[43] his travel diary did mention an 'invasion of Taoist imagery' in the shrines.[44] Wang's epitaph, inscribed on the tomb stone erected by two of his disciples in 1931, states that he was put in charge of the county's Daoist Association by the magistrate Lu Qian 陸前 in recognition of his merits. Importantly, the epitaph stresses Wang's genuine dedication to restoring the Mogao Caves, including the Buddhist statues, as well as his endeavour to convince people to contribute money towards these efforts.[45] As attested by a letter on red paper signed in his name, it seems that Wang Yuanlu even sent a plea for a large donation to the local administration following the transfer of Cave 17's remaining contents to Beijing.[46]

It is therefore clear that being a Daoist did not preclude Wang from revering the Mogao Caves as a Buddhist site and devoting his existence to their upkeep. According to the stele 'Record of the Thousand Buddha Caves' Thousand Images Pagoda' by Ting Dong, Wang Yuanlu collected several damaged Buddha statues in 1910 and placed them in a specially built pagoda.[47] The pagoda was demolished in the 1940s and the artefacts it contained are now in the collections of the Dunhuang Academy.[48] There is further evidence that Wang Yuanlu's worship extended to the contents of Cave 17, particularly textual materials. We know of two instances in which he directly used the manuscripts from the cave for devotional and merit-making purposes. A document in the Dunhuang county archives dated to 1910 recorded that, in 1908, he 'loaded some Buddhist scrolls into two barrel-like containers, tightly sealed these and placed them on wooden poles inside a Buddhist hall, calling them sūtra-turning wheels'.[49] In 1944, the Dunhuang Academy also found 72 manuscripts inside a statue located in a Daoist temple built by Wang Yuanlu in the early 1900s.[50] Given

[40] Fan Guangchun 樊光春, '*Dunhuang Daoshi Wang Yuanlu pingzhuan*', p. 44.

[41] J. Abercombie, 'Syncretism in the Study of Quanzhen Taoism: From Essence to Argument' (unpublished PhD thesis, Whitman College, 2012), arminda.whitman.edu/theses/12 (accessed 18 July 2024).

[42] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, p. 83.

[43] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 169.

[44] Bodleian Libraries Oxford, entry for 29 May 2023, MSS Stein 204: f. 320.

[45] The tombstone is located inside a stupa containing the remains of Wang Yuanlu, near the Mogao Caves. Zhao Mingyu 趙明玉, '*Tai qing gong da fang zhang dao hui si Wang shi Fazhen muzhi*' 太清宮大方丈道會司王師法真墓誌, in Wei Juxian 衛聚賢, *Dunhuang shishi* 敦煌石室, Appendix 9, *Shuowen yuekan* 說文月刊 3/10 (1946), pp. 35–36.

[46] The letter is held at the Dunhuang Academy, under object number D0311. Referred to in Chinese as '催養經款草丹' or '王道士薦疏', it is signed by Wang Yuanlu and dated to the first to third years of the Xuantong 宣统reign (1910–1911). Some scholars have also suggested that the letter was addressed to the Empress Cixi 慈禧 or to an eminent Buddhist monk. I am grateful to Dunhuang Academy colleagues for this information and for showing me the document.

[47] This information is recorded in the stele 'Record of the Thousand Buddha Caves' Thousand Images Pagoda' (Ch. '*Dunhuang Qianfodong Xiangta ji* 敦煌千佛洞千相塔记'), dated to the second year of Xuantong's reign; see Fan Guangchun, '*Dunhuang Daoshi Wang Yuanlu pingzhuan*', p. 43. The stele, 112 centimetres high by 56 centimetres wide and 12 centimetres thick, is now in the exhibition centre of the Dunhuang Academy (collection number Z1114).

[48] Zhao Shengliang 赵声良, '*1943 nian Luo Jimei pai she Dunhuang shi ku zhao pian de yi yi*' 1943 年罗寄梅拍摄敦煌石窟照片的意义 [The significance of Luo Jimei's 1943 photographs of the Dunhuang Caves], in Pengpai Xinwen 澎湃新闻, 23 October 2019, https://www.thepaper.cn/newsDetail_forward_4633619 (accessed 3 April 2024).

[49] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, pp. 116–117.

[50] J.-P. Drège, 'Notes codicologiques sur les manuscrits de Dunhuang et de Turfan', *Bulletin de l'Ecole française d'Extrême Orient* 74 (1985), p. 489.

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the public and communal nature of these activities, it is highly likely that members of the resident Buddhist community knew of them.

We can now see that Wang Yuanlu, who made it his mission in life to raise funds towards the upkeep and restoration of the Mogao Caves, joined ongoing initiatives that had begun long before his arrival and was deeply connected to the site's Buddhist monks. Upon finding Cave 17, he became responsible for safeguarding its contents, albeit as a representative of the local religious community at large. Both Wang and the resident monks established at the caves were using some of the cave's manuscripts and paintings for their ritual activities. Such information calls for a deeper foray into Wang's relationship with the contents of the small repository.

Wang Yuanlu and the contents of Cave 17

Contrary to what has been said, Wang Yuanlu was not illiterate. He possessed at least some rudimentary literacy and numeracy skills, as demonstrated by the fact he kept a list of the various donations he received.[51] The letter on red paper mentioned earlier in this article could have been written by Wang, even if it is unconfirmed. Furthermore, a Dunhuang manuscript in Ryukoku University's Omiya Collection bears two inscriptions that have been tentatively attributed to him by the scholar Fang Guangchang, which could be evidence of his ability to write Chinese.[52] Stein's assistant Jiang Xiaowan reported that Wang was 'ignorant of all that constitutes traditional Chinese scholarship'.[53] Ironically, the two of them were ill-placed to make this observation: Stein deplored 'the great hindrance created by [his] total want of Sinological training' when faced with the mass of Chinese rolls from Cave 17,[54] while Jiang struggled to make sense of their Buddhist content.[55]

With the help of his local network, Wang Yuanlu might have had an edge over them in identifying some of the texts from the small cave. During his visit in 1908, the French Sinologist Paul Pelliot observed perfectly ordered Tibetan manuscripts enclosed in wooden covers. Relying on information from some Tibetan monks, Wang identified them as a form of Kanjur, which Pelliot interpreted as an early version of the Tibetan Buddhist canon: 'It seemed probable *a priori* that the perfectly ordered kia-pan, the only works in order in the whole library, represented a Kandjur; and this is precisely the information that the Wang tao gave me himself, based on the testimony of the lamas who have had access to the cave.'[56] While this turned out not to be strictly true, as the volumes contained copies of *Perfection of Wisdom* sutras, the lamas were perhaps identifying the volumes as 'Kanjur' because of their appearance and because they contained important canonical texts. Such large volumes could have served a similar ritual function to Kanjur collections in local monasteries. In any case, this indicates that Wang was able to gather valuable knowledge through local sources.

[51] Wang Yuanlu showed his accounts and his temple subscription to Jiang Xiaowan; see Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 168. When Stein went back to the Mogao Caves in 1914, Wang still kept a 'fine red book of donations'; see M. A. Stein, *Innermost Asia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia, Kan-su and Eastern Iran* (Oxford, 1928), p. 357.

[52] Fang Guangchang 方廣錩, '*Wang Daoshi mingcheng kao*', pp. 116–118.

[53] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 804.

[54] *Ibid*, pp. 821, 809: 'The limitations of my philological knowledge would not permit a rapid selection of what might be of special interest amidst these masses of Chinese texts.'

[55] *Ibid*, p. 802.

[56] P. Pelliot, 'Une grotte médiévale retrouvée au Kan-sou', *Bulletin de l'École française d'Extrême- Orient* 8 (1908), p. 507: 'Il semblait probable *a priori* que les kia-pan parfaitement en ordre, les seuls ouvrages en ordre de toute la bibliothèque, représentaient un Kandjur; et c'est justement le renseignement que m'a donné de lui-même le Wang Tao, sur la foi des lamas qui ont eu accès dans la grotte.'

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There is further reason to believe that Wang Yuanlu's limited knowledge was sufficient for him to realise the importance of the manuscripts, paintings, and other relics that the cave contained. On numerous occasions, including some mentioned earlier, Wang gave away discreet batches from the newly found hoard to officials and dignitaries in Gansu, causing the early dispersal of Cave 17's contents from 1900 onwards.[57] In doing so, Wang was perfectly able to select the better preserved, most complete, and aesthetically pleasing specimens. He hand-picked several beautiful paintings and removed Buddhist and Daoist scriptures that not only were finely written, but also happened to possess a high scholarly value.[58] Pelliot's writings also reveal that there were copper statuettes in the cave, which Wang Yuanlu also used as gifts.[59] As stressed by Susan Whitfield, to find such exceptional specimens, Wang would have gone through a considerable number of items.[60]

At some point between 1900 and 1904, Wang completely emptied Cave 17 before he received the order to put the whole 'collection' back in it.[61] During this process, he must have had the opportunity to form an overall idea of everything that had been deposited in the small room prior to its sealing-off. Because the scattering of the cave's contents started very soon after its discovery, this makes Wang Yuanlu the only person who was ever close to knowing their full extent and original arrangement. Stein wrote that Wang was looking for 'valuables'.[62] This somehow conveyed the image of Wang Yuanlu as an individual driven by greed. It would be more accurate to say that he was searching for valuable items, which could be understood in terms of their significance as well as their monetary value. Wasn't the British-Hungarian explorer himself drawn to the Caves of the Thousand Buddhas by the promise of Cave 17's hidden 'treasures'?[63] Wang could have decanted the cave to get a better understanding of what was in there, perhaps even to reorder its contents into an arrangement that he deemed more adequate.

Wang Yuanlu certainly did play a vital role in the organisation of Cave 17's contents when he rehoused them. Stein described what were two very distinct kinds of bundles in the cave: the 'regular' bundles, composed of uniform packets containing canonical Buddhist texts in Chinese and Tibetan that may have once belonged to monastic libraries; and the 'miscellaneous' or 'mixed' bundles, filled with fragmentary Chinese and Tibetan rolls, non-Chinese texts, paintings, textiles, and other ex-votos.[64] Wang had sorted and structured these bundles according to their type and physical characteristics. At the bottom, he had put several 'miscellaneous' bundles to 'what he thought appropriate use in turning the floor at the foot of the north wall and on either side of the clay platform into a foundation level with the latter'.[65] In his diary, Stein recorded that some of these bundles, which contained pictures and waste paper, may even have been placed there to keep off the damp.[66] He had then built on this base a 'wall-like array' of 'regular' manuscript bundles, above which lay

[57] Hundreds of items—both manuscripts and paintings—had been given to officials and other individuals before Aurel Stein arrived at Dunhuang in 1907; see Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, pp. 84–102.

[58] *Ibid*, pp. 84, 100–101.

[59] These items proved particularly popular and were rapidly almost exhausted, but Pelliot managed to secure a few during his visit; see Pelliot, 'Une grotte médiévale', pp. 506, 528.

[60] P. Terzi and S. Whitfield, 'Reconstructing a medieval library? The contents of the manuscript bundles in the Dunhuang Library Cave', *Silk Roads Archaeology and Heritage* 1.1 (2023), pp. 56–76.

[61] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 182; Stein, *Serindia*, pp. 808–809.

[62] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 182; Stein, *Serindia*, pp. 808–809.

[63] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 801.

[64] *Ibid*, p. 814.

[65] *Ibid*, p. 823.

[66] Bodleian Libraries Oxford, entry for 28 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: ff. 317–318: 'During the Tao-shih [Daoshi]'s absence, I succeeded in digging down to floor in the NE corner. Here between the wall & base three bundles full of silk pict[ure]s, waste paper, etc., had been thrown down to keep off the damp! [...] No moisture in rock, but clay built base appar[ently] absorbs some from outside air.'

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numerous irregularly shaped bundles with heterogeneous contents.[67] If anything, the way Wang rehoused the materials in the cave seemed careful and intentional, not haphazard.[68]

Whether to raise awareness of the pious efforts that were being carried out and solicit donations or to genuinely alert people to this extraordinary discovery, Wang Yuanlu hand-picked hundreds of fine manuscripts, paintings, and other artefacts, and gifted them to officials, triggering their slow dispersal as early as 1900. He may not have realised the full historical, cultural, and scholarly value of the objects contained in the hoard, but this is not to say that he did not consider them to be important. Wang knew better than anyone what was inside Cave 17 and carefully reorganised the bundles in a way that reflected, as we will see below, his very own appraisal of the newly found repository's collection.

Wang Yuanlu: disperser of Cave 17's contents

Aurel Stein's first visit to Dunhuang

Aurel Stein first visited Dunhuang and the Mogao Caves Buddhist complex during his second Central Asian expedition (1906–1908). The selection and acquisition of paintings, manuscripts, and other sacred relics from the cave turned out to be a gradual negotiation process, dependent in large part on the goodwill of Wang Yuanlu. In the words of the British-Hungarian explorer: 'We never knew how long we might rely on the Tao-shih [Daoshi]'s indulgence.'[69] His writings reveal that Wang played a crucial role from the onset, determining to a large extent what Stein was eventually able to purchase. The whole transaction can be broken down in two distinct phases: the first phase unfolded between 22 May and 6 June 1907, while the second phase took place in around October of the same year.[70] We will now explore Stein's dealings with Wang Yuanlu on each of these occasions.

When Stein and his secretary Jiang Xiaowan first came to the Caves of the Thousand Buddhas in March 1907, Wang Yuanlu was absent. However, they were shadowed by a young monk who revealed the location of Cave 17 and allowed them to examine one of the manuscripts lent to his master. Given how embedded Wang was in the small Buddhist monastic community at the site, he was most likely informed of the explorer's visit. As Stein waited in town for the local festival and the annual pilgrimage to the caves to be over, Jiang contacted Wang Yuanlu and asked him to wait for them at the Mogao Caves.[71] Therefore, when Stein returned on 21 May of the same year, Wang immediately came to 'welcome [him] at what for most of the year he might well claim as sacred ground entrusted to his own exclusive care'.[72]

Stein's description of Wang was particularly unflattering, conveying the image of a shifty-looking, deceitful, and untrustworthy individual: 'He looked a very queer person, extremely shy and nervous, with an occasional expression of cunning which was far from encouraging. It was clear from the first that he would be a difficult person to handle.'[73] This is somewhat hypocritical, as the explorer himself proudly reported, in his published accounts, how he was using subterfuge. The next morning, in an attempt to disguise the main objective of his stay, he 'avoided any long interview' with Wang and pretended to be

[67] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 814.

[68] When Stein started looking at some of the 'miscellaneous' packets placed at the bottom of the 'regular' bundles, Wang was visibly annoyed that he disturbed his arrangement and proceeded to fill the space with bundles that the explorer had already sifted through. See Bodleian Libraries Oxford, MSS 204: f. 318.

[69] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 188.

[70] For a thorough review of Stein's acquisitions of Dunhuang materials, see Terzi and Whitfield, 'Reconstructing a medieval library?', pp. 56–76.

[71] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 802.

[72] *Ibid*, p. 803.

[73] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 165.

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absorbed by 'the survey of the main grottoes, and the photographing of the more notable frescoes'.[74] Yet, Stein was keen to 'ascertain the true character and approximate date of the collection' contained within the hoard.[75] He dispatched Jiang Xiaowan to 'sound [D]aoshi about MSS, wishing to prepare [the] ground slowly. Priest ready to show collection, & before evening S.[hiye] saw it, a large recess crammed full with MSS. to roof!'[76]

Stein had hoped to see the manuscripts 'in their original place of deposit',[77] but this initial conversation was not the open sesame they had expected. Wang Yuanlu consented, 'with various meticulous reservations', only to let Stein see 'such specimens of the collection as he might conveniently lay his hands on'.[78] The mere suggestion that the explorer may wish to acquire a few manuscripts caused Wang 'manifestly genuine perturbation'.[79] Concerned that the promise of money might not overcome the religious scruples and fear of popular resentment that Stein believed motivated Wang Yuanlu's reluctance, he decided to pay him a formal visit.[80] He asked to see the restored Cave 16, known to be Wang's 'chief care',[81] as well as 'the pride and the mainstay of his [Dunhuang] existence'.[82] In a famous episode from his published accounts (not recorded in his diaries),[83] Stein sought to win Wang's trust by invoking the seventh-century Buddhist monk Xuanzang 玄奘:

> More than once before, my well-known attachment to the memory of Hsuan-tsang [Xuanzang], the greatest of those pilgrims, had been helpful in securing me a sympathetic hearing both among the learned and the simple. Wang Tao-shih [Daoshi], too, had probably heard about it. [...] I thought it appropriate to tell Wang Tao-shih [Daoshi], as well as my poor Chinese would permit, of my devotion to the saintly traveller; how I had followed his footsteps from India for over ten thousand Li across inhospitable mountains and deserts; how in the course of the pilgrimage I had traced to its present ruins, however inaccessible, many a sanctuary he had previously visited and described; and so on.[84]

Late that night, Jiang came to Stein's tent bearing a 'small bundle of manuscript rolls' that Wang had secretly given him.[85] It must have belonged to the 'regular' bundles, for it contained several Chinese sutras, 'all neatly rolled up and enclosed in cotton wrappers'.[86] A note at the beginning of several scrolls in Chinese stated that they had been first brought from India and translated by Xuanzang, whom Stein called his 'Chinese patron saint'. Both Stein and Jiang Xiaowan assumed this auspicious sign could only be a coincidence since 'Wang Tao-shih [Daoshi] in his ignorance could have had no inkling, when he picked up those specimens, of their connexion with [Xuanzang]'s sacred memory'.[87] Was it just a lucky accident?

[74] *Ibid*, p. 165.
[75] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 166.
[76] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 22 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 305.
[77] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 803.
[78] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 166.
[79] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 803.
[80] *Ibid*, pp. 804, 808.
[81] *Ibid*, p. 804.
[82] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 167.
[83] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 22 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: ff. 305–306.
[84] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 169.
[85] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 807.
[86] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 23 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 307.
[87] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 807.

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It is unlikely: these fine manuscripts probably came from the 'regular' bundles filled with canonical texts, so Wang must have extracted them specifically. If the conversation about Xuanzang did take place that very afternoon, then it is worth considering whether Wang was using these scrolls as 'bait' to start the negotiations with Stein.

The following day, 23 May 1907, Wang Yuanlu finally opened the door to Cave 17, which Stein depicted as a 'black hole' where 'no examination of the manuscripts would be possible'.[88] It was agreed that Wang would continue to take out a bundle or two at a time and allow them to 'look rapidly through their contents in a less cramped and dark part of the temple precincts'.[89] A small room in the antechapel of Cave 16, sheltered from view, was turned into an improvised 'reading room' for Stein and Jiang, who had to work quickly for fear that Wang might change his mind.[90] Responsible for retrieving items, Wang Yuanlu began with the 'miscellaneous' bundles he had stacked atop the 'regular' bundles.[91] Stein thus looked through a 'large bundle of silk and cotton banners and prayer flags', two Chinese bundles, 'a large convolute of mixed papers', and 'one packet of large C[entral] A[sian] sheets'.[92]

The explorer remarked that 'it was mere chance, too, what bundles the Tao-shih [Daoshi] would hand [them] out'.[93] In fact, Wang was carefully planning what to deliver, focusing on the items he valued the least. The position of the 'miscellaneous' bundles made them easy to reach, but, more importantly, their selection was deliberate. While Wang Yuanlu appeared indifferent to Stein sifting through these bundles, he was by contrast eager to shield the regular ones from him: 'The secret hope of diverting by their sacrifice my attention from the precious rolls of Chinese canonical texts or "Ching" [jing 經] made him now more assiduously grope for and hand out bundles of what he evidently classed under the head of miscellaneous rubbish.'[94]

Thanks to Jiang's persuasion, Wang consented to letting them remove the items that they were putting aside, provided that they exercised the utmost discretion and acted in secret:[95]

> The Tao-shih [Daoshi] had summoned up the courage to fall in with my wishes, on the solemn condition that nobody besides us three was to get the slightest inkling of what was being transacted, and that as long as I kept Chinese soil the origin of these 'finds' was not to be revealed to any living being.[96]

Wang Yuanlu did not want to be seen outside his quarters at night, so Jiang Xiaowan acted as courier, carrying documents back to Stein's tent while everyone else slept.[97] This demonstrates that Wang remained in control and dictated the terms of the transaction.

Stein spent five days working through 'miscellaneous' bundles, gathering items he considered of special interest: 'everything that possessed artistic or archaeological value, and

[88] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 172; Stein, *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks*, p. 204.
[89] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 808.
[90] *Ibid*, p. 809.
[91] *Ibid*, p. 814.
[92] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 23 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: ff. 307–308.
[93] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 182.
[94] *Ibid*, pp. 178–179.
[95] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 813.
[96] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 181.
[97] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 813; Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 181.

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whatever manuscripts in Indian or Central Asian languages could be traced'.[98] He was surprised and delighted that Wang 'raised no objection when [he] put aside rapidly "for closer inspection" the best of the pictures on silk, linen, and paper I could lay my hands on'.[99] He hand-picked some banners, paintings, and several manuscripts in Brahmi, Sanskrit, and Uyghur, written in a variety of formats. He also extracted any secular texts in Chinese, drawings, and woodblock prints that he came across.[100]

Despite the remarkable 'finds' already made, Stein was still intent on accessing the 'rampart' of regular manuscript bundles 'rising against the walls of the chapel'.[101] Wang Yuanlu was initially reluctant, resisting the 'heavy labour of clearing out the whole chamber' and the 'risk of exposure thus involved', but he eventually started removing the regular bundles with the help of an assistant.[102] As Stein's diaries hint, the prospect of a donation may have swayed him:

> During morning, Wang opened question as to donation for temple. Took up the theme in order to introduce question of purchase. No definite offer could be made until I had seen the full extent of the collection. So Wang, his helpmate and Sieh [Shiye] slaved all the afternoon in clearing out bundles of MSS. From cella.[103]

By nightfall on 27 May 1907, the entire collection of regular bundles had been arranged in neat rows in the cella of Cave 16 (Figure 3).[104] Stein and Jiang Xiaowan quickly selected items, without breaking pace to unfold scrolls or check their backs,[105] mindful that Wang Yuanlu was uneasy about their handling of material he clearly highly valued, particularly the Chinese sutras.[106] The operation also yielded an unexpected bonus, for several large miscellaneous bundles, placed by Wang Yuanlu at the very bottom, were now revealed. They contained exquisite silk paintings and textiles that Stein set aside among his 'selections'.[107]

Having grown increasingly tense, Wang was now keen to conclude his proceedings with the explorer: 'While asking for a substantial subscription to his temple, he yet protested that any cession of sacred texts or "Chings [jing 經]"—and among these he classed all Chinese manuscript rolls, whatever their contents might be—was impossible.'[108] Stein then attempted to acquire the whole hoard, but Wang Yuanlu categorically refused, and his insistence only worsened the situation.[109] In his diaries, Stein wrote that Wang raised difficulties 'about [the] consent of donors',[110] further expanding on this in his published accounts:

[98] Confidential report by Stein concerning the cache of ancient manuscripts at Dunhuang, British Museum archives, CE 32/23/16/2.

[99] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 812.

[100] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entries for 23 to 27 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: ff. 307–315.

[101] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 822.

[102] *Ibid*, p. 822.

[103] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 27 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 315.

[104] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 823.

[105] *Ibid*, p. 823.

[106] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 191.

[107] Stein, *Serindia*, pp. 823–824. The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 2 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: ff. 317–318.

[108] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 823.

[109] *Ibid*, p. 813.

[110] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries, entry for 23 May 1907, MSS Stein 204: f. 316.

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Figure 3. Image showing piled-up manuscript bundles and tables outside of Cave 17, in the corridor leading to Cave 16. Source: M. A. Stein, *Serindia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China, etc.* (Oxford, 1921), vol. ii, fig. 200.

> The Tao-shih [Daoshi] persisted in urging with all signs of sincere anxiety that any deficiency in those piles of sacred texts was bound to be noticed by his patrons, whose publicly recorded subscriptions had helped him to clear and restore the temple; this would lead to the loss of the position which he had built up for himself in the district by the pious labours of eight years and to the destruction of his life's task. Former scruples reasserting themselves, he reproached himself for having given up sacred objects which his patrons had as much right to control as he had, and doggedly asserted the need of consulting them before taking any further step.[111]

When Stein went to skim through the regular bundles in search of interesting materials the next day, he realised that Wang Yuanlu had shifted almost all of them back into Cave 17 overnight. In his published accounts, he recounted how they had nevertheless reached a compromise, assuring him of 'fifty well-preserved bundles of Chinese text rolls and five of Tibetan ones, besides all [his] previous selections from the miscellaneous bundles'.[112] His personal diaries precise that Wang had left behind between 30 and 40 less well-preserved rolls and was only persuaded to 'extract from [the recess] about half of [the] finally selected bundles', amounting to '5 Tib[etan] rolled bundles; 3 large packets of Tib.[etan] pothis (among them two compl[ete] works & large portions of 7-8 others); 40 Chin.[ese] bundles (among them 2-3 misc.[ellaneous], 1 with frag.[ments])', as well as '6 large bundles of silk and other pictures'.[113] Now that the bundles were safely back in the

[111] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 824.
[112] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 193.
[113] Bodleian Libraries Oxford, entry for 29 May 1907, MSS 204: f. 319.

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cave, Wang could choose again which ones he deemed acceptable to part with. For instance, he also presented the explorer with 'several broken bundles', and a 'large silk embroidered Buddha curtain, app[arently] lifesize'.[114] This is most probably the splendid embroidery of the Buddha flanked by two disciples now held in the British Museum collections.[115]

Once the transaction was complete, Wang went to Dunhuang to beg for alms. Considering what he had said about his patrons' right to decide the fate of the manuscripts, he may have used this opportunity to ask them whether they supported his dealings with Stein. Stein's report notes that, upon coming back from town a week later, Wang seemed 'reassured that the secret had not been discovered, and that his spiritual influence, such as it was, had suffered no diminution'.[116] Perhaps encouraged by his sponsors' approval, Wang was sufficiently emboldened to let Stein purchase 20 regular bundles of manuscripts, with additional selections from the 'mixed' bundles.

The explorer left the Mogao Caves on 12 June 1907, with seven cases full of manuscripts and five cases of paintings, embroideries, and other items:

> I had the satisfaction of seeing that the shy Tao-shih [Daoshi], honest in his own way, now breathed freely again. It seemed almost as if in a dim way he recognized that it was a pious act on his part to let me rescue for Western scholarship as much as circumstances would permit of those ancient Buddhist relics which local ignorance would allow to lie here neglected or to be lost in the end. When I finally took my departure from the 'Halls of the Thousand Buddhas', his quaint, sharp-cut face had resumed its customary expression of shy but self-contented serenity.[117]

For Wang, the true 'pious act' was selling the cave's contents to fund the renovation work that preoccupied him. As he and other monks actively used the manuscripts and paintings for religious purposes, their 'neglect' was hardly a concern. Having been conflicted throughout his negotiations with Stein, Wang Yuanlu was undoubtedly relieved to see him go.

The second phase of Stein's acquisitions took place four months later, when he stopped at Anxi to retrieve the cases of antiquities he had left with the magistrate on his way back from Jiuquan. Through a messenger he sent a written proposal for further 'selections' from Cave 17, which was 'met with a cautious response'.[118] In his answer, received on 27 September 1907, Wang Yuanlu specified the price he expected per 100 bundles, already setting the tone of the transaction.[119] To avoid raising suspicions, Stein stayed behind and entrusted negotiations to his Chinese secretary.[120] Jiang Xiaowan departed for the Mogao Caves on 29 September with 600 taels, intending to reach the site by 2 October and to be back by the sixth.[121] On the evening of 4 October 1907, the convoy returned with four camels

[114] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein field diaries, entry for 29 May 1907, MSS 204: f. 320.

[115] This item was given the number Ch.00269 by Stein and received the registration number MAS, 0.1129 at the British Museum.

[116] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 825.

[117] *Ibid*, p. 825.

[118] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 339.

[119] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 27 September 1907, MSS Stein 205: f. 90.

[120] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 339.

[121] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 29 September 1907, MSS Stein 205: f. 91.

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heavily laden with manuscripts, having marched by night to avoid attention.[122] In his personal narrative, Stein recounted the 'secret mission' as a resounding success: 'How he had managed to secure the timorous Taoist monk, and to induce him for a very reasonable recompense to hand out at night over two hundred additional bundles of Chinese texts, was quite a dramatic story. The whole was managed most discreetly.'[123]

The explorer's field diary offers slightly different insights. When Jiang reached the caves on 1 October 1907, Wang Yuanlu was away and had to be fetched by his 'famulus' on a donkey. Despite Jiang's efforts, Wang refused to reduce his price or agree to further sales. He was particularly unwilling to part with some Tibetan manuscripts, in which a group of lamas had expressed an interest:

> It appears Tib.[etan] Mss. are to be taken over by some 6–9 red-robed Tib.[etan] monks who wish to keep them in a separate shrine. These men made Tao-shih [Daoshi] nervous. 200 bundles were taken out from dark hole without previous selection; but [Jiang Siye] says he rejected 'lan-di' ones. Packing done hurriedly within cave and sacks put on *shotas* within.[124]

This passage demonstrates again that Wang was guiding the selection process and suggests that the local Buddhist community influenced negotiations, as Wang prioritised the monks' interests in this instance. Although Wang Yuanlu ceded a large share of Chinese and Tibetan manuscripts, he controlled the transaction at every stage. Jiang Xiaowan's rejection of several 'lan-di' (spoiled or decayed) bundles also indicates that Wang Yuanlu tried to release manuscripts of lesser value.[125] By contrast, when selecting gifts for officials, Wang had chosen particularly fine manuscripts, with beautiful handwriting and in excellent condition. Upon leaving Dunhuang in mid June 1907, Stein had taken with him over 90 bundles of manuscripts, containing about 1,200 separate texts in rolls or 'Pothis'. This new tranche of materials was even more significant: it comprised 230 of the regular bundles, 'rais[ing] the number of texts to close on 4,000'.[126]

When Stein met Wang, he quickly understood that the preservation of the Mogao Caves was key to him. He saw in his pious endeavours powerful motivation to sell the contents of Cave 17, while Wang saw in Stein an opportunity to get money for the site's upkeep. Yet, throughout the ensuing transactions, Wang Yuanlu proved nervous and conflicted, especially about parting with the 'regular' bundles of Buddhist sutras. As we have seen, this was due to the high value the local religious community placed on these materials. Wang set the conditions for their 'exchange': he chose most of the bundles for Stein's examination, stipulated that the items be transferred at night in the greatest secrecy, and probably pre-selected the bundles presented to Jiang when he returned on his own.

Wang Yuanlu and Paul Pelliot

Less than a year after Stein, on 12 February 1908, Paul Pelliot arrived at Dunhuang, where he stayed until the beginning of June 1908. During his sojourn in Urumqi at the end of 1907, he

[122] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 5 October 1907, MSS Stein 205: f. 94.

[123] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 339.

[124] The Bodleian Libraries Oxford, typed transcript of Stein's field diaries from December 1906 to August 1908, entry for 5 October 1907, MSS Stein 205: f. 95.

[125] The author would like to thank their two anonymous reviewers for suggesting that 'lan-di' might be Stein's transcription for 爛的, meaning 'rotten', 'decayed', or 'ragged'. This term would have denoted manuscript scraps considered of low value.

[126] British Museum Central Archives, CE 32/23/16/2.

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had heard of the newly found repository at the Mogao Caves complex and had been shown an eighth-century manuscript from Cave 17.[127] This had made him even more eager to reach the Thousand Buddha Caves, which were already on his itinerary when he left France. Once there, Pelliot also purchased a sizeable portion of the cave's contents from Wang Yuanlu. Stein may have been the first Western explorer to see the newly discovered cache, but I would argue that Pelliot's luck was to have come in second place. It may have resulted in his securing some of the 'rarest' pieces.

By the time Pelliot came to the Mogao Caves, Wang had had several months to see whether there were any repercussions to selling crates' worth of materials from the small cave to Stein. The benefits must have outweighed the negatives, as he was ready to engage in another such transaction with Pelliot. According to the French Sinologist:

> Mr. Stein had worked in the cave for three days, and officially bought a certain number of manuscripts, with the knowledge of the local mandarin; the monk added that our colleague [Stein] had also personally left him a sum, which he said was plump, to get more [manuscripts]. A word to the wise; I knew for certain the procedure to adopt myself.[128]

There is no evidence that Wang Yuanlu ever made any sort of agreement with the local official—if anything, this is at odds with the discretion that Stein was asked to use during their interactions. Could this have been a lie that was meant to put Pelliot at ease and convince him to engage in a financial deal with Wang?

While Wang Yuanlu had resisted giving Stein full access to the small repository, insisting on handing him preselected bundles of materials, he showed no such resistance when the Frenchman came. Interestingly, Wang no longer seemed concerned about people finding out what Pelliot was up to. He had asked Stein and Jiang to work in a screened room during the day and to remove materials 'for further examination' (knowing what this implied) at night, yet Pelliot made no mention of any such stipulations. For three weeks, from 3 March 1908, Pelliot used the small space left by the items Stein had removed, squatting inside the niche to examine as many items as possible. He was amazed to find many of the bundles still intact and sewn up.[129] During the first ten days, he managed to freely check up to 1,000 scrolls a day.[130] A photograph shows him crouching in Cave 17, with piles of materials behind him.

Several of Pelliot's selection criteria were similar to Stein's. He too prioritised scrolls written in languages such as Uyghur or Brahmi: 'My ignorance simplified the choice of non-Chinese documents. I distinguish many letters and their alphabet, but the meaning escapes me; to leave nothing interesting behind, I acquired everything.'[131] Pelliot sought to acquire most of the remaining Tibetan documents, putting aside 'about five hundred kilos of manuscripts dating back to the first four centuries of Tibetan Buddhism'.[132] He also focused on the Chinese manuscripts with dated colophons, non-Buddhist texts, and other historically significant documents. His mastery of classical Chinese enabled him to better sort through materials in this language, including non-canonical Buddhist texts. Unlike Stein,

[127] P. Pelliot, 'Trois Ans dans la Haute Asie: Conférence de M. Paul Pelliot au Grand Amphithéâtre de la Sorbonne, le 10 décembre 1909', *Extrait du Bulletin du Comité de l'Asie Française* (Janvier 1910) (Paris, 1910), p. 13. The article has been digitised and is available on Toyo Bunko, http://dsr.nii.ac.jp/toyobunko/VIII-5-B2-12/, https://doi.org/10.20676/00000241.

[128] Translated by the author; Pelliot, 'Une bibliothèque médiévale', p. 505.

[129] *Ibid*, pp. 506–507.

[130] *Ibid*, p. 505.

[131] *Ibid*, p. 508.

[132] *Ibid*, p. 507.

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who had insisted on the 'regular' or 'library' bundles, Pelliot had little interest in them. He deliberately discarded the Chinese copies of the *Lotus Sutra* and the *Nirvana Sutra*.[133] This may explain why he did not face the same resistance from Wang Yuanlu, who valued canonical sutras most highly.

Overall, Wang did not object to Pelliot's selections, but he did not let him acquire everything either. Pelliot was keen to have the huge Tibetan *pothi* stacked in perfect order in a corner of the cave that Wang Yuanlu identified as a form of Kanjur or Tibetan Buddhist canon.[134] Wang explained that a Mongol prince from Qaidam, who travelled to the Mogao Caves every year, had got into the habit of consulting them each time. He refused to part with them to avoid upsetting the regular visitor.[135] Despite protracted negotiations, Wang conceded only three volumes.[136] To divert the Sinologist's attention and safeguard these Tibetan copies of the *Perfection of Wisdom Sutra*, Wang Yuanlu offered Pelliot several paintings. He claimed that they were the best and had been set aside long ago.[137] Stein was likely correct in thinking that Wang had handed him what he considered to be 'rubbish'[138] because he had obviously held onto the items more important to him.

In August and September 1909, Pelliot travelled to Beijing to buy books for the Bibliothèque nationale de France. He brought a small selection of Dunhuang manuscripts, which several scholars examined and photographed. They formed an association to reproduce and publish the most important texts.[139] This marked a turning point, as Chinese scholars became aware of the value of Cave 17's contents. They petitioned the Qing Ministry of Education, which ordered in 1910 that the remaining manuscripts should be sent to Beijing for safekeeping. Unfortunately, there were several instances of theft and loss during their transfer to the capital.[140]

Wang Yuanlu's attitude was markedly different during Pelliot's visit in 1908. Although it is often said that Pelliot gained better access thanks to his excellent Chinese, other factors were probably at play. By then, Wang had established his own boundaries regarding what could and could not be sold, possibly in accord with his lay patrons and the local monastic community. Furthermore, unlike Stein, who insisted on purchasing materials from the regular bundles, Pelliot was not interested in collecting Buddhist canonical texts, which may have reduced tension in his dealings with Wang.

Acquisitions by other explorers and Stein's second visit to Dunhuang

As we have seen, most of Cave 17's remaining manuscripts were transferred to Beijing in 1910. In the letter written on red paper mentioned in the first part of this article, Wang Yuanlu complained that he had not received the amount of money promised for his restoration work. He also mentioned 'donating' thousands of scrolls to Stein and Pelliot, although he was careful to use a turn of phrase emphasising the piety of this act.[141] This shows that

[133] *Ibid.*

[134] M. Lalou, 'Les manuscrits tibétains des grandes prajñapāpāramitā trouvés à Touen-houang', in *Silver Jubilee Volume of the Zinbun-Kagaku-Kenkyusyo* (1954), p. 257.

[135] Pelliot, 'Une bibliothèque médiévale', p. 507.

[136] In his travel diaries, Pelliot said on 12 May 1908 that he had only managed to buy one of these books; see Pelliot, *Carnets de Route*, p. 294. However, the post-scriptum to an article published in the same year indicates that he had secured three volumes; see Pelliot, 'Une bibliothèque médiévale', p. 529, n. 1.

[137] Pelliot, *Carnets de Route*, p. 136.

[138] See full quote earlier in the article; Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, pp. 178–179.

[139] Pelliot, 'Trois Ans dans la Haute Asie', p. 15.

[140] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, p. 106.

[141] Shuchen Wang, 'Atoms & Bits of Cultural Heritage: The Use of Dunhuang Collections in Knowledge Making, Nation Building, Museum Diplomacy, Cultural Tourism and Digital Economy' (unpublished PhD thesis, Aalto University, 2019), p. 57, footnote 15, https://urn.fi/URN:ISBN:978-952-60-8685-9 (accessed 30 July 2024).

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Wang did not attempt to hide that he had given a large number of items to the two foreigners, even if he did not mention that he did so against payment. What he kept quiet, however, is that he had disobeyed official orders and secreted hundreds of items.

In 1911–1912, Wang Yuanlu sold several hundreds of manuscripts from his stash to members of the third Ōtani expedition (1910–1914).[142] While waiting for Tachibana Zuichō 橘瑞超 (1890–1968), the leader of the expedition, Yoshikawa Koichirō 吉川小一郎 (1885–1978), began examining the Mogao Caves and taking photographs of the murals on 17 October 1911. At the site he bought two carved statues from Wang, who made a special journey to Dunhuang the next day to sell him some 'Tang sutras'. In December, Wang visited again, explaining that the country's turmoil would prevent him from getting funds from Suzhou's Yamen for the restoration of the caves. He was asked to come back with a better set of manuscripts and returned in early January 1912 with scrolls written in a script Yoshikawa identified as Mongolian and preferred not to buy. In his diaries, the Japanese explorer wrote that he suspected Wang Yuanlu of having made a secret arrangement with his landlord.[143] He also compared the attitude of the Daoist priest with Cave 17's Tang sutras to that of a thief 'carrying stolen goods'.[144]

After months of delay, Tachibana Zuichō finally arrived in Dunhuang and went to the Mogao Caves with Yoshikawa. They bought 169 scrolls and asked Wang Yuanlu to bring better manuscripts. Wang came back with 200 additional items, some of which they thought were forgeries, prompting them to sort the scrolls into three categories by quality. On 4 February 1912, Wang brought another batch of 200 Buddhist scrolls in Chinese that Yoshikawa and Tachibana also purchased.[145] They left town a few days later. Yoshikawa returned to Dunhuang on his own in February 1913 and acquired approximately 80 scrolls from Wang.[146] A large proportion of these were Tibetan copies of the *Aparamitayus Sutra*, which would presumably have been in the regular 'library' bundles.[147]

When Stein stopped at Dunhuang again in 1914, during his third Central Asian expedition (1913–1916), Wang was still in possession of manuscripts from Cave 17. Wang Yuanlu welcomed Stein to town and cordially invited him to the Mogao Caves, hinting that his own store of ancient manuscripts had not yet been exhausted.[148] Wang also told him 'with a bitterness only too justified' that he had received none of the large sum assigned by the Central Government as compensation for the removal of the manuscripts.[149] The money had vanished on the way, 'duly absorbed in transit through various offices',[150] and he regretted 'not having previously had the courage and wisdom to accept the big offer that [Stein] had

[142] Wang was not the only person with manuscripts for sale. The diaries of Yoshikawa Koichirō reveal that he was offered a scroll by the head of the Anxi Telegraph Office even before reaching Dunhuang in 1911. He also purchased a smaller number of manuscripts from several locals, including a farm labourer and a Chinese merchant. Imre Galambos, 'The third Ōtani expedition at Dunhuang: acquisition of the Japanese collection of Dunhuang manuscripts', *Journal of Inner Asian Art and Archaeology* 3 (2008): pp. 30–31. Ueyama Daishun, 'How I came to be convinced that the Ōtani collection contains forged manuscripts', in *Dunhuang Manuscripts Forgeries*, (ed.) S. Whitfield (London, 2002), pp. 316–320.

[143] Galambos, 'Third Ōtani expedition at Dunhuang', pp. 30–31.

[144] English translation from Yoshikawa Koichirō's diary. See Daishun, 'How I came to be convinced', p. 317.

[145] *Ibid*, pp. 317–8. See also Galambos, 'Third Ōtani expedition at Dunhuang', p. 31.

[146] *Ibid*, p. 32. The author found the precise number of manuscripts in an interview given by Yoshikawa Koichirō 70 years after the events. See also Hao Chunwen, *Dunhuang Manuscripts: An Introduction to Texts from the Silk Road*, (trans.) S. Teiser (Diamond Bar, CA, 2020), p. 51.

[147] Shang Lin 尚林, Fang Guangchang 方廣錩, and Rong Xinjiang 荣新江, *Zhongguo suocang Dagu shoujipin gaikuang: tebie yi Dunhuang xiejing wei zhongxin* 中國所藏集品概況—特別以敦煌寫經為中心 (Kyoto, 1991).

[148] Stein, *Innermost Asia*, p. 356.

[149] *Ibid*, p. 355.

[150] Stein, *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks*, p. 210.

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made through Jiang S[h]iye for the whole collection *en bloc*'.[151] Wang Yuanlu's patrons felt the same and were probably aware of his actions. As Stein wrote:

> His devout clientèle among the Tun-huang population, seeing how well he had laid out the sums received, first from myself and then from Pei Ta jên, i.e. M. Pelliot, in building new gaudy chapels and a large, comfortable hospice, seemed to agree in sharing his feelings. They, no doubt, fully approved too of the shrewd precaution which the honest Taoist monk had taken against the official spoliation of the temple becoming too complete.[152]

Stein made his way to the site on 2 April 1914. The following day, he received confirmation that Wang had indeed put away a 'nest egg' of Chinese manuscripts.[153] Wang showed him two large boxes crammed with sutra rolls whose handwriting, high-quality paper, Buddhist content, and dating indicated they came from the 'regular' bundles that 'Wang Tao-shih [Daoshi], under the influence of quasi-religious scruples, had in 1907 been least willing to part.'[154] Almost all these scrolls, Stein noted, were large (often complete) and in remarkably good condition.[155] Wang had deliberately retained the finest specimens, displaying the very qualities that had guided his choice of gifts for Gansu officials as early as 1900.

This time, Stein did not 'reasonably hope for any finds of outstanding importance', since Pelliot had likely examined most of the manuscripts and selected all the non-Chinese texts, along with any Chinese texts of obvious interest.[156] Frustratingly for Stein, however, Wang Yuanlu now demanded a much higher 'donation' than in 1907. Not only had Wang learned from his dealings with other explorers, but he also wanted appropriate compensation for scrolls he regarded as especially valuable:

> his shrewd sense of business had been awakened by the payments received from subsequent visitors to a keener comprehension of the money value of what he retained. He consequently held out at first for a price per roll which, being about four times as much as that paid on the occasion of [Jiang Shiye 師爺]'s big haul of October, 1907, seemed distinctly too high. No doubt Wang's estimate was greatly influenced by the fact that the rolls he was now prepared to part with were almost all large ones and particularly well preserved.[157]

In the end, Stein purchased 570 Buddhist manuscripts, filling a total of five cases, 'each as large as a pony could conveniently carry'.[158] What he acquired was once again shaped by Wang Yuanlu, who had mainly Buddhist canonical texts in Chinese, some dating as early as the fifth and sixth centuries. In addition, to seal their deal, he also presented him with a collection of relief stucco plaques that he had supposedly found in another cave.[159]

During Stein's second visit, Wang showed him his accounts and the new structures that had appeared over the past seven years, largely funded by the 1907 payments in exchange

[151] *Ibid*, p. 211.
[152] Stein, *Serindia*, p. 830.
[153] Stein, *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks*, p. 211.
[154] Stein, *Innermost Asia*, p. 358.
[155] *Ibid*, p. 358.
[156] *Ibid*, p. 358.
[157] *Ibid*, p. 358.
[158] *Ibid*, p. 358.
[159] *Ibid*, p. 359.

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for his 'selections'. Right opposite Cave 16 and Cave 17 now stood a guest house, a series of shrines, and a few facilities that 'attested the little priest's single-minded ambition to restore, according to his lights, the glory and popular attractions of the ancient sacred site'.[160] Several wall paintings and stucco sculptures had also been restored. Elsewhere, substantial work had been done to remove the drift sand blocking the lower-level caves and to render the upper-level caves accessible by 'cutting passages from one cave-shrine to another right through the rock wall separating them'.[161]

As Stein left with his new acquisitions, he could not help but wonder 'whether the contents of the two big boxes of manuscripts which Wang Tao-shih [Daoshi] kept in his store-room really represented the whole of the reserve he had managed to retain'.[162] There is no way to confirm his suspicions. In August 1914, the Russian orientalist and Buddhist scholar Sergey Oldenburg (1863–1934), who was leading his second Russian Turkestan expedition (1914–1915), travelled to Dunhuang. His team systematically studied and reproduced the pictorial and sculptural remains of the Mogao Caves, compiling an account of all caves, making floor plans, taking photographs, and copying murals. They gathered 19,000 Dunhuang manuscripts, mostly fragments, as well as over 350 paintings, acquired primarily from other caves rather than Cave 17.[163]

By the time Stein returned to Dunhuang in 1914, most of Cave 17's contents had been removed. Even so, he secured another 600 fine Buddhist scrolls from Wang Yuanlu, who still possessed manuscripts from the small cache. Having learned from his dealings with Pelliot and the members of the Ōtani expedition, Wang was now determined to obtain fair payment to finance his restoration work. These manuscripts are now held at the British Library. Again, Stein was only able to choose from the materials that were made available to him and, in that sense, Wang played a determining role in shaping the collection that the explorer was gathering.

Conclusion

Wang Yuanlu—the man whose pious restoration work led to one of the most astonishing discoveries of the twentieth century—is a fascinating character. This article provides a more nuanced understanding of Wang by examining his relationship with the Mogao Caves and their wider ecosystem (especially the community of local Buddhist monks and the lay donors who funded his enterprises), by tracing how he conducted his transactions with Stein in 1907 and 1914, and by contrasting these with his dealings with other explorers. We argue here that Wang is not so much an 'obscure' as an 'obscured' figure.

Aurel Stein's detailed writings and other sources belie the simplistic image of a 'quaint priest, with [a] curious mixture of pious zeal, naïve ignorance, and astute tenacity of purpose',[164] who was swayed to sell thousands of manuscripts and other artefacts out of his and Stein's shared admiration for Xuanzang or a belief that letting Stein take some of the

[160] *Ibid*, p. 357.
[161] *Ibid*, p. 360.
[162] *Ibid*, p. 359.
[163] For an overview, see Hao Chunwen, *Dunhuang Manuscripts*, pp. 54–56. For more details, refer to Popova, 'S.F. Oldenburg's Second Russian Turkestan Expedition (1914–1915)', pp. 158–175. In addition to the items collected in 1914–1915, several Dunhuang manuscripts acquired from an unknown source had been transferred to St Petersburg in 1911. See A. Zorin, 'The collection of Dunhuang Tibetan texts kept at the IOM RAS', Institute of Oriental Manuscripts, RAS, St. Petersburg, 2012, pp. 365–367, http://www.orientalstudies.ru/rus/images/pdf/a_zorin_2012_b.pdf.
[164] Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 169.

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manuscripts to Buddhism's homeland would earn him some spiritual merit.[165] Wang exercised far more agency than he is usually credited with, yet he should not be reduced to a thief or even a shrewd businessman who treated Cave 17's contents as mere commodities. As noted by Justin Jacobs, he 'sought to control access to his "goods," carefully manage his "stock," and "sell" them on his own terms'.[166] This insight, however, does not reflect the full range of his motivation.

Wang Yuanlu, who took it upon himself to act as guardian of the Mogao Caves and joined ongoing restoration efforts, can be considered the first 'curator' or 'keeper' of Cave 17 and its contents. He alerted the authorities to the newly found hoard and, left in charge of preserving the collection, installed a locked door and reorganised the room according to what he deemed a more suitable arrangement. Contrary to Stein's accounts, Wang was far from unaware of the nature of the cave's contents. He collaborated with resident Buddhist monks, drawing on their expertise to identify some materials and lending them items for ritual purposes. He also hand-picked fine specimens as gifts for Gansu officials. Finally, having completely emptied and restacked Cave 17, he would have had a good grasp of its contents.

Equally important is Wang's role in shaping the now so-called Dunhuang Stein collection. Throughout his transactions with Stein, he was concerned with controlling the conditions of the exchange. When Stein first visited the Mogao Caves in 1907, he was not allowed free access to the repository and largely had to rely on Wang's choice of bundles to make selections. Stein and Jiang had to act in quasi-secrecy to avoid arousing suspicion. Wang Yuanlu was particularly protective of the Buddhist canonical texts that formed the bulk of the 'regular bundles', which he had safely sandwiched between top and bottom layers of 'miscellaneous' bundles. To distract Stein, he supplied one miscellaneous bundle after another, filled with materials he considered 'rubbish' or almost worthless—that is, paintings, drawings, printed documents, and texts in Central Asian languages. This is how the embroidery of the Buddha at the Vultures Peak or the 868 printed copy of the Diamond Sutra ended up in the United Kingdom.[167] Stein nevertheless secured a substantial number of 'regular' bundles in 1907 and 1914, explaining why the British Library's Stein collection contains multiple copies of the same scripture, including the *Lotus Sutra* and the *Diamond Sutra* in Chinese.

Ultimately, Wang Yuanlu made a judgement call between the relative importance of the Mogao Caves site as a whole versus that of Cave 17's contents. For him, enabling repair works to what had been a thriving Buddhist pilgrimage centre was a pious duty to which he devoted his life, channelling money from his begging tours and the sale of manuscripts into clearing sand, repairing statues and paintings, and restoring shrines. His decision was made not only from the perspective of living practice as opposed to that of scholarship but also collectively. Although Wang avoided drawing attention to his dealings with Stein, it is likely that local Buddhist monks were aware. Wang himself told Stein he was keen to consult the donors funding his initiatives. This may explain why his later transactions with Pelliot and others were conducted more openly. What seems clear is that his reputation was not diminished when he died in 1931; his disciples obtained permission from local authorities to erect a stupa in his honour, opposite the caves.[168]

[165] *Ibid*, p. 170.
[166] Jacobs, *Compensations of Plunder*, p. 97.
[167] They are now respectively held at the British Museum and British Library.
[168] Rong, *Eighteen Lectures on Dunhuang*, p. 107.

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